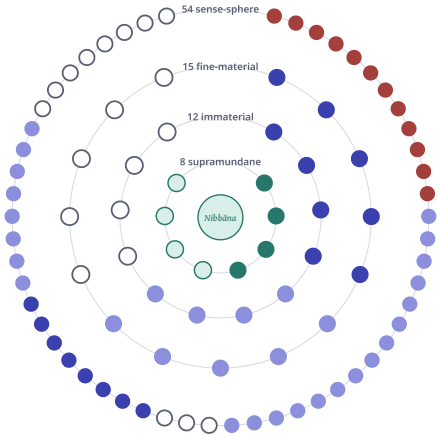
Abhidhamma Atlas

Mind, matter and the conditions that join them: fifteen plates on a seven-level path, with tools for slow study



unwholesome 12 · wholesome 17 · resultant 32 · functional 20 · path 4 · fruit 4

Each dot is one of the 89 kinds of consciousness. The rings run from the sense-sphere on the outside to the supramundane at the centre, where the only object is Nibbāna.

→	**How to learn with this atlas**	2
→	How to study slowly	3
→	A study plan, one plate a week	4
→	How the main ideas connect	5
→	The map in 3D	6
→	Every link explained	7
→	The Buddha's life as a map	8
I	**Level I · Foundations**	9
1	The library	10
2	From a person to dhammas	11
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	12–13
II	**Level II · Elements**	14
3	A map of the 89	15
3b	What each citta does	16
4	The 52 factors as an ensemble	17
4b	Which factors meet which cittas	18
5	How matter is made	19
6	The commentators' picture-book	20
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	21–22
III	**Level III · Process**	23
7	The mango and the moment	24
7b	Other processes	25
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	26–27
IV	**Level IV · Relations**	28
8	The web of 24 conditions	29
8b	The lists reduced to their factors	30
9	The wheel across three lives	31
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	32–33
V	**Level V · Lives and worlds**	34
10	Kamma, death and rebirth	35
11	Thirty-one planes	36
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	37–38
VI	**Level VI · Practice**	39
12	Forty meditation subjects	40
13	The tree of purification	41
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	42–43
VII	**Level VII · Synthesis**	44
14	One moment, every lens	45
15	Other maps of the same ground	46
◆	In 3D, then in the stories	47–48
↯	Threads, and reading with the Manual	49
↯	Glossary of 150 terms	50
✎	**Study tools: one dhamma, many lenses**	52
✎	Sixteen identity cards	53
✎	A review deck in five boxes	54

A learning path in seven levels

The plates are arranged as a path. Each level answers one question and assumes only the levels before it. Within every level you can work at three depths, taken from the Abhidhamma's own account of how wisdom grows: from learning, from reflection and from development. Read down a column to deepen one level; read across a row to climb.

	I Foundations	II Elements	III Process	IV Relations	V Lives and worlds	VI Practice	VII Synthesis
Question	*What is being taken apart?*	*What is experience made of?*	*How does it unfold?*	*How does it hold together?*	*What carries on, and where?*	*What do I do with it?*	*How does it all fit?*
Plates	1 2	3 4 5 6	7	8 9	10 11	12 13	14 15
Learn *suta*	Name the 7 books and 4 realities	Classify cittas, factors and matter	List the 17 moments and their jobs	Name the 6 families and 12 links	Sort kamma 4 ways; the 31 planes	40 subjects; 7 purifications; 10 fetters	The counts of three schools
Reflect *cintā*	Why a convention is not a falsehood	Why some factors never meet	Why kamma is made only in javana	Why most conditions are simultaneous	How rebirth hangs on the last process	Why calm is the root of insight	What a different view of time would change
Observe *bhāvanā*	See one moment as five aggregates	Notice the feeling-tone of moments	Catch the gap between hearing and naming	Trace a craving back to a contact	Watch which thoughts are habitual	Practise one subject for a week	Read one moment through every lens

Three depths of understanding

- **Learn** · *sutamayā paññā*, wisdom from hearing and study. Know the lists, the terms and the diagrams.
- **Reflect** · *cintāmayā paññā*, wisdom from thinking it through. See why the lists are built as they are, and how the plates connect.
- **Observe** · *bhāvanāmayā paññā*, wisdom from development. Recognise the same things in your own experience.

The next page turns the three depths into a weekly method study.

Dīgha Nikāya 33; Vibhaṅga. The tradition's matching triad is study, practice and realisation (*pariyatti, paṭipatti, paṭivedha*).

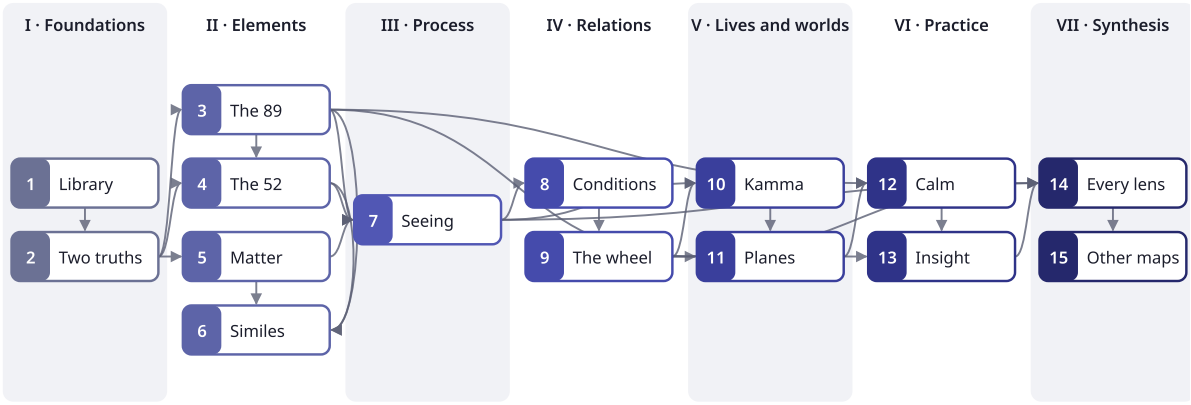
Three routes through the atlas

Full course
every level page and plate, in order
Level I → 1 → 2 → Level II → … → Threads

Quick tour
the core in six plates
2 Two truths → 3 The 89 → 7 Seeing → 9 The wheel → 13 Insight → 14 Every lens

Practitioner's route
from the elements to the path
2 Two truths → 4 The 52 → 7 Seeing → 9 The wheel → 12 Calm → 13 Insight → 14 Every lens

WHICH PLATES BUILD ON WHICH



Each arrow means “read this first”. Every level page lists what you should arrive with and what you should leave able to do.

How to study slowly

The Abhidhamma rewards slow study. Traditional teachers have students learn the outline by heart, read it word by word, question it, and only then look for it in their own experience. Research on learning points the same way: recalling beats rereading, and spacing beats cramming. This page turns both into a method for using the atlas: one plate at a time, six steps, then round again a level deeper.

THE STUDY CYCLE · ONE TURN FOR EVERY PLATE

1 Memorise

uggaha

TRADITION

Learn the outline by heart before its meaning. Students in Myanmar traditionally memorise the verses of the Abhidhammattha Saṅgaha first.

RESEARCH

You can only recall what is already stored; a memorised list is a scaffold for everything that follows.

IN THE ATLAS

The Learn questions on each level page; the review deck.

2 Read closely

pariyatti

TRADITION

Read word by word, as in a nissaya: the Pāli term, then its meaning, then the commentary's explanation.

RESEARCH

Explaining each step to yourself while reading (self-explanation) deepens understanding more than rereading.

IN THE ATLAS

One plate at a time. Then redraw it from memory.

3 Question

pucchā

TRADITION

The Vibhaṅga treats most topics in three ways: by the suttas, by the Abhidhamma, and by a catechism of questions.

RESEARCH

Asking "why is it so?" and answering in your own words (elaborative interrogation) ties new facts to old ones.

IN THE ATLAS

The Reflect questions; the Common confusions boxes.

4 Connect

paccaya

TRADITION

The Paṭṭhāna relates every dhamma to every other by its conditions.

RESEARCH

Mixing topics (interleaving) and drawing their relations helps you tell similar ideas apart and see how they fit.

IN THE ATLAS

The concept map and its path tracer; threads; the dhamma explorer.

5 Notice

paṭipatti

TRADITION

Recognise the dhamma in your own experience: its characteristic, at one of the six doors, as it appears now.

RESEARCH

Concrete examples make abstract categories stick; your own experience is the most concrete example there is.

IN THE ATLAS

The Observe questions; identity cards; the stories.

6 Return

punappunaṃ

TRADITION

Study is lifelong. Teachers such as Nina van Gorkom return to the same few realities again and again, each time a little deeper.

RESEARCH

Reviewing at growing intervals (spaced practice) and testing yourself (retrieval practice) are the two best-supported study techniques.

IN THE ATLAS

The review deck's five boxes; the study plan.

then return, one plate and one level further on, and later the whole way round again

A WEEK WITH ONE PLATE

DAY 1

Read

Read one plate slowly, with its sources.

LEARN

DAY 2

Redraw

Close the atlas. Redraw the plate's main drawing from memory, then compare.

LEARN

DAY 3

Question

Answer the level's Reflect questions in writing, in your own words.

REFLECT

DAY 4

Connect

Read a story from the level. Trace two links from this plate on the concept map.

REFLECT

DAY 5

Notice

Carry one Observe question through the day. Write one line in the evening.

OBSERVE

DAY 6

Review

Go through the review deck: today's cards from every level so far.

LEARN

DAY 7

Rest

Read nothing new. Let it settle.

REST

Five habits

- **Recall before you reread.** Close the atlas and write down what you remember, then check. The gaps show you where to look.
- **Space it out.** Come back after a day, three days, a week, a month. Forgetting a little between reviews makes each review count for more.
- **Mix the levels.** Review cards from earlier levels alongside new ones, so that citta, kamma and conditions keep meeting each other.
- **Draw it yourself.** A plate you can redraw from memory is a plate you know. Redrawing shows what you only recognise.
- **Notice without forcing.** Understanding grows by knowing what appears now. You cannot force greed away, but you can know it, as greed, while it is there.

Why slow?

The three depths on the previous page take time to grow. Wisdom from learning comes from repetition; wisdom from reflection needs room to turn an idea over; wisdom from development needs the idea to meet your own day. A plate a week gives each of them its turn. The plan on the next page sets out the weeks (plan), and the review deck keeps earlier levels alive (deck).

Sources: accounts of the Burmese Abhidhamma curriculum; Vibhaṅga; Nina van Gorkom, *Abhidhamma in Daily Life*; J. Dunlosky et al., "Improving Students' Learning With Effective Learning Techniques" (2013), which rates practice testing and spaced practice the most useful study techniques.

Eighteen weeks, one plate at a time

One row a week, one column a day. Each week takes one plate, with its level page, its 3D models and its stories when the level ends. Tick a box when a session is done; leave the seventh day empty. After week 17, go back to Level I: the second pass is faster, and you will notice what you missed.

Week	Study	Read	Redraw	Question	Connect	Notice	Review
0	Start here: the path, the method, the map path method map	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
1	The library Level I 1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	From a person to dhammas 2 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	The 89 cittas Level II 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	The 52 factors 4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	Matter 5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	The commentators' similes 6 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	The mango and the moment Level III 7 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	The 24 conditions Level IV 8	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	The wheel across three lives 9 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	Kamma, death and rebirth Level V 10	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	Thirty-one planes 11 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12	Forty meditation subjects Level VI 12	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
13	The tree of purification 13 3D stories	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
14	One moment, every lens Level VII 14	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
15	Other maps; the threads 15 3D stories threads	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
16	One dhamma a day: the identity cards explorer cards	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
17	Review everything, then begin again at Level I deck	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Tick a box when you finish a session. Your ticks stay in this browser.

If a week is not enough

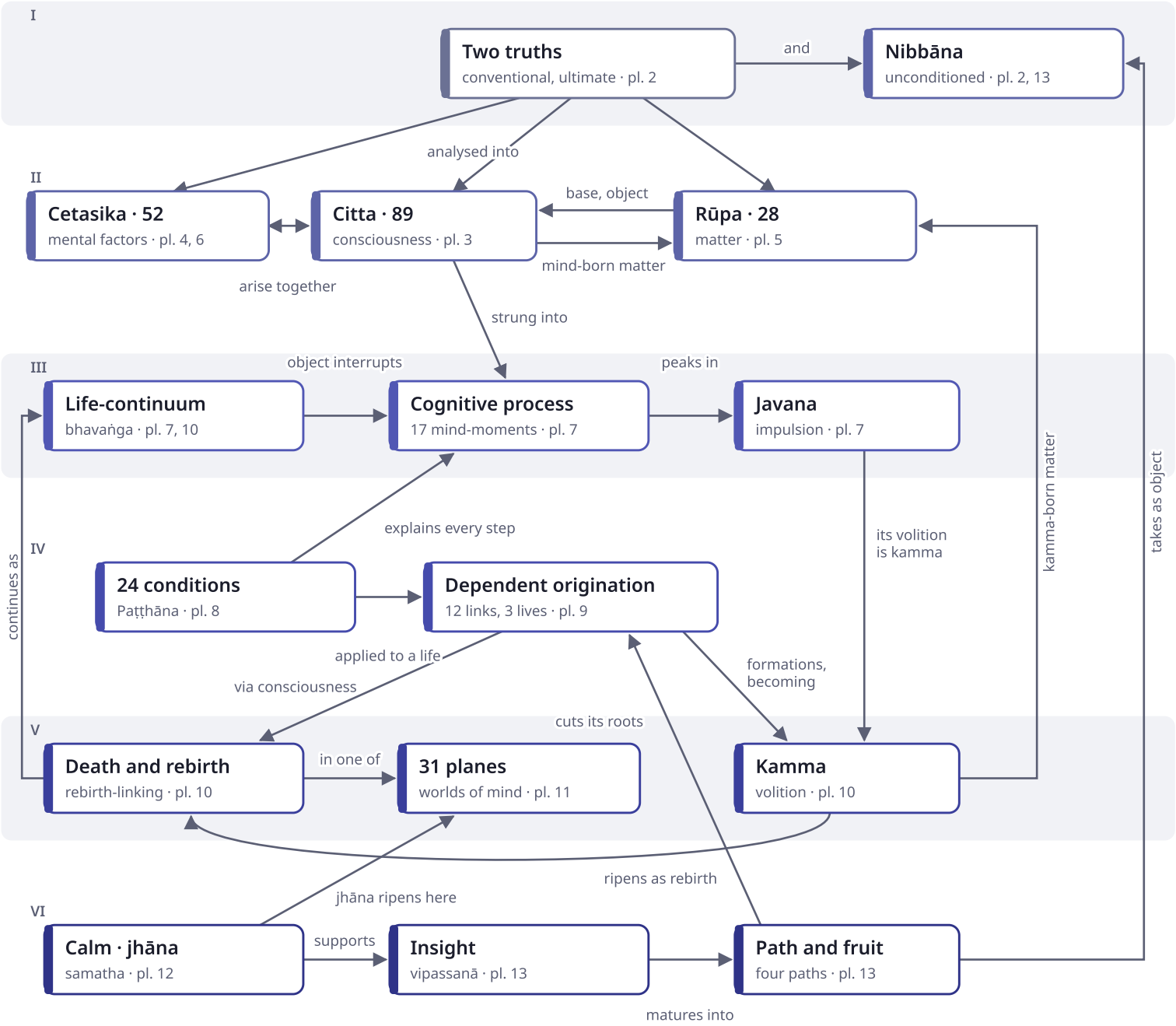
Take two. Plates 3, 7, 8 and 13 hold the most. The point is not to finish, but to know each plate well enough to redraw it and to find it in your day.

Studying with others

The tradition learns in pairs and classes. Take turns asking each other the Learn questions, and bring one Observe note each week. Disagreements about the Reflect questions are the best part.

How the main ideas connect

Sixteen main ideas and the relations that join them. Rows follow Levels I to VI, and each box names the plates that teach it. Read every arrow as a sentence: *Javana, its volition is kamma, Kamma.* Come back to this page after each level and you will find more of it makes sense.



THREE LOOPS WORTH TRACING ON THE MAP

The loop of a life

Kamma → Rebirth → Life-continuum → Process → Javana → Kamma

Each javana adds kamma; kamma shapes the next life; that life's moments make more javanas. → 7 → 10

Mind and matter hold each other up

Rūpa → Citta → Rūpa

Matter gives mind its bases and objects; mind gives matter its movements; kamma builds the sense organs. → 5 → 8

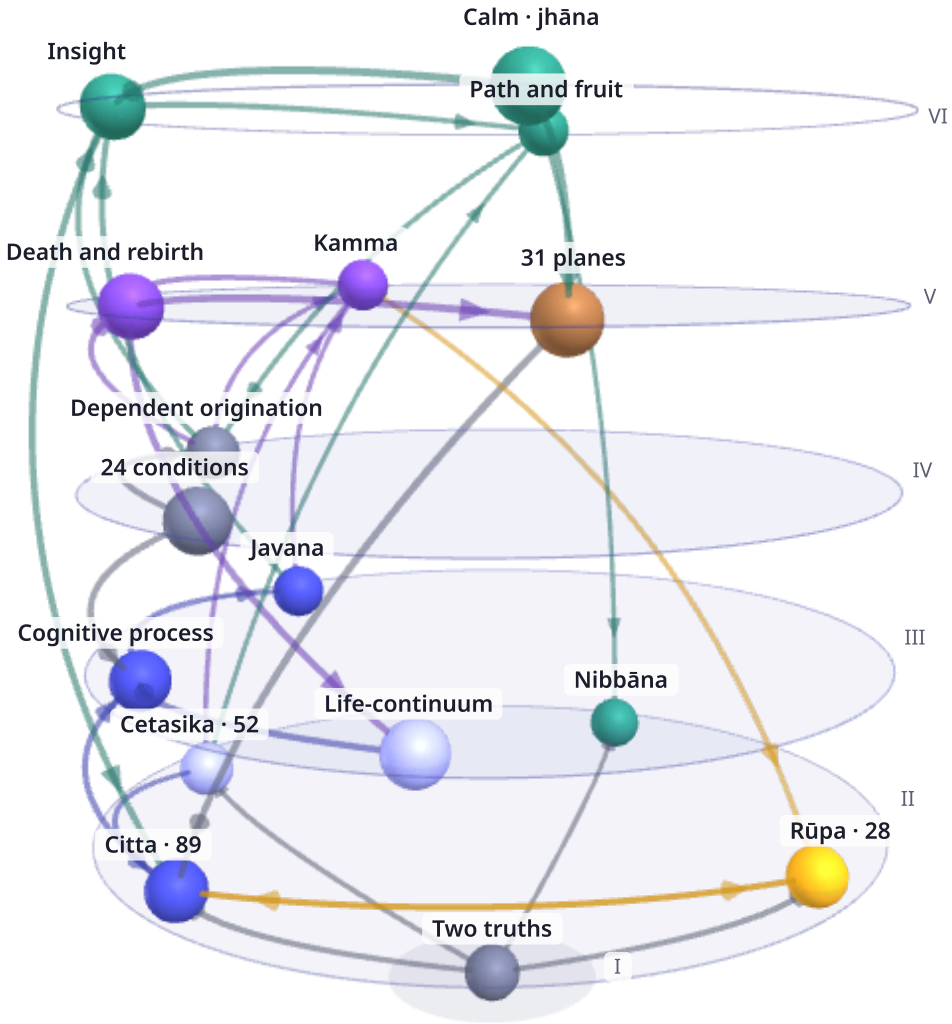
The way out

Calm → Insight → Path → Nibbāna

The path cuts ignorance and craving, the two roots of the wheel, so the first loop stops turning. → 9 → 13

The interconnection map in 3D

The sixteen main ideas of the atlas, lifted into three dimensions. Each level is a floor, rising from Foundations at the bottom to Practice at the top. Every line is a relation taught in the plates, coloured by kind. Turn the model to follow a thread, choose a loop, or choose an idea to light up everything it touches.



analysis within mind mind and matter kamma and rebirth the path

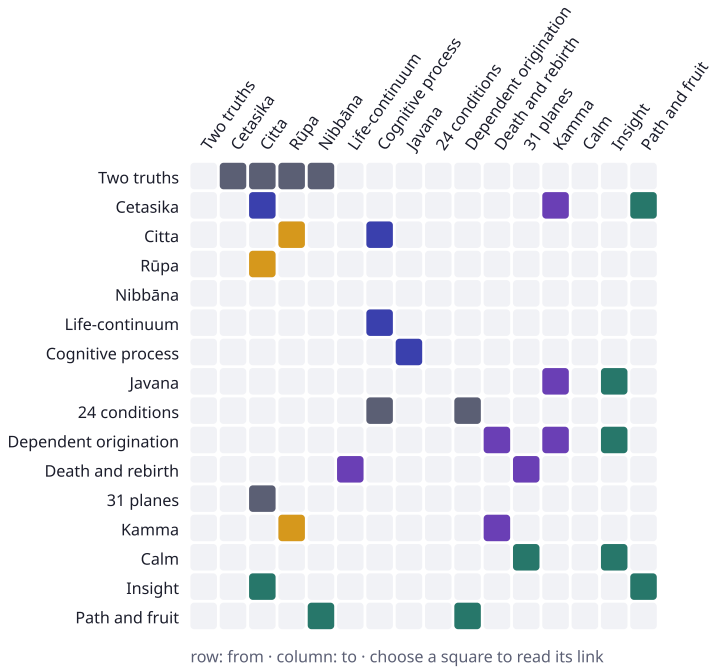
Selected: none. Choose an idea in the model, or a loop above. The 2D map has the same ideas, each with its own panel of links.

THE SIXTEEN IDEAS

- **Two truths** Conventional speech and ultimate analysis; the starting point. → 2
- **Citta · 89** Kinds of consciousness, each one moment of knowing. → 3
- **Nibbāna** The unconditioned; the object of path and fruition. → 2 → 13
- **Cognitive process** The fixed sequence in which cittas take an object. → 7
- **24 conditions** The ways in which one dhamma supports another. → 8
- **Death and rebirth** The hinge between one life and the next. → 10
- **Kamma** Volition, and the way it ripens. → 10
- **Insight** The knowledges that see mind and matter rise and fall. → 13
- **Cetasika · 52** The mental factors that colour each citta. → 4 → 6
- **Rūpa · 28** Kinds of matter, always in groups of eight or more. → 5
- **Life-continuum** The resultant citta that fills the gaps between processes. → 7 → 10
- **Javana** The active phase, where volition becomes kamma. → 7
- **Dependent origination** The twelve links, read across three lives. → 9
- **31 planes** The worlds, matched to levels of mind. → 11
- **Calm · jhāna** Concentration, from access to the five jhānas. → 12
- **Path and fruit** The four paths, with Nibbāna as their object. → 13

Every link explained

The matrix shows which idea leads to which: read across a row for what an idea gives rise to, down a column for what it depends on. The list beneath gives each relation in a sentence, with the plates that teach it.



row: from · column: to · choose a square to read its link

Reading the shape

- Links that point down, from a higher floor to a lower one, are where later teaching reaches back: kamma builds the body, insight sees mind and matter, the path cuts the roots of the wheel.
- **Citta** takes part in 7 links and **Dependent origination** in 5: they are the busiest ideas on the map.
- Three loops recur: kamma to rebirth to life-continuum to javana and back to kamma; matter to mind and back to matter; and calm to insight to path, which cuts the first loop at its roots.

ANALYSIS

Two truths → **Cetasika** *analysed into*. Ultimate analysis finds four kinds of reality; the mental factors (cetasika) are the second. → 2

Two truths → **Citta** *analysed into*. Consciousness (citta) is the first of the four realities. → 2

Two truths → **Rūpa** *analysed into*. Matter is the third. → 2

Two truths → **Nibbāna** *and the unconditioned*. Nibbāna is the fourth reality, and the only unconditioned one. → 2

24 conditions → **Cognitive process** *explains every step*. Each step of a process is held by specific conditions: proximity, support, object and more. → 8

24 conditions → **Dependent origination** *applied to a life*. The twelve links are related by the same 24 conditions. → 8 → 9

31 planes → **Citta** *each world its minds*. Each plane allows certain kinds of citta; the immaterial planes have no matter at all. → 3 → 11

WITHIN MIND

Cetasika → **Citta** *arise together*. A citta and its factors arise and cease together, with one object and one base. → 4

Citta → **Cognitive process** *strung into processes*. Cittas never occur at random; they follow fixed sequences. → 7

Life-continuum → **Cognitive process** *an object interrupts*. The life-continuum vibrates and is cut off when an object strikes. → 7

Cognitive process → **Javana** *peaks in*. A complete sense-sphere process usually culminates in seven javanas. → 7

MIND AND MATTER

Rūpa → **Citta** *base and object*. Matter supplies the six bases and the five sense objects. → 5 → 8

Citta → **Rūpa** *mind-born matter*. 75 kinds of citta produce matter as they arise: posture, gesture, speech. → 5 → 8

Kamma → **Rūpa** *kamma-born matter*. Past kamma produces the sense organs, sex, heart-base and life faculty. → 5 → 10

KAMMA AND REBIRTH

Javana → **Kamma** *its volition is kamma*. Wholesome or unwholesome volition in the javanas is new kamma. → 7 → 10

Cetasika → **Kamma** *volition is a factor*. Kamma is cetanā, one of the seven universal mental factors. → 4 → 10

Dependent origination → **Kamma** *formations and becoming*. Link 2, and the kamma side of link 10 (kamma-process becoming), are kamma. → 9

Dependent origination → **Death and rebirth** *via consciousness*. Link 3 is resultant consciousness, beginning with rebirth-linking. → 9 → 10

Kamma → **Death and rebirth** *ripens as rebirth*. Productive kamma produces the next rebirth-linking. → 10

Death and rebirth → **Life-continuum** *continues as*. The rebirth-linking citta recurs as the life-continuum for the whole life. → 7 → 10

Death and rebirth → **31 planes** *in one of 31*. Rebirth takes place in a plane that fits the ripening kamma. → 10 → 11

THE PATH

Calm → **31 planes** *jhāna ripens here*. Jhāna kamma ripens in the Brahmā planes. → 11 → 12

Calm → **Insight** *supports*. Concentration is a root of the tree of purification. → 12 → 13

Insight → **Citta** *sees mind and matter*. Insight begins by defining mind and matter, then watches them rise and fall. → 2 → 13

Dependent origination → **Insight** *discerning conditions*. Overcoming doubt, the fourth purification, is seeing the conditions of mind and matter. → 9 → 13

Insight → **Path and fruit** *matures into*. The insight knowledges culminate in path knowledge. → 13

Path and fruit → **Dependent origination** *cuts its roots*. The paths abandon ignorance and craving, the two roots of the wheel. → 9 → 13

Path and fruit → **Nibbāna** *takes as object*. Path and fruition cittas take Nibbāna as their object. → 2 → 13

Javana → **Insight** *where insight arises*. Insight knowledge arises in wholesome (for an arahant, functional) javanas of the mind-door process, taking mind and matter as object. → 7 → 13

Cetasika → **Path and fruit** *path factors are mental factors*. The factors of the path (wisdom, applied thought, the abstinences, energy, mindfulness, one-pointedness) are cetasikas arising in path consciousness. → 4 → 13

The Buddha's life as a map of the atlas

Every idea in these plates appears somewhere in a life story: the Bodhisatta's past lives in the Jātakas, and the last life of Siddhattha Gotama. Read down either line, follow the coloured plate numbers into the atlas, and use the story links to reach the retellings that close each level.

PAST LIVES · JĀTAKA AND BUDDHAVAṂSA

- Bv II — **Sumedha at Dīpaṅkara's feet** story
  the vow; four incalculable aeons of perfections begin
  10 11
- Ja 313 — **Khantivādi Jātaka** story
  patience under torture, without anger
  4 10
- Ja 407 — **Mahākapi Jātaka** story
  a monkey king's body as a bridge
  4
- Ja 9 — **Makhādeva Jātaka** story
  a first grey hair, and renunciation
  7 13
- Ja 538 — **Mūgapakkha Jātaka**
  Prince Temiya remembers a hell, and refuses the throne
  10 11
- Ja 541 — **Nimi Jātaka** story
  a chariot ride past the hells and heavens
  11
- Ja 547 — **Vessantara Jātaka** story
  the last human life before the final one: giving perfected
  10
- Jātaka introduction — **A deva in Tusita**
  waiting for the final birth
  11

↘ From Tusita to the final birth

THE LAST LIFE · SIDDHATTHA GOTAMA

- age 0 — **Birth at Lumbinī**
  rebirth-linking in the human world
  10
- childhood · MN 36 — **The rose-apple tree** story
  a child enters the first jhāna
  3 12
- age 29 — **Going forth**
  old age, sickness, death and a recluse
  13
- MN 26 — **Two teachers** story
  nothingness; neither perception nor non-perception
  11 12
- age 35 · MN 36, Ud 1 — **Awakening** story
  three watches of the night; dependent origination
  9 10 13
- commentary — **The Jewel House** story
  the fourth week: contemplating the Abhidhamma
  1 8
- SN 56.11 — **First sermon** story
  Koṇḍaññā: all that arises ceases
  13
- SN 22.59 — **Not-self**
  five monks become arahants
  2 13
- Vin Mv I.23 — **Assaji's verse** story
  Sāriputta hears of causes and their cessation
  8 9
- commentary — **A rains in Tāvatiṃsa** story
  the Abhidhamma taught to devas and his mother
  1 11
- MN 86 — **Aṅgulimāla** story
  a murderer becomes an arahant, and meets old kamma
  10
- age 80 · DN 16 — **Final Nibbāna** story
  through the jhānas, at Kusinārā
  3 13

Why stories belong in an Abhidhamma atlas

The Abhidhamma speaks in dhammas, not people. The commentaries that teach it, though, are full of people: the Atthasālinī and the Visuddhimagga constantly turn to the Buddha's life, his disciples and the Jātakas to show a dhamma at work. A story gives one concrete case; the plates give the general structure. Going back and forth between the two is the Reflect depth of this atlas.

LEVEL I OF VII · PLATES 1–2

I Foundations

What is the Abhidhamma, and what does it take apart?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | III · Process | IV · Relations | V · Lives and worlds | VI · Practice | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

No background is needed. A little familiarity with the five aggregates of the suttas helps.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

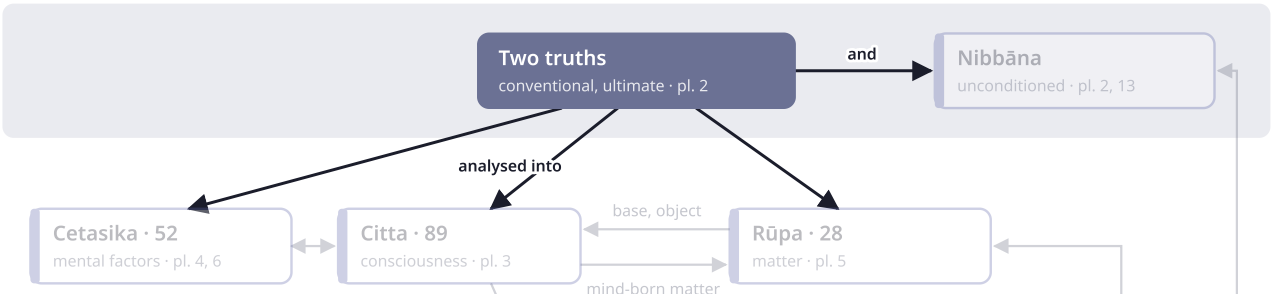
- Name the seven books and the main later works.
- Tell conventional truth from ultimate truth.
- Map the five aggregates onto the four ultimate realities.
- Read the four-part definition the commentaries give each dhamma.

1 The library
Seven books, and the commentaries and manuals that grew around them.

2 From a person to dhammas
How "a person" resolves into four kinds of ultimate reality.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. Name the four ultimate realities and how many kinds each has.
2. Which book analyses, and which one relates everything by condition?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. The Abhidhamma calls "chariot" a convention, not a falsehood. What would be lost if conventions were simply false?
2. Why might a four-part definition teach more than a one-line gloss?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Take one ordinary moment, such as drinking tea, and list which of the five aggregates were present in it.

Common confusions

≠ "Ultimate" does not mean hidden or permanent. Conditioned dhammas are momentary events, and they are exactly what is directly experienced. Nibbāna, the one unconditioned dhamma, is not an event in time.

≠ The Abhidhamma does not throw persons away. One of its seven books, the Puggalapaññatti, is about types of people.

I Foundations · Start of the path · Leads to 2 · 3D view

Seven books, and the shelves that grew around them

The Abhidhamma Piṭaka is the third basket of the Pāli Canon. Its first book takes experience apart. Its last book puts the parts back together as a web of conditions. Nearly everything written since is commentary, summary or teaching aid for these seven.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Dhammasaṅgaṇī	*Vibhaṅga*	*Dhātukathā*	*Puggalapaññatti*	*Kathāvatthu*	*Yamaka*	*Paṭṭhāna*
Enumeration of phenomena Opens with the mātikā, 22 triads and 100 dyads, then analyses each kind of citta into its factors.	**Book of analysis** Eighteen chapters, most treated by the sutta method, the Abhidhamma method and by questions.	**Discussion of elements** Shows how each dhamma is included in, or excluded from, the aggregates, bases and elements.	**Designation of persons** Types of people. The one book about conventional rather than ultimate reality.	**Points of controversy** Refutes the views of other early schools in debate form.	**Book of pairs** Pins down the scope of each term with paired, converse questions.	**Conditional relations** Applies 24 conditions to every dhamma. The largest book, called the Great Treatise.

← **analysis**: breaking wholes into dhammas · **synthesis**: relating dhammas by condition →

THERAVĀDA: EACH LAYER COMMENTS ON THE ONE ABOVE

Canon c. 3rd–1st c. BCE
- Abhidhamma Piṭaka, 7 books
- Kathāvatthu attributed to Moggaliputta Tissa, Third Council
- written down in Sri Lanka, 1st c. BCE

Commentaries 5th c. CE
- *Atthasālinī* on the Dhammasaṅgaṇī
- *Sammohavinodanī* on the Vibhaṅga
- *Pañcappakaraṇa-aṭṭhakathā* on the other five
- *Visuddhimagga* (all by Buddhaghosa)
- *Abhidhammāvatāra*, Buddhadatta

Subcommentaries after the 5th c.
- *Mūlaṭīkā*, Ānanda
- *Anuṭīkā*, Dhammapāla

Manuals c. 10th–12th c.
- *Abhidhammattha Saṅgaha*, Anuruddha
- *Vibhāvinī-ṭīkā*, Sumaṅgala, late 12th c.

Burmese revival 1890s
- *Paramatthadīpanī*, Ledi Sayadaw: disputes the Vibhāvinī on 245 points

In English 1949–2010
- Nyanaponika, *Abhidhamma Studies* 1949
- Nārada, *A Manual of Abhidhamma* 1956
- van Gorkom, *Abhidhamma in Daily Life* 1975
- Bodhi (ed.), *A Comprehensive Manual* 1993
- Mehm Tin Mon, *The Essence of Buddhist Abhidhamma* 1995
- Karunadasa, *The Theravāda Abhidhamma* 2010

A PARALLEL SHELF: NORTHERN ABHIDHARMA

- Sarvāstivāda: seven treatises, led by the *Jñānaprasthāna*
- *Mahāvibhāṣā*, c. 2nd c. CE
- *Abhidharmakośa*, Vasubandhu, c. 4th–5th c.
- Yogācāra: Asaṅga's *Abhidharmasamuccaya*; the hundred dharmas

These lists grew from the same early matrices (*mātikā*) but reached different counts. Plate 15 sets them side by side. → 15

Dates before the modern period are approximate and some are disputed. Anuruddha's date, for example, is placed anywhere from the 8th to the 12th century; most modern scholars favour the 10th–12th.

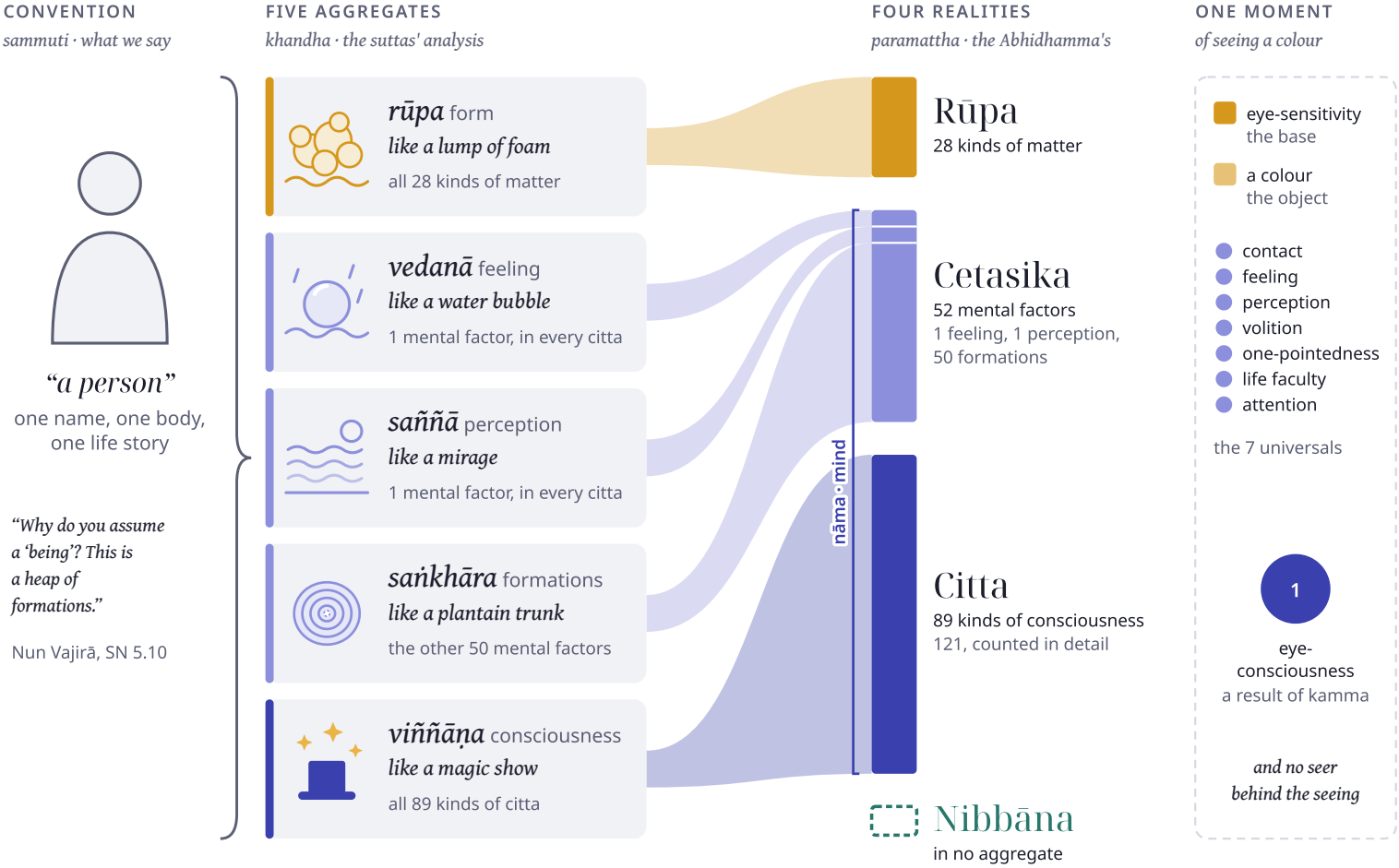
Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* introduction; Encyclopaedia entries on the Abhidhamma literature

I Foundations Builds on 1 Leads to 3 · 4 · 5 3D view

citta · feeling · contact · matter · Nibbāna

From a person to dhammas

Ordinary speech talks about people, chariots and mangoes. That is conventional truth (*sammuti-sacca*), and it is not false. The Abhidhamma adds a second level, ultimate truth (*paramattha-sacca*): the irreducible events, or *dhammas*, that the conventions are built from. The suttas' five aggregates are the bridge between the two.



Read from left to right, as three steps of magnification. Looked at closely, a person is five aggregates. Looked at more closely, the aggregates are four kinds of ultimate reality. One moment of experience holds only a few of them.

Similes from the Pheṇapiṇḍūpama Sutta (SN 22.95). Band widths at the right are proportional to the number of kinds of dhamma; feeling and perception, one factor each, are drawn at a minimum width. Each reality has its own plate: citta → 3, cetasika → 4, rūpa → 5; the moment of seeing returns on Plate 7 → 7.

The chariot

"Chariot" is the name used when axle, wheels, frame and pole are assembled; no chariot is found apart from them. In the same way, "a being" is the convention used when the aggregates are present. Nun Vajirā says this in the Saṃyutta Nikāya, and Nāgasena makes the same point to King Milinda.

The texts add a wordplay. The Buddha says *rūpa*, matter, is so called because it is "afflicted" (*ruppati*) by cold, heat, hunger and thirst; the commentaries add that *nāma*, mind, is so called because it bends (*namati*) toward its object.

SN 5.10; SN 22.79; Milindapañha II.1; Visuddhimagga XVIII

How the commentaries define a dhamma

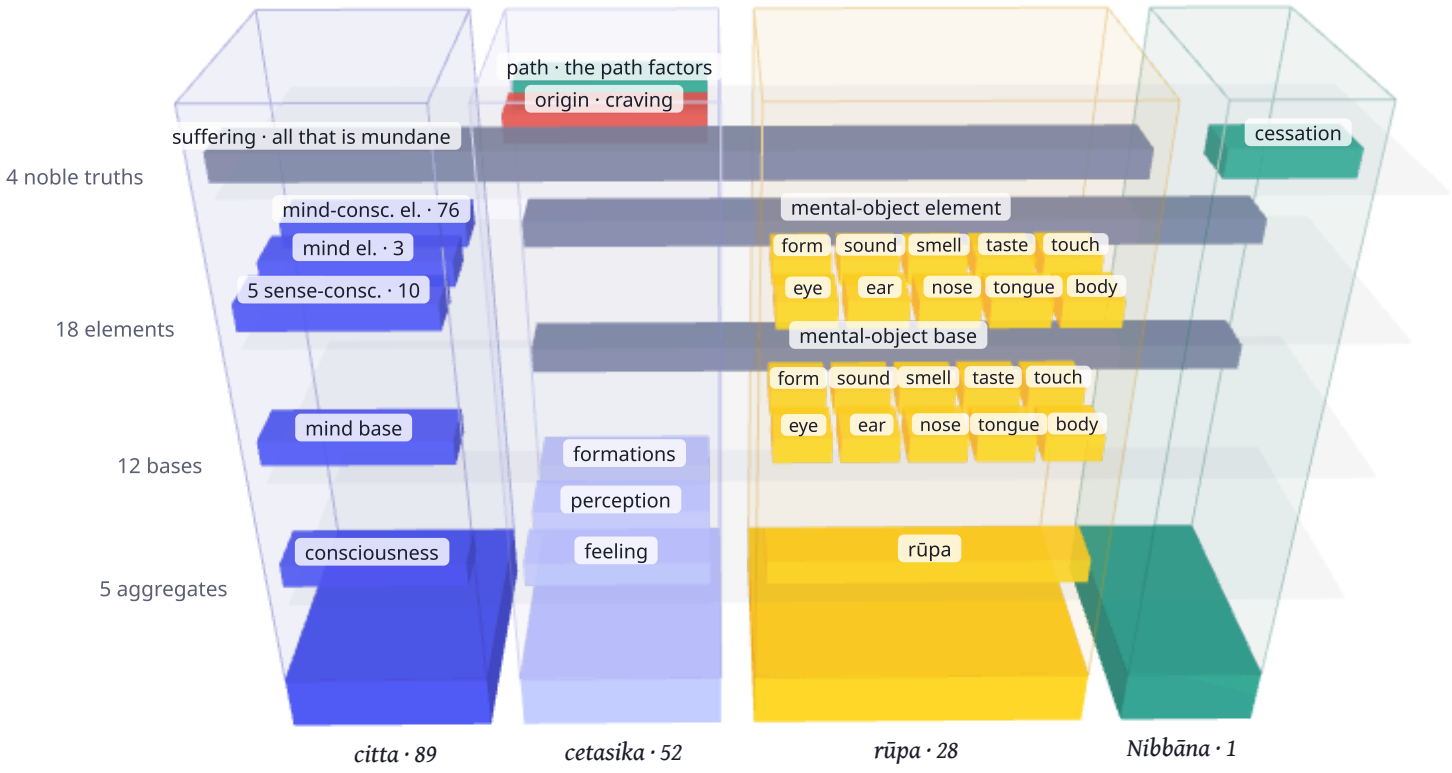
The commentaries give each dhamma they define the same four-part "identity card". Learn the template once and every definition in the Atthasālinī and Visuddhimagga becomes easy to read. Sixteen cards are collected on the Identity cards page cards.

- **Characteristic** (*lakkhaṇa*): its own nature
- **Function** (*rasa*): what it does
- **Manifestation** (*paccupaṭṭhāna*): how it shows up in experience
- **Proximate cause** (*padaṭṭhāna*): what it most directly depends on

I Foundations Models for plates 1–2

The categories, mapped

The suttas describe experience with overlapping lists: five aggregates, twelve bases, eighteen elements, four noble truths. The Abhidhamma shows that every item on every list is made of the same four realities. Here the realities are glass columns; each list is a shelf, and each item sits over the columns it is made of. An item that bridges several columns contains several kinds of reality.



Five aggregates

Rūpa is all 28 kinds of matter. Feeling and perception are one mental factor each, and formations are the other 50. Consciousness is all 89 cittas. Nibbāna belongs to no aggregate.

Twelve bases

Ten bases are matter: five sense organs and five objects. The mind base is all 89 cittas. The mental-object base gathers the rest: the 52 factors, the 16 subtle kinds of matter, and Nibbāna.

Eighteen elements

As the bases, but the mind base splits into seven: five sense-consciousness elements (10 cittas), the mind element (3: five-door adverting and the two receiving cittas) and the mind-consciousness element (the other 76).

Four noble truths

Suffering is everything mundane, the mind and matter of the three planes. Its origin is craving, which the Abhidhamma identifies with the factor greed. Cessation is Nibbāna. The path is the eight path factors, mental factors that arise together in path consciousness (seven in paths of the second jhāna and above, which lack right intention).

Gross and subtle matter: the five organs and seven objects (touch counting as earth, fire and air) are the 12 gross kinds of matter; the other 16 are subtle and are known only at the mind door.

I Foundations Retells and reads plates 1–2 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Foundations in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE — Atthasālinī, introduction

Where the Abhidhamma was first taught

The commentary tells that the Buddha spent a rainy season in the Tāvatiṃsa heaven, teaching the Abhidhamma to the devas, among them his mother, reborn as a deva. Each day he came down to Lake Anotatta, where he gave Sāriputta the outline, and Sāriputta taught it to five hundred monks. At the end of the rains he descended at Saṅkassa. The Tipiṭaka itself does not tell this story.

READ WITH THE ATLAS This is the tradition's account of where the seven books of Plate 1 came from, and why Sāriputta is honoured as the first teacher of the Abhidhamma. → 1 → 11

REFLECT *Why might a tradition place the first teaching of the Abhidhamma among devas rather than humans?*

JĀTAKA — Jātaka, closing identification

The last line of every Jātaka

Each Jātaka ends by naming who was who: “At that time, so-and-so was the king, and I myself was the ascetic.” One continuity is followed across many lives as if it were one person.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Conventional truth at work (Plate 2). Ultimately there is only a stream of cittas and matter, each moment conditioning the next. “The Bodhisatta” names the stream: neither the same person, nor a different one. → 2 → 10

REFLECT *What does the word “I” refer to in “I was the ascetic”?*

DISCIPLES — SN 22.87

Vakkali and the body

The monk Vakkali longed to keep looking at the Buddha. The Buddha said: “Enough, Vakkali. What is there to see in this foul body? Whoever sees the Dhamma sees me.”

READ WITH THE ATLAS Even “the Buddha” is a convention for aggregates. What is really to be seen are dhammas and their characteristics, the shift Plate 2 asks of you. → 2

REFLECT *What would it mean to see a teacher in dhammas rather than as a person?*

DISCIPLES — SN 5.10

Nun Vajirā's chariot

Māra asked the nun Vajirā who had created “this being”. She answered: “Why do you assume a being? This is a heap of formations. As the word ‘chariot’ is used when the parts are assembled, so ‘a being’ is the convention when the aggregates are present.”

READ WITH THE ATLAS Her reply is the hinge of Plate 2: the five aggregates on the left of its diagram, the convention “a being” on top of them. → 2

REFLECT *Is Vajirā saying that beings do not exist, or saying what the word refers to?*

II

LEVEL II OF VII · PLATES 3–6

Elements

What is experience made of?

I · Foundations | **II · Elements** | III · Process | IV · Relations | V · Lives and worlds | VI · Practice | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Level I: the four realities and the two truths.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

- Place any citta by plane, ethical kind and feeling.
- Tell the 7 universals from the 6 occasionals, and say why unwholesome and beautiful factors never meet.
- Name the four origins of matter and the eight inseparables.
- Explain contact, feeling, perception or volition with a commentarial simile.

3 A map of the 89

3b What each citta does

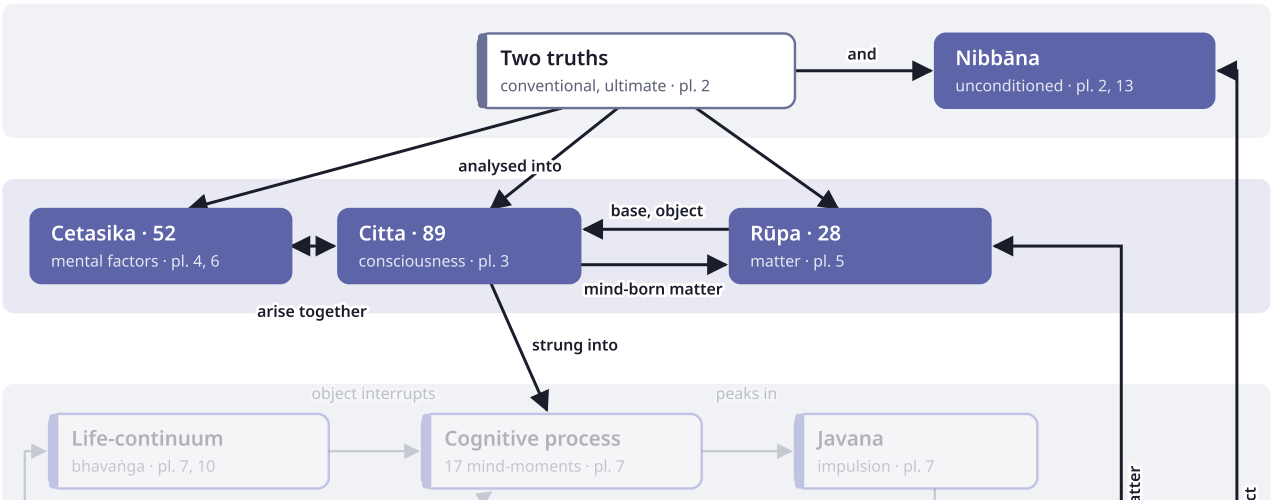
4 The 52 factors as an ensemble

4b Which factors meet which cittas

5 How matter is made

6 The commentators' picture-book

In 3D · In the stories
Models to turn, then episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. Name the seven universal factors.
2. Which four things produce matter, and which kinds does only kamma produce?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. Displeasure appears only in the two hate-rooted cittas. What does that suggest about mental pain and aversion?
2. Feeling is a universal factor. Can any moment of mind be entirely without feeling-tone?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Note the feeling-tone of the next ten things you see: pleasant, unpleasant or neutral.
2. When irritation arises, look for pleasure in the very same moment. Can you find it, or do they alternate?

Common confusions

≠ Vedanā is not emotion. It is only the pleasant, painful or neutral tone of a moment; an emotion is a complex of many factors.

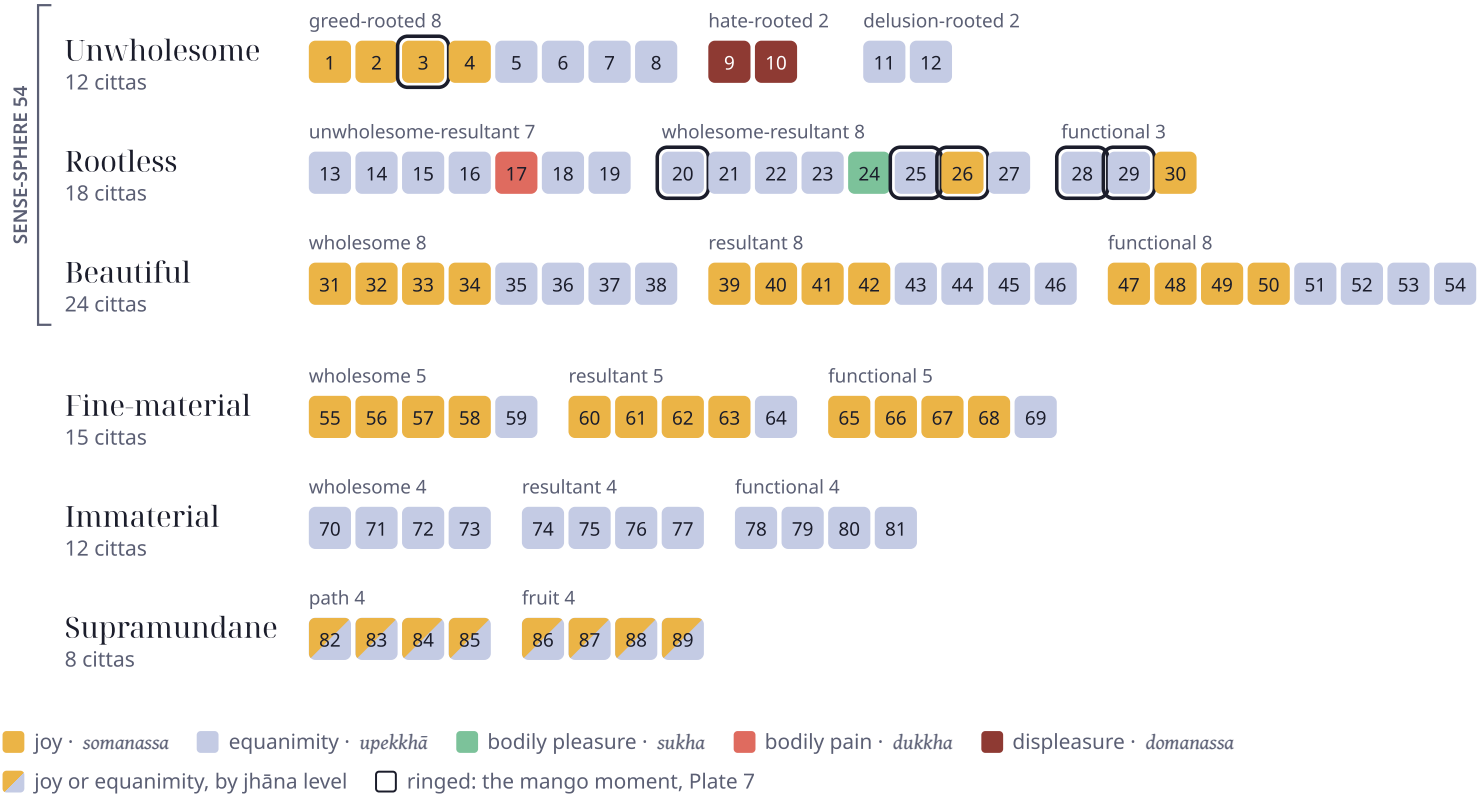
≠ Rūpa is not just visible form. It includes the sense organs, sound, the heart-base and nutritive essence.

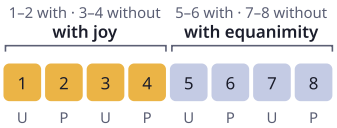
≠ Citta and its factors are not separate things that meet. They arise together, cease together and share one object and one base.

II Elements Builds on 2 Leads to 4 · 6 · 7 · 11 · 12 3D view citta feeling jhāna

A map of the 89, coloured by feeling

The usual chart sorts consciousness by plane and by ethical quality. Colour it by the feeling (*vedanā*) that each citta carries and a pattern appears: most kinds of mundane citta are neutral (47 of 81), joy is common in wholesome states, and pain and displeasure are surprisingly rare.



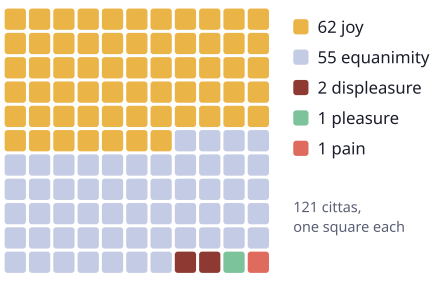


Blocks of eight (#1–8, 31–38, 39–46, 47–54) run alike. **With**: wrong view (greed) or knowledge (beautiful). **U** unprompted, **P** prompted, arising with urging.

Unwholesome. 9–10 hate (unprompted, prompted); 11 delusion with doubt; 12 delusion with restlessness.

Rootless. 13–17 eye, ear, nose, tongue, body consciousness; 18 receiving; 19 investigating. 20–27 the same, wholesome-resultant, with investigating twice (26 joy, 27 equanimity). 28 five-door adverting, 29 mind-door adverting, 30 the arahant's smile.

Higher. Jhāna blocks run 1st to 5th jhāna; immaterial: infinite space, infinite consciousness, nothingness, neither perception nor non-perception; path and fruit: stream-entry, once-return, non-return, arahantship.



What the colours say

- Counted as 121, joy accompanies 62 cittas and equanimity 55. Only four cittas carry any other feeling.
- Bodily pleasure and bodily pain occur in exactly one citta each: wholesome-resultant and unwholesome-resultant body-consciousness.
- Displeasure occurs only in the two hate-rooted cittas. Wherever there is displeasure, there is aversion.
- Every immaterial citta is equanimous, and so is the fifth jhāna. The higher the concentration, the quieter the feeling.
- The fine-material and immaterial rows are the minds of jhāna. Each has its own worlds → 11 and its own meditation subjects → 12. What each citta does is on the next sheet → 3b.

II Elements Continues 3 Leads to 7

What each citta does

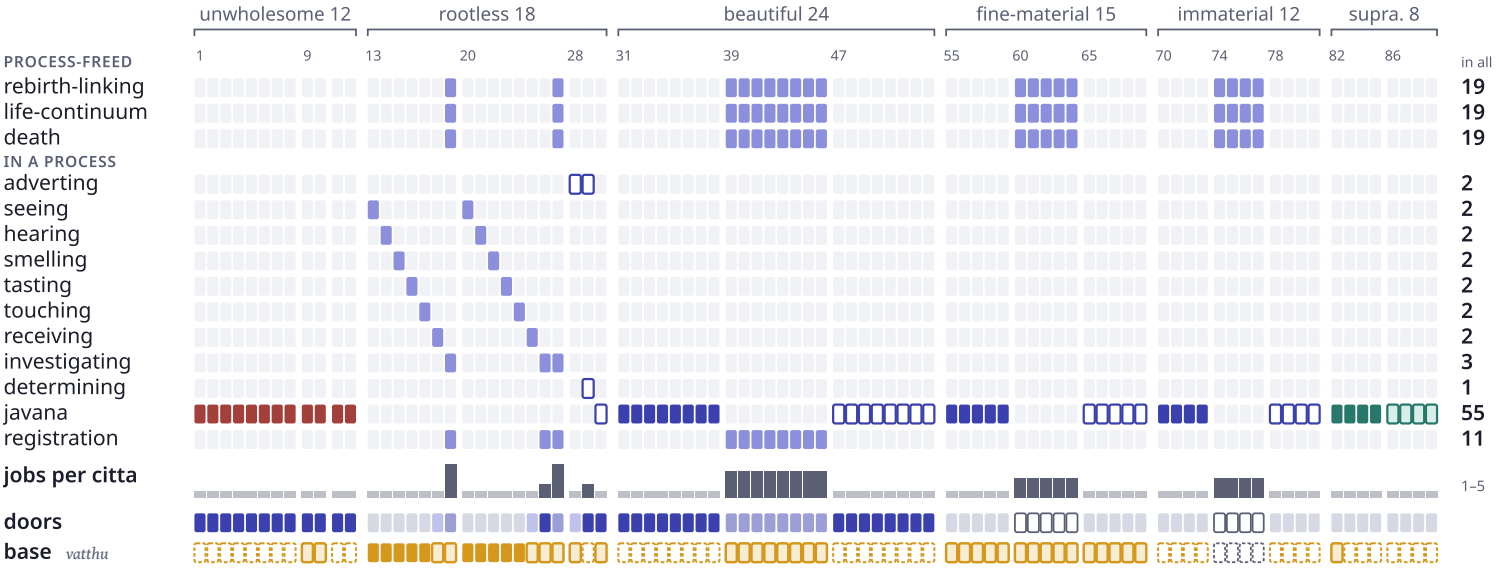
Plate 3 sorted the 89 by what they are. Chapter III of the Saṅgaha asks what they do: which of fourteen jobs each can perform, through which doors it knows, and on which physical base it stands. This is the bridge from the map of the 89 to the moments of Plate 7.

ON A FIVE-DOOR TRACK (PLATE 7): HOW MANY CITTAS CAN FILL EACH SLOT

life-continuum	adverting	seeing	receiving	investigating	determining	javana ×7	registration ×2	life-continuum
1 of 19	1	2	2	3	1	29	11	1
this life's own	#28	#13 · 20	#18 · 25	#19 · 26 · 27	#29	#1–12 · 30 · 31–38 · 47–54	#19 · 26 · 27 · 39–46	the same one

the number in each slot: how many of the 89 can fill it on an eye-door track (any one sense door: 46 cittas in all)

THE 89, NUMBERED AS ON PLATE 3, AGAINST THE FOURTEEN JOBS



unwholesome · wholesome · resultant · functional · path · fruit · **doors:** one · five · six · six or none · door-freed

base: its own sense organ · heart · heart, or none (immaterial planes) · none

The busiest cittas

68 cittas do one job. Two do five: the equanimous investigating cittas #19 and #27 investigate and register, and are the rebirth-linking, life-continuum and death of beings reborn without roots. The eight great resultants (#39–46) do four, the nine sublime resultants three.

Doors

A door is where a process meets its object: the five sensitivities, which are matter (Plate 5), and the mind door, the life-continuum itself. 46 cittas can arise through the eye door, 67 through the mind door; 19 are door-freed, because rebirth-linking, life-continuum and death happen outside any process.

Physical bases

Every citta in a body stands on a base (*vatthu*, not the *āyatana* of Plate 2): the ten sense consciousnesses on their own organ, the rest on the heart-base. The sense sphere has all six bases, the fine-material planes three (eye, ear, heart), the immaterial planes none, so four cittas never need one.

Objects: what each kind of citta can know

25 sense-sphere objects only: the 23 sense-sphere resultants, five-door adverting, the smile

5 anything but arahant path and fruit: great wholesome with knowledge, and fifth-jhāna wholesome as direct knowledge

21 a concept: the 15 fine-material cittas and the first and third immaterial (×3)

20 any mundane object: the 12 unwholesome and the 8 great wholesome and functional without knowledge

6 any object: great functional with knowledge, fifth-jhāna functional, mind-door adverting

6 a sublime citta: the second and fourth immaterial (×3) · **8** Nibbāna: path and fruit

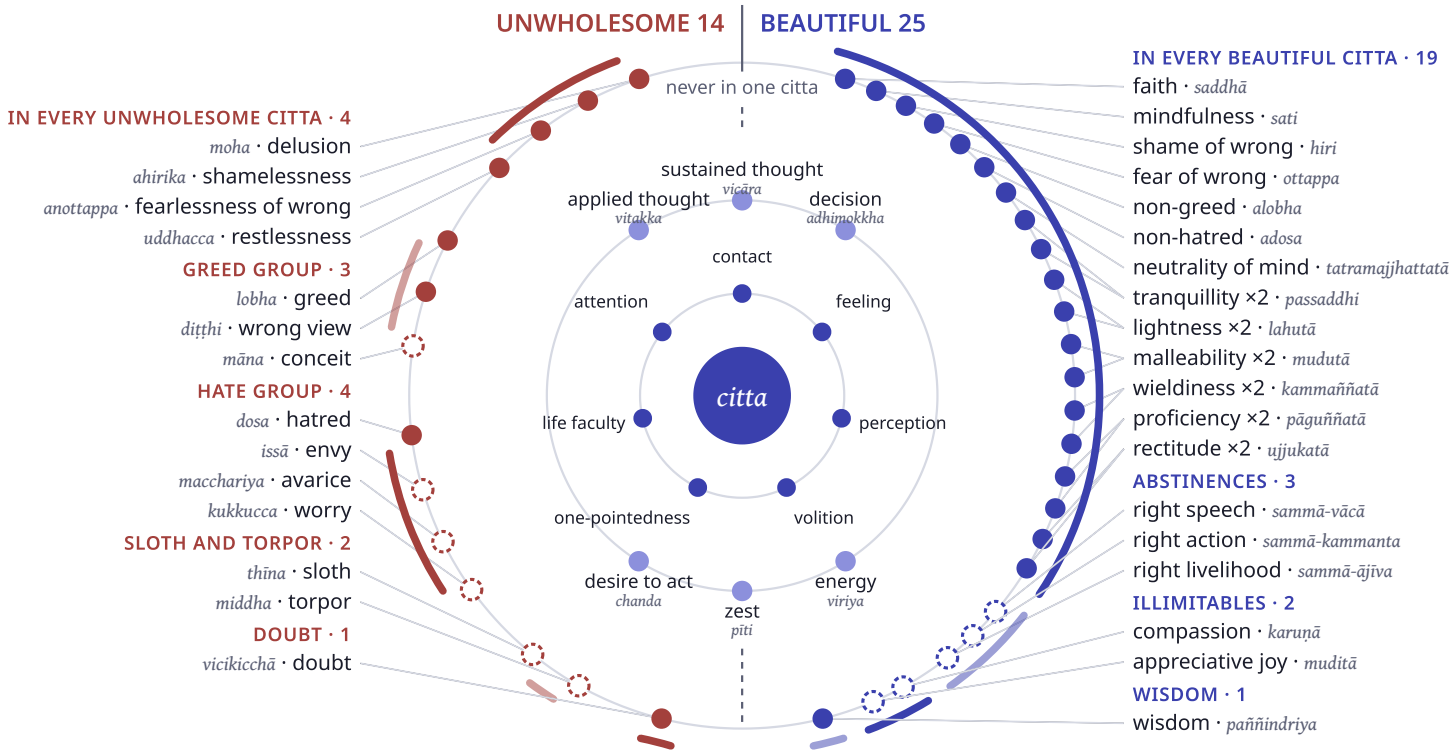
Five-door cittas take only present objects; mind-door cittas any time, or none. The counts sum to 91: #59 and #69 fall in two classes.

Source: Bodhi, *CMA* III §§8–22; counts derived from the Saṅgaha's rules and checked against its stated totals

II Elements Builds on 2 · 3 Leads to 6 · 7 3D view citta feeling contact kamma roots jhāna wisdom

The 52 mental factors as an ensemble

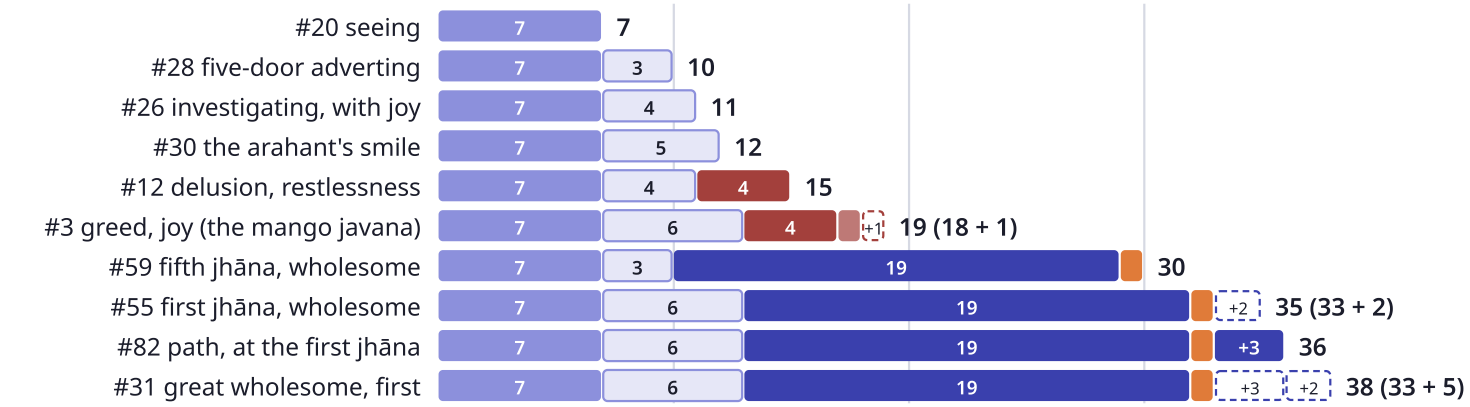
Picture the factors as players gathered around citta. Seven play in every moment of mind; six more join either side when the music calls for them. The two outer families, unwholesome and beautiful, never play in the same moment.



inner ring: 7 universals, in every citta · middle: 6 occasionals, either side · ×2: of the mental body and of the mind fixed: always joins its cittas

unfixed: joins only sometimes (*aniyatayogī*), 11 in all unwholesome

HOW MANY FACTORS JOIN EACH KIND OF CITTA (NUMBERS AS ON PLATE 3)



7 universals occasionals unwholesome 19 beautiful universals wisdom +3 in path: the abstinences, always present

may join, one at a time

Reading the +2 and the +5

+3: the abstinences (right speech, action, livelihood) join a mundane citta only when one is refraining from a wrong; in path consciousness all three are always there. +2: compassion and appreciative joy, when the object is a being in pain or in success. One at a time, so at most 34 are present at once. → 14

Why the families never meet

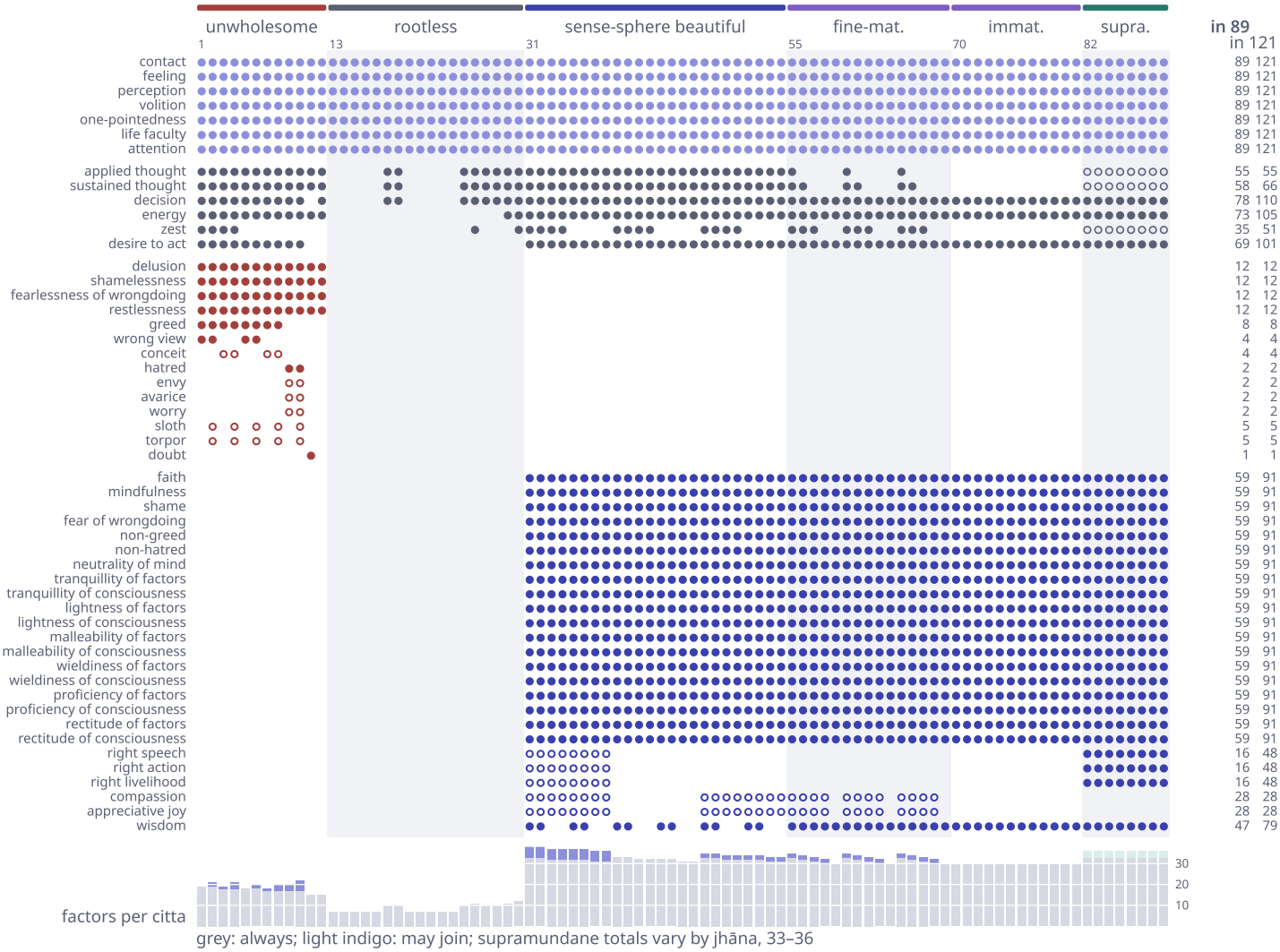
Each family has its own universals: four in every unwholesome citta, nineteen in every beautiful one. They come in opposed pairs, shame against shamelessness, non-greed against greed, so one citta with one object cannot hold both. The occasionals have no opposite and take either side. A reading of CMA II.

Source: Bodhi, *CMA* II (association and combination of mental factors)

II Elements Continues 3 · 4 Leads to 6 · 7

Which factors meet which cittas

Chapter II reads one table two ways. Across a row, the method of association: which cittas a factor joins. Down a column, the method of combination: which factors a citta takes. Rows follow Plate 4, columns Plate 3's numbering.



grey: always; light indigo: may join; supramundane totals vary by jhāna, 33–36

Read across a row for the cittas a factor joins; read down a column for the factors a citta takes. Citta 31, the great wholesome citta with joy and knowledge, takes the most: 38 counted, 34 at most at once.

■ always present (fixed) ☐ may be present (one of the 11 unfixed) ☐ by jhāna, in path and fruit cittas

The two families never meet

The 14 unwholesome and the 25 beautiful factors never share a citta: their dots never fall in the same column. An unwholesome citta takes at most 22 factors; a great wholesome one 38 counted, but at most 34 at once.

The 11 unfixed factors join only sometimes: envy, avarice and worry, one at a time, in the hate-rooted cittas; the three abstinences, one at a time when refraining from a wrong (all three in path and fruit); compassion and appreciative joy; conceit, in greed-rooted cittas without wrong view; sloth and torpor, together, in the prompted unwholesome cittas.

Counting a column

supramundane	**36 · 35 · 34 · 33 · 33**
sublime	**35 · 34 · 33 · 32 · 30**
great wholesome	**38 · 37 · 37 · 36**
great resultant	**33 · 32 · 32 · 31**
great functional	**35 · 34 · 34 · 33**
unwholesome	**19 (21) · 19 (21) · 18 (20) · 18 (20) · 20 (22) · 15 · 15**
rootless	**12 · 11 · 10 · 7**

The margins give each factor's count out of 89 and out of 121; the Saṅgaha's own verse prints 55, 66, 78, 73, 51 and 69 for the six particulars, mixing the two bases.

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* II §§10–30; the round-2 research tables, derived from the Saṅgaha's inclusion rules

II Elements · Builds on 2 · Leads to 6 · 7 · 3D view · kamma · matter · time

How matter is made

Four things produce matter: kamma, mind, temperature and nutriment. The matrix shows which kinds each one makes. Matter never arises alone; it comes in packets called *kalāpas*, and every packet carries the same eight inseparables.

		kamma	mind	temp.	food	none
CONCRETE 18	*pathavī*	earth	■	■	■	■	·
	āpo	water	■	■	■	■	·
	tejo	fire	■	■	■	■	·
	vāyo	air	■	■	■	■	·
	cakkhu	eye-sensitivity	■	·	·	·	·
	sota	ear-sensitivity	■	·	·	·	·
	ghāna	nose-sensitivity	■	·	·	·	·
	jivhā	tongue-sensitivity	■	·	·	·	·
	kāya	body-sensitivity	■	·	·	·	·
	vaṇṇa	visible form	■	■	■	■	·
	sadda	sound	·	■	■	·	·
	gandha	smell	■	■	■	■	·
	rasa	taste	■	■	■	■	·
	itthibhāva	femininity	■	·	·	·	·
	purisabhāva	masculinity	■	·	·	·	·
	hadaya	heart-base	■	·	·	·	·
	jīvita	life faculty	■	·	·	·	·
	ojā	nutritive essence	■	■	■	■	·
NON-CONCRETE 10	*ākāsa*	space	■	■	■	■	·
	kāya-viññatti	bodily intimation	·	■	·	·	·
	vacī-viññatti	vocal intimation	·	■	·	·	·
	lahutā	lightness	·	■	■	■	·
	mudutā	malleability	·	■	■	■	·
	kammaññatā	wieldiness	·	■	■	■	·
	upacaya	production	·	·	·	·	■
	santati	continuity	·	·	·	·	■
	jaratā	decay	·	·	·	·	■
	aniccatā	impermanence	·	·	·	·	■
	kinds produced		18	15	13	12	4

ONE UNIT OF MATTER OUTLIVES SEVENTEEN CITTAS

17 CITTAS × 3 SUB-MOMENTS

presence · 49 sub-moments

↑ arising: 1 dissolution: 1 ↑

Matter is slow to change, so many minds pass over one body.

THE 21 KALĀPAS

Kamma-born · 9

- eye-decad + life, eye
- ear-decad + life, ear
- nose-decad + life, nose
- tongue-decad + life, tongue
- body-decad + life, body
- female-decad + life, fem.
- male-decad + life, masc.
- heart-base decad + life, heart
- vital nonad + life

Mind-born · 6

- pure octad
- bodily intimation nonad + b.int
- vocal intimation decad + v.int, sound
- undecad of mutability
- bodily int. + mutability
- vocal int. + sound + mut.

Temperature-born · 4

- pure octad
- sound nonad + sound
- undecad of mutability
- sound + mutability

Nutriment-born · 2

- pure octad
- undecad of mutability

□ the eight inseparables ■ added kinds

Space separates the kalāpas, and the four characteristics only mark their arising and decay, so neither is counted inside a group. Kamma-born matter is where this plate meets Plate 10 (→ 10); mind-born matter is how javanas move the body (→ 7).

The commentators' picture-book

The canonical Abhidhamma is lists and tables. The commentaries brought it to life with similes. Each one is chosen to show a single property, not to tell a whole story, so it pays to ask what the picture is pointing at.

Three people look at a heap of coins



A child sees shapes and colours but does not know the coins are money. A villager knows they are money and can be spent. A money-changer knows which are genuine, which are false, where they were struck and what they weigh. So perception (*saññā*) notes the surface, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) knows the object as such, and understanding (*paññā*) penetrates its characteristics.

Visuddhimagga XIV, on "in what sense is it understanding?"

Contact *phassa*

Two rams butting heads: one is the eye, one is the visible object, and their meeting is contact. Or two hands clapping.

Milindapañha → 4 → 9

Feeling *vedanā*

A cook tastes a dish while preparing it; the king enjoys the whole meal. Other factors touch the object's taste in passing. Feeling, as master, enjoys it fully.

Atthasālinī → 3 → 9

Perception *saññā*

A carpenter marks his timber so he can recognise it later. Perception makes a sign, so that next time it can say, "this is the same".

Visuddhimagga XIV → 4

Volition *cetanā*

A head pupil recites his own lesson and makes the others recite theirs. Volition does its own work and sets the other factors to theirs.

Atthasālinī → 4 → 10

Applied and sustained thought *vitakka, vicāra*

Striking a bell, and its ringing on. A bird spreading its wings to take off, and gliding. A bee diving onto a lotus, and moving over it once landed.

Visuddhimagga IV; Milindapañha has a gong → 12

Mind and matter *nāma-rūpa*

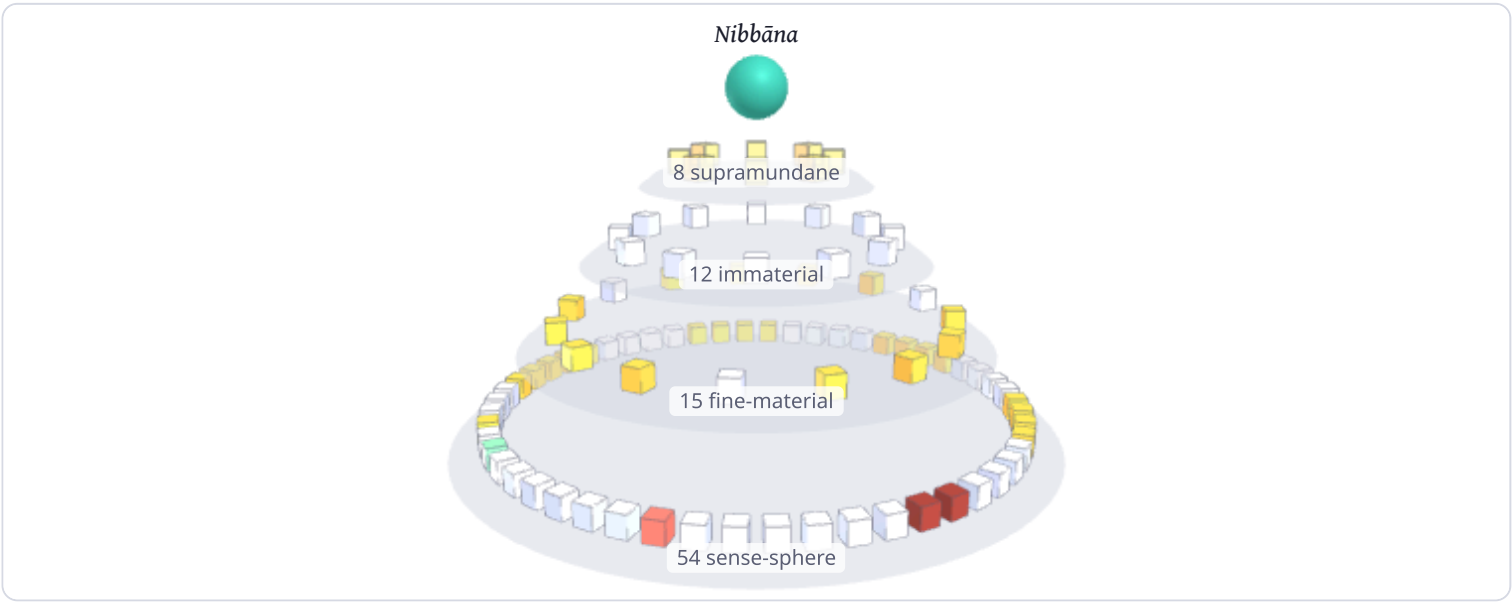
A blind man carrying a lame man who can see: neither can travel alone. Also a puppet that moves only through wood and strings, and two sheaves of reeds propped against each other.

Visuddhimagga XVIII → 5 → 13

II Elements Models for plates 3–6

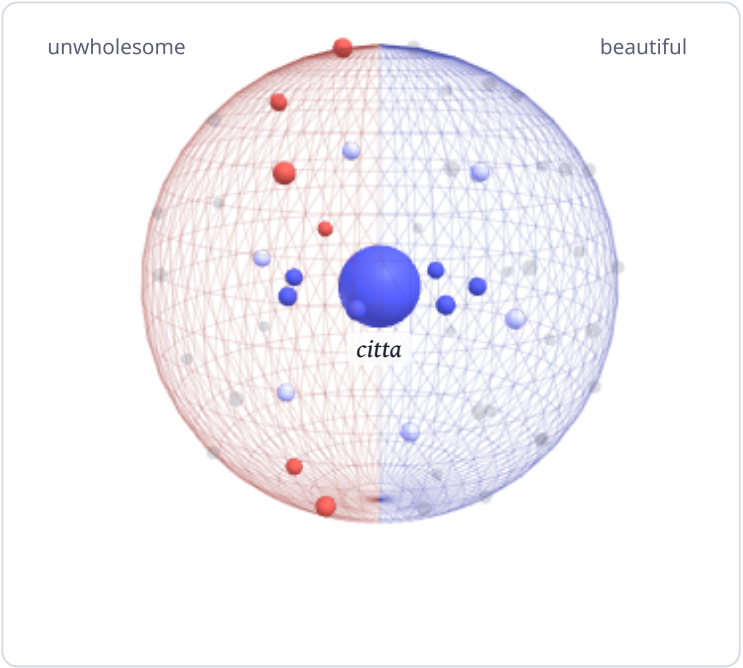
Elements in 3D

Three models of the elements of experience: all 89 cittas as a stupa, the 52 factors gathered round a single citta, and the inside of a kalāpa of matter.

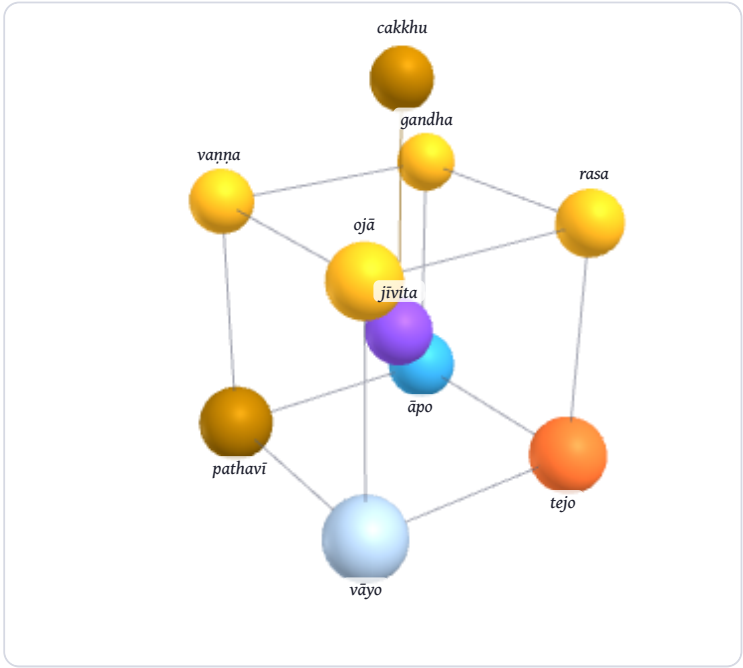


joy equanimity bodily pleasure bodily pain displeasure supramundane (joy or equanimity, by jhāna)

Each cube is one citta. The tiers rise from the 54 sense-sphere cittas, through the 15 fine-material and 12 immaterial, to the 8 supramundane cittas around Nibbāna at the top. Coloured by feeling, most of the stupa is joy or equanimity; the four red-brown and green cubes are the only cittas with bodily pain, bodily pleasure or displeasure.



Greed-rooted, joyful, with wrong view: 19 factors, all on the unwholesome side. Unwholesome factors (red) and beautiful ones (indigo) sit on opposite half-spheres: they never share a citta.



Kamma-born: the eight inseparables, the life faculty and eye-sensitivity. The cube's corners are the eight inseparables: the four great elements below, colour, smell, taste and nutritive essence above.

II Elements Retells and reads plates 3–6 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Elements in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, v. 114

Kisāgotamī and the mustard seed

Mad with grief, Kisāgotamī carried her dead child from house to house asking for medicine. The Buddha asked her for a mustard seed from a house where no one had died. She found none, laid the child down, and understood that death comes to all.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Her grief is displeasure (domanassa), which on Plate 3 occurs only in the two hate-rooted cittas: grief is aversion toward loss. The search turned a private wound into a universal fact. → 3 → 4

REFLECT *Why would the Abhidhamma class grief with aversion rather than with love?*

DISCIPLES SN 19.1

Why Moggallāna smiled

Coming down Vulture Peak, Mahā Moggallāna smiled. Asked why, he said he had seen a skeleton moving through the air, pursued by crows and vultures. The Buddha confirmed that he too had seen such beings, and named the deeds that led there.

READ WITH THE ATLAS An arahant smiles with one of five cittas, none of which makes kamma: citta 30 on Plate 3, the smile-producing consciousness found only in arahants, or one of the four joyful great functional cittas. What he saw belongs to the woeful planes of Plate 11. → 3 → 11

REFLECT *In terms of citta, how does an ordinary person's smile differ from an arahant's?*

JĀTAKA Ja 313

Khantivādi, the teacher of patience

A drunken king, Kalābu, asked an ascetic what he taught. “Patience,” he said. To test him, the king had his hands, feet, nose and ears cut off. The ascetic felt no anger and wished the king long life. Leaving, the king was swallowed by the earth.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Plate 4 at its sharpest: non-hatred (adosa) and hatred (dosa) never share a citta. The king's fate returns on Plate 10 as kamma that ripens in this very life. → 4 → 10

REFLECT *Is patience only the absence of anger, or the presence of something else?*

JĀTAKA Ja 407

The monkey king's bridge

To save his troop from archers, a monkey king stretched himself across a river as a living bridge. The troop crossed over his back, but a jealous monkey leapt on him and broke it. The king of Benares, moved, tended him as he died.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Compassion (karuṇā) is one of the variable beautiful factors on Plate 4. It joins a wholesome citta only now and then, when the suffering of others is the object. → 4 → 12

REFLECT *Why does compassion need suffering as its object, while loving-kindness does not?*

DISCIPLES MN 44

Dhammadinnā on feeling

Questioned by the layman Visākha, the nun Dhammadinnā explained that lust lies latent in pleasant feeling, aversion in painful feeling and ignorance in neutral feeling. The Buddha said he would have answered in the same way.

READ WITH THE ATLAS This joins Plate 3's colours to Plate 9's wheel: feeling (link 7) is where craving (link 8) takes hold. → 3 → 9

REFLECT *Which tendency does neutral feeling feed, and why is it the hardest to notice?*

DISCIPLES MN 140

Pukkusāti and the elements

One night in a potter's shed, the Buddha taught a stranger, Pukkusāti, to see his body as earth, water, fire, air, space and consciousness, none of it “mine”. Pukkusāti recognised his teacher, but while seeking robes for ordination he was killed by a cow. The Buddha declared him a non-returner.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The four great elements are the core of the 28 kinds of matter on Plate 5. Analysing the body into elements is also one of the forty meditation subjects on Plate 12. → 5 → 12

REFLECT *If hardness, cohesion, heat and motion are all there is in “my hand”, what does “my” point to?*

III

LEVEL III OF VII · PLATE 7

Process

How does experience unfold, moment by moment?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | **III · Process** | IV · Relations | V · Lives and worlds | VI · Practice | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Level II: the kinds of citta, especially the rootless ones, and the lifespan of matter.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

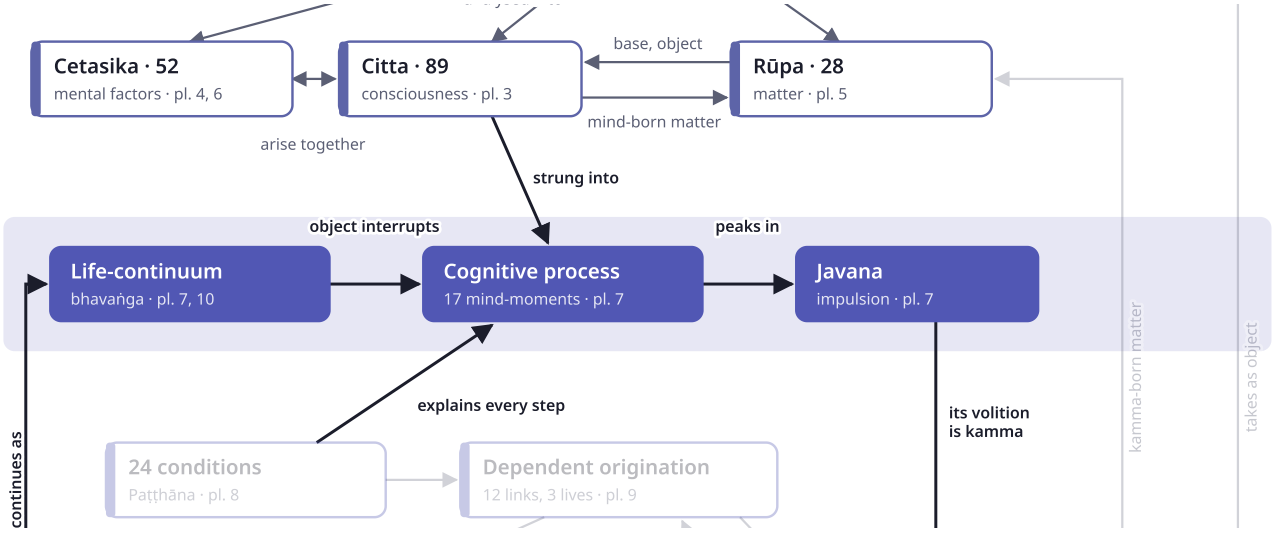
- List the 17 moments of a five-door process and the job of each.
- Explain why new kamma is made only in the javanas.
- Say how weaker objects cut the process short, and how the mind-door process differs.

7 The mango and the moment
A 17-moment process of seeing, told through the mango simile.

7b Other processes
The mind door, absorption, the path, cessation and death.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. At which moment does seeing occur? Which moments make kamma?
2. What happens when the object is only "slight"?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. Eye-consciousness is the result of past kamma, but the javanas make new kamma. Where, then, is the room for choice in a moment of seeing?
2. Why can a very weak object produce no javana at all?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. When a sound catches your attention, notice the brief gap between hearing it and naming it.

Common confusions

≠ Bhavaṅga is not a self or a soul. It is a resultant citta that arises and ceases like any other.

≠ The 17 moments are not a slow sequence you can watch one by one. They describe structure, far below the speed of ordinary awareness.

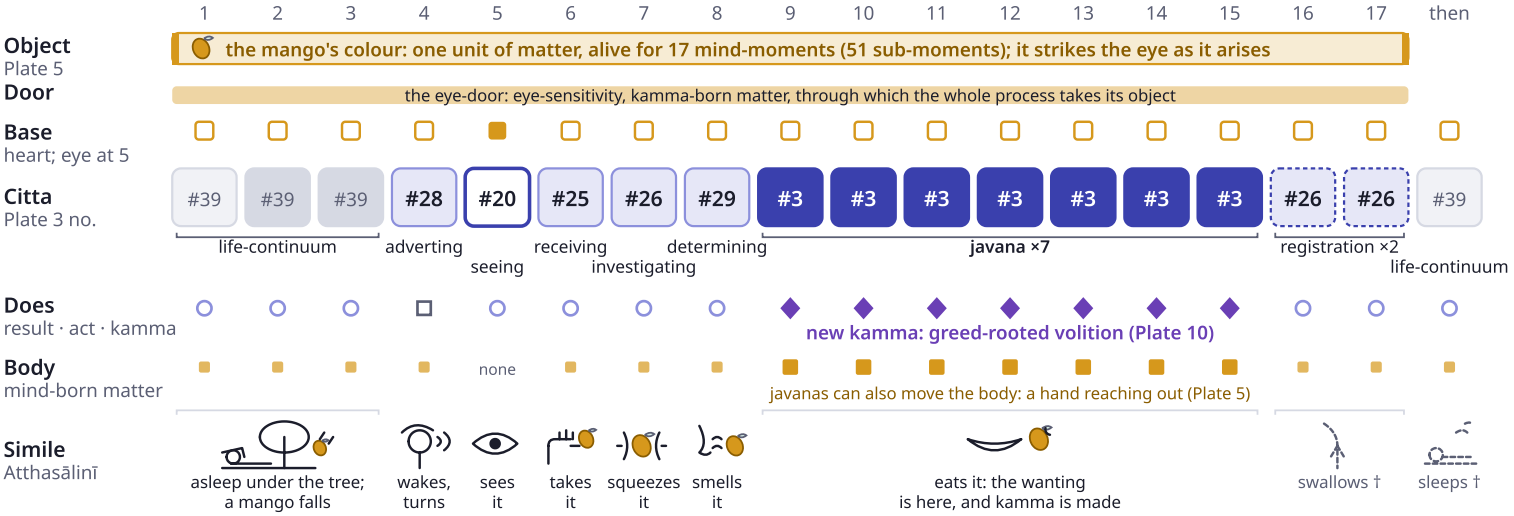
≠ Javana is not a separate decision-maker. It is a run of, usually, seven similar cittas.

III Process Builds on 3 · 4 · 5 Leads to 8 · 10 · 14 3D view

citta · kamma · matter · bhavaṅga · time

The mango and the moment

The Atthasālinī explains a seventeen-moment process of seeing with a story: a man asleep under a mango tree. Every row below runs on the same clock, one column per mind-moment: the object's matter, the door and base it works through, the citta that does each job (numbered as on Plate 3), what that moment does, the matter it makes, and the picture.



life-continuum · process citta · sense consciousness · javana · registration · result of past kamma · functional: acts, no result · makes kamma · matter

The simile follows the Atthasālinī: he wakes, sees, takes the fruit, squeezes it, smells it and eats it. † Swallowing and lying down again were added by later teachers, for example in the *Vibhāvinī-ṭīkā*, to cover registration and the return to the life-continuum. The citta numbers are one case: the man's life-continuum is shown as #39 (any of #27, #39–46 for a human); the mango is taken as an extremely desirable object, so investigating has joy (#26; a moderately desirable one gives #27); the javana is #3, greed with joy, without wrong view. Plate 3b lists every citta that can do each job.

1–3 · Life-continuum. The same citta as this life's rebirth-linking keeps the stream going between processes. The arriving object makes it vibrate, then stop. → 10

4–8 · Turning and handling. Adverting (#28) and determining (#29) are functional: they act and leave no result. Seeing, receiving and investigating are results of past kamma: no one chooses what is seen. → 3

9–15 · Javana. The only moments that make kamma. Whether they are greed (#3) or a wholesome citta turns on wise or unwise attention at determining, the Atthasālinī says. → 10

16–17 · Registration. A result again, taking the javanas' object. The process has lasted exactly as long as the mango's unit of matter; then the life-continuum resumes. → 5

NOT EVERY OBJECT COMPLETES THE PROCESS

Very great object: complete, with registration



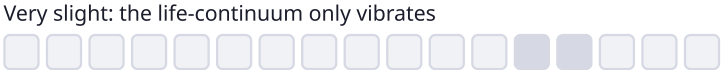
Great: 2–3 past moments, no registration



Slight: no javana; determining repeats



Very slight: the life-continuum only vibrates



Mind door, clear object



How fast is a moment?

The commentaries say that billions of cittas can arise and cease in the time it takes lightning to flash or an eye to blink. The seventeen moments are not a slow story; they are a description of structure.

Why seventeen?

A unit of matter lasts seventeen mind-moments. A sense object strikes the door at the first moment and is gone after the seventeenth, so a single object can carry exactly one complete process. A weaker impact starts later and runs out sooner.

III Process Continues 7 Leads to 8 · 12 · 13

Other processes

Plate 7 followed one eye-door process. The same building blocks make every other process: the mind door, absorption in jhāna, the path, the attainment of cessation, and the last process of a life. Each strip below reads left to right, one cell per mind-moment, in the colours of Plate 7.

lc life-continuum **vib** vibrating **arr** arrest **adv** adverting **J** javana **reg** registration **prep** preliminary **acc** access **conf** conformity **CoL** change-of-lineage **abs** absorption **path** path **fruit** fruition **—** cessation: no mind **death** death **reb** rebirth-linking

The mind-door processes that follow a five-door process · the first consequent process: CMA IV guide

vib arr adv J J J J J J J reg reg

the same visible form, just past

Independent mind-door process, obscure object · CMA IV §12

vib arr adv J J J J J J J

no registration

Absorption process, keen faculties · CMA IV §14

vib arr adv acc conf CoL abs lc

The preliminary moment is omitted, so absorption is the 4th javana.

Path process, keen faculties · CMA IV §14

vib arr adv acc conf CoL path fruit fruit fruit lc

No preliminary moment, so three fruition moments follow the path: still seven javanas in all.

Death and rebirth (reference: Plate 10) · CMA IV §21

adv J J J J J reg death reb lc

Near death javanas run only five times, because the process is weak.

Independent mind-door process, limited javana, clear object · CMA IV §§12–13

vib arr adv J J J J J J J reg reg

any object: past, present, future or timeless; for example, remembering the mango tomorrow

Absorption process, first attainment of jhāna, slow faculties · CMA IV §§14–16

vib arr adv prep acc conf CoL abs lc

Absorption is the 5th javana.

Path process (stream-entry), slow faculties · CMA IV §14

vib arr adv prep acc conf CoL path fruit fruit lc

Seven javanas: four preparatory, one path, two fruition.

Attainment of cessation (nirodha-samāpatti) · CMA IV §22

abs abs — fruit lc

Only non-returners and arahants who have all eight attainments, and not in the immaterial planes: cessation needs the eight attainments in succession, and the fine-material jhānas cannot arise there (Vism XXIII).

When does it become “a mango”?

The five-door process knows only the visible datum. 'A mango' is known in later mind-door processes, after the eye-door process is over. The mango simile's “smells it” at determining is not yet recognition.

1. **taking the past object:** the mind door takes up the colour that the eye-door process has just seen, now past
2. **taking the whole:** the colours of many successive processes are taken together as one
3. **taking the meaning or shape:** the thing is recognised: something round and yellow, a fruit
4. **taking the name:** the name is known: “a mango” (a concept of name). From step 3 on, the object is a concept; liking “the mango” takes a concept as object

The series of naming processes is later teaching (Ledi Sayadaw and others), not the Saṅgaha's own.

Rules of the process

HOW MANY JAVANAS

sense-sphere (limited) javana, normal	**7 (sometimes 6)**
weak process (e.g. fainting) and at the time of death	**5**
first attainment of a jhāna	**absorption 1**
path	**1**
fruition right after the path	**2 (slow) or 3 (keen)**
jhāna attainment and fruition attainment	**many, as long as resolved**

REGISTRATION

- Registration occurs only after sense-sphere javanas, only in sense-sphere beings, and only with sense-sphere objects that are very great (five doors) or clear (mind door).
- Registration runs for two moments (some commentators allow one), or not at all.

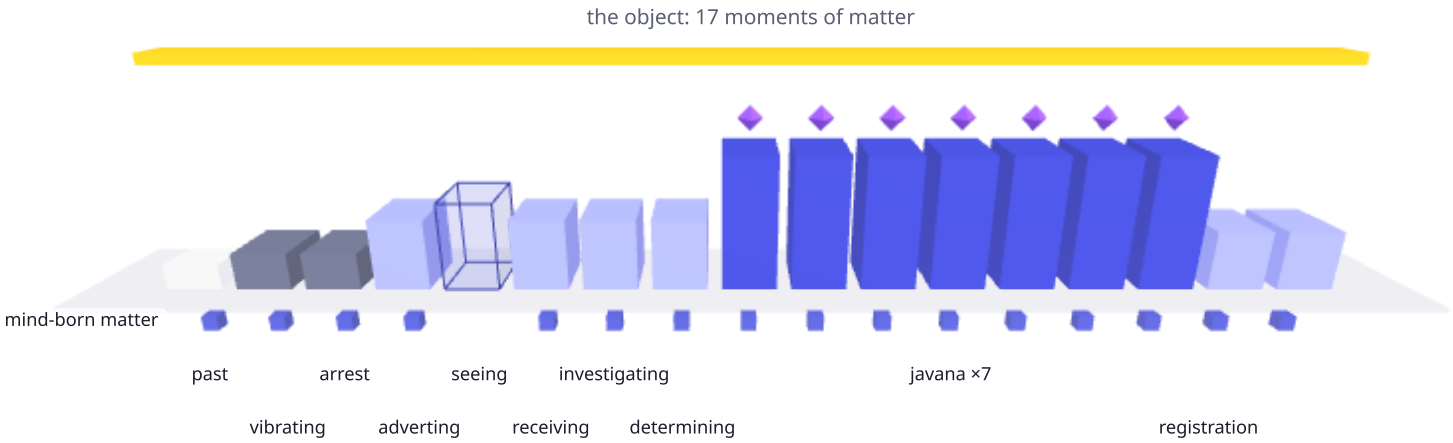
WISE ATTENTION

Whether the javanas are wholesome or unwholesome turns on wise or unwise attention at the turning point of determining. So the Atthasālinī explains it; determining itself makes no kamma, and in an arahant the javanas are functional.

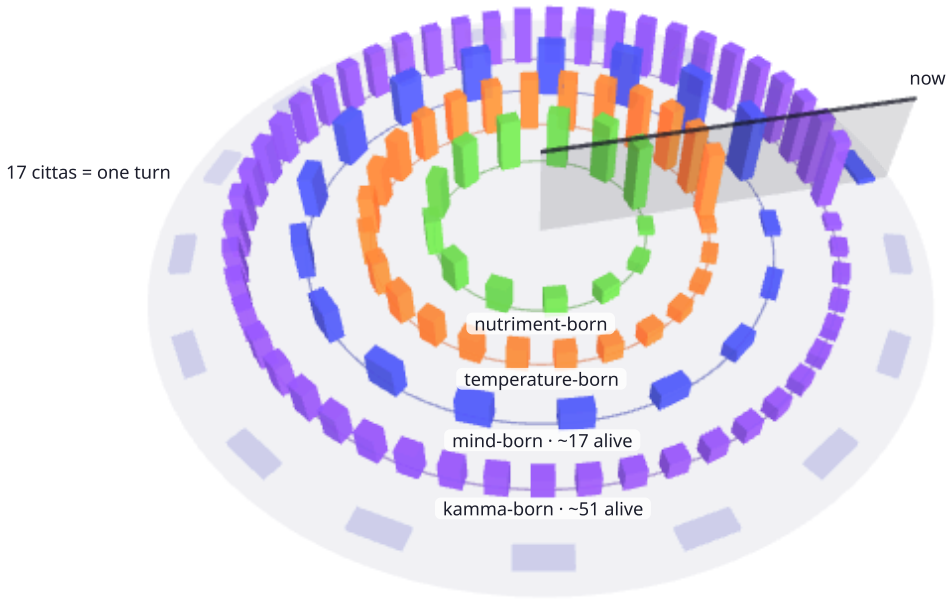
III Process Models for plate 7

Process in 3D

Two views of the same seconds of life. Above, one cognitive process as a track of moments, with what each moment does to kamma and to the body. Below, the body itself as a clock: one turn of the pointer is the 51 sub-moments that a unit of matter lives, so each ring of matter stays full while every unit in it is replaced.



The bar above the track is the object's life: seventeen moments for a very great object. Violet seeds rise from the javanas, where kamma is made. The small cubes below are mind-born matter, produced as each citta arises, except the sense consciousness, which is too weak to produce matter.



kamma-born · every sub-moment mind-born · at each citta's arising temperature-born · rate illustrative
nutriment-born · rate illustrative

During life. Each bar is one generation of matter, set down where the pointer stood when it arose and shrinking as it ages. It ceases when the pointer comes round again: one turn is 17 cittas, or 51 sub-moments. Every bar is replaced, yet the rings stay full: about 51 generations of kamma-born matter and 17 of mind-born matter are alive at once. The body is a standing wave of arising and ceasing.

III Process Retells and reads plate 7

● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Process in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

DISCIPLES Ud 1.10

Bāhiya: in the seen, only the seen

Bāhiya stopped the Buddha on his alms round, begging to be taught. The Buddha said: "In the seen there will be only the seen, in the heard only the heard, in the sensed only the sensed, in the cognized only the cognized." Bāhiya became an arahant there and then, and was killed by a cow soon after.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Plate 7 shows where the instruction bites. Seeing itself, at moment 5, is a result and makes no kamma. Liking, disliking and "I" enter only in the javanas. → 7 → 2

REFLECT *At which moment of Plate 7 does "the seen" become "a mango I want"?*

DISCIPLES Ud 3.2; AN 8.9; AN 1.230

Nanda, guardian of the doors

The Buddha's half-brother Nanda was ordained on his wedding day and pined for his bride. In time he became an arahant, and the Buddha named him foremost among those who guard the sense doors: whichever way Nanda looked, he looked with full awareness, so that longing and grief could not flow in.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The doors of sense restraint are the doors of Plate 7. Guarding them means the seeing is not followed by unwholesome javanas. → 7 → 4

REFLECT *Can a door be guarded without being closed?*

JĀTAKA Ja 9

Makhādeva's first grey hair

King Makhādeva told his barber to report the first grey hair. When it came, the king held it in his hand, saw death approaching, handed the kingdom to his son and went forth.

READ WITH THE ATLAS A small object can carry a large process. The same sight of a grey hair could run javanas of vanity or of urgency; which one runs depends on attention at the turning point of determining (Plate 7). → 7 → 13

REFLECT *What decides whether a grey hair produces worry or wisdom?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE MN 61

Rāhula and the mirror

The Buddha asked his young son Rāhula what a mirror is for. "For reflection, sir." "In the same way," said the Buddha, "reflect before, during and after every action of body, speech and mind: does it lead to harm for myself, for others, or both?"

READ WITH THE ATLAS Reflection is a discipline for the javanas, where volition becomes kamma (Plates 7 and 10). → 7 → 10

REFLECT *Why reflect after an action, when its kamma is already made?*

IV

LEVEL IV OF VII · PLATES 8–9

Relations

How does everything hold together?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | III · Process | **IV · Relations** | V · Lives and worlds | VI · Practice | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Level III: the cognitive process. Level II: mind and matter.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

- Name the six families of conditions and give an example of each.
- Trace one moment of experience through several conditions.
- Place the 12 links across three lives, and name the connections, rounds and roots.

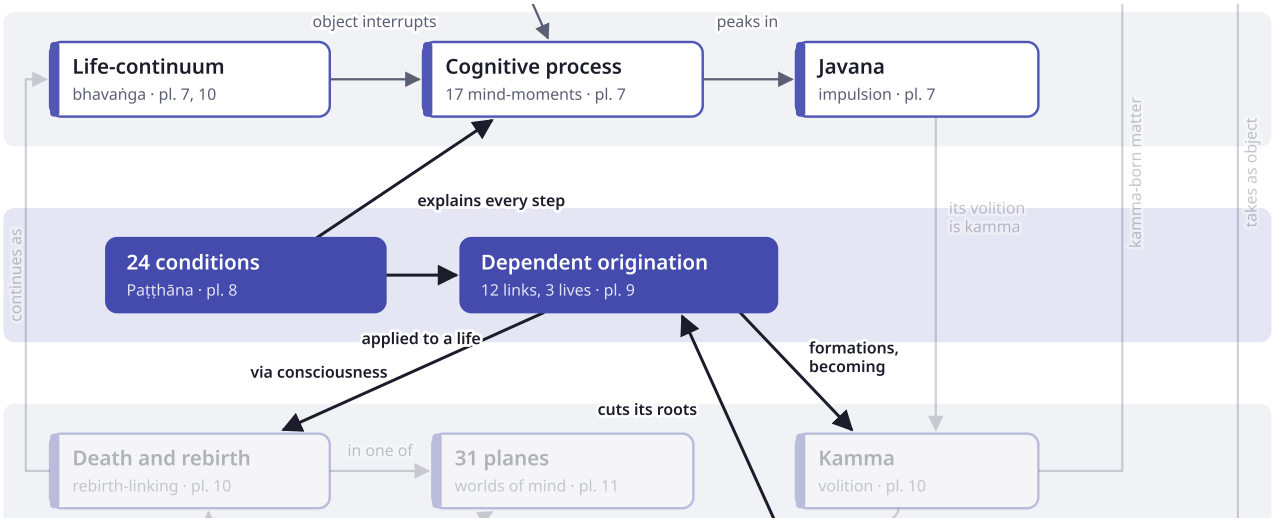
8 The web of 24 conditions
How each dhamma helps another, sorted by direction.

8b The lists reduced to their factors
Chapter VII: defilement lists, and six categories that are conditions.

9 The wheel across three lives
Dependent origination and its whole vocabulary in one drawing.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. Which two links are the roots of the wheel?
2. Name the four conditions that, the Saṅgaha says, include all 24.

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. Contact and feeling arise together, yet contact is listed first. What kind of order is the list showing?
2. Why must the Paṭṭhāna allow concepts, not only dhammas, to be objects?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Trace one craving back: what feeling came just before it, and what contact before that?

Common confusions

≠ Conditions are not billiard balls in a chain. Many of them hold between things that arise at the same time.

≠ The three-life reading is the Saṅgaha's standard, but the Vibhaṅga also applies the twelve links within a single moment of mind.

IV Relations Builds on 7 Leads to 9 3D view

citta contact kamma matter roots jhāna

The web of 24 conditions

The Paṭṭhāna asks one question of every pair of dhammas: how does this one help that one arise or persist? Its 24 answers fall into six families according to direction, mind or matter on each side. The Saṅgaha adds that all 24 fold into four, a good place to start: **object** (what is known), **decisive support** (what strongly backed it), **kamma** (what volition produced it) and **presence** (what had to exist at the same time).

Mind → mind 6

4 proximity · 5 contiguity · 12 repetition · 19 association · 22 absence · 23 disappearance

Each citta, as it ceases, gives way to the next: the stream has no gaps. Javanas strengthen their successors.

Mind → mind & matter 5

1 root · 13 kamma · 14 result · 17 jhāna · 18 path

Roots, jhāna and path factors steady the citta, its factors and the matter it produces. Volition is kamma.

Mind → matter 1

11 postnascence

Later cittas sustain the body that arose before them. This is postnascence.

Matter → mind 1

10 prenascence

The eye, already arisen, supports the eye-consciousness that follows; so does a visible object already present.

Anything → mind 2

2 object · 9 decisive support

Concepts, mind or matter can all be objects. A strong past experience, a teacher, a habit can decisively support what arises now.

Mind & matter → both 9

3 predominance · 6 conascence · 7 mutuality · 8 support · 15 nutriment · 16 faculty · 20 dissociation · 21 presence · 24 non-disappearance

Mostly things arising together, like a tripod's legs; some work from an earlier base or a later citta.

THE 24 IN THEIR CANONICAL ORDER, COLOURED BY FAMILY

1 *hetu* root	2 *ārammaṇa* object	3 *adhipati* predominance	4 *anantara* proximity	5 *samanantara* contiguity	6 *sahajāta* conascence
7 *aññamañña* mutuality	8 *nissaya* support	9 *upanissaya* decisive support	10 *purejāta* prenascence	11 *pacchājāta* postnascence	12 *āsevana* repetition
13 *kamma* kamma	14 *vipāka* result	15 *āhāra* nutriment	16 *indriya* faculty	17 *jhāna* jhāna	18 *magga* path
19 *sampayutta* association	20 *vippayutta* dissociation	21 *atthi* presence	22 *natthi* absence	23 *vigata* disappearance	24 *avigata* non-disappearance

Worked example: seeing a mango and wanting it → 14

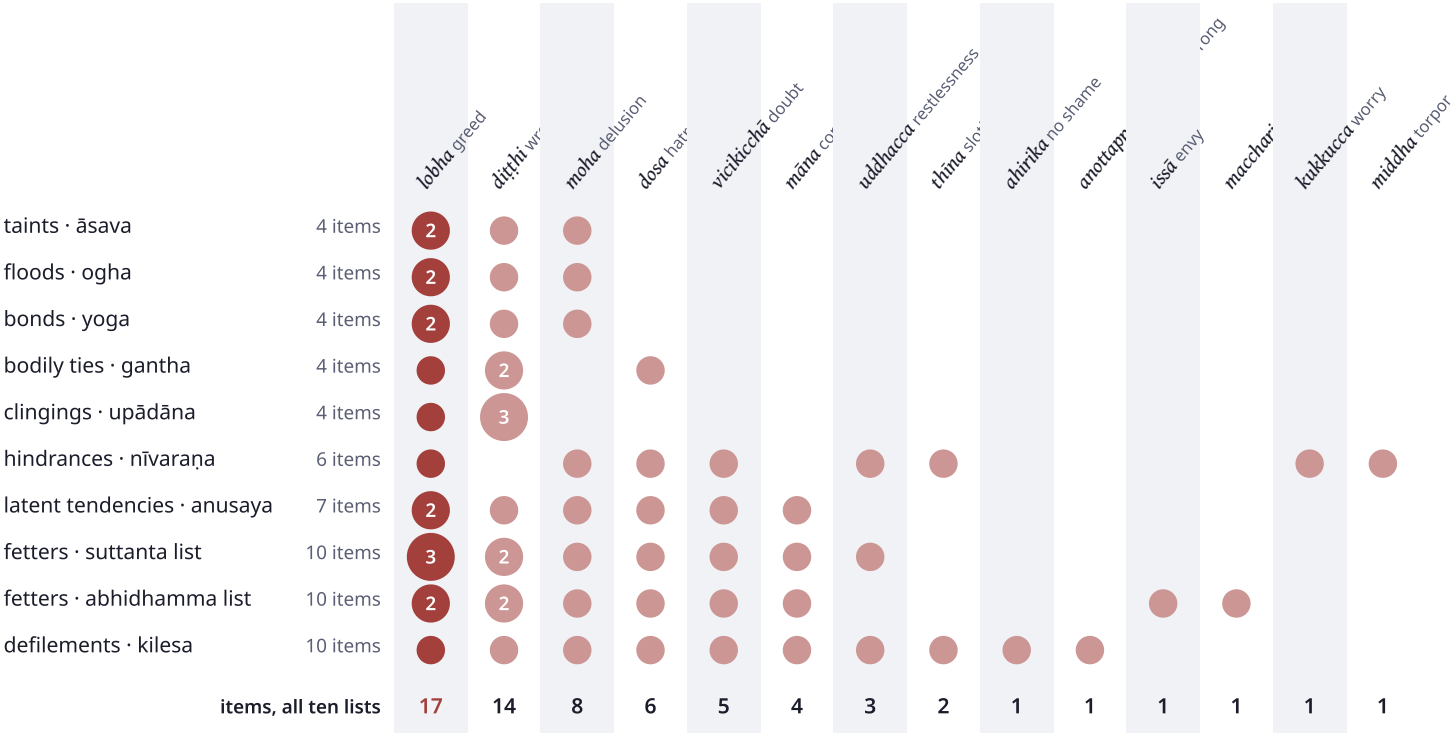
The eye-base, already present, supports eye-consciousness	10 prenascence · 8 support · 21 presence
The mango's colour is the object of eye-consciousness	2 object · 10 prenascence
Five-door adverting gives way to eye-consciousness	4 proximity · 5 contiguity · 22 absence · 23 disappearance
Greed, a root, steadies the javana and its factors	1 root · 6 conascence
Each javana strengthens the next	12 repetition
Contact, feeling and the rest arise together and support each other	6 conascence · 7 mutuality · 19 association
Volition in the javanas can ripen in a later life	13 kamma

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* VIII; Agganyani, overview of the 24 paccayas

IV Relations Continues 4 · 8 Leads to 9 · 13

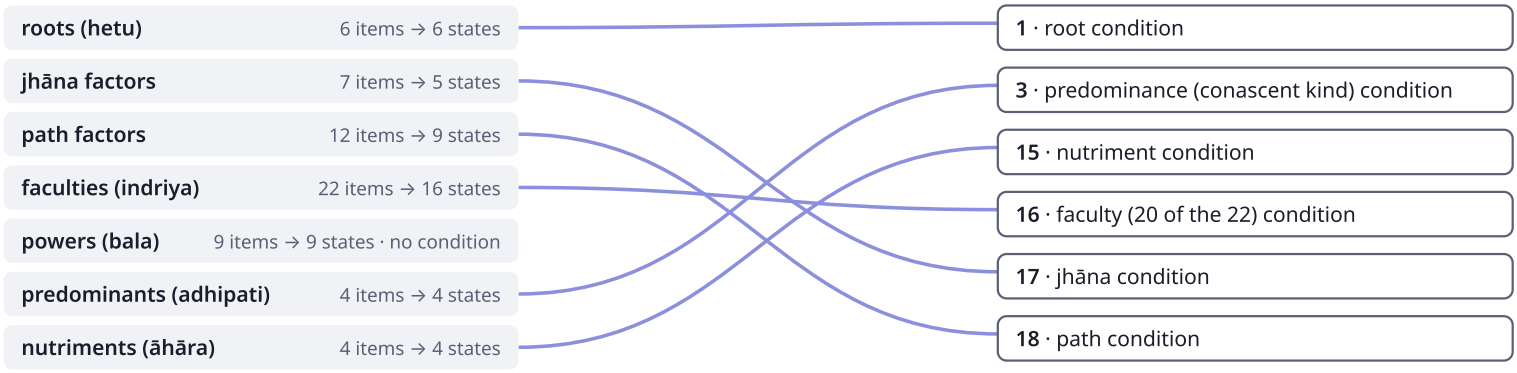
The lists reduced to their factors

Chapter VII gathers the Abhidhamma's lists: taints, floods, bonds, ties, clingings, hindrances, latent tendencies, fetters, defilements. Dozens of names reduce to only fourteen unwholesome factors. Each circle counts the items of a list that are, ultimately, that factor.



Greed (lobha) is in all nine groups, 17 times across the ten lists; wrong view in 8 groups (14 times); delusion in 7. All 14 unwholesome factors appear somewhere. The lists name the same few defilements again and again, each time from another angle: as what flows in, what sweeps away, what binds, what lies latent.

SIX CATEGORIES THAT ARE ALSO CONDITIONS



Two cautions

- CMA counts no jhāna factors in the 10 sense consciousnesses and no path factors in the 18 rootless cittas.
- Predominance as a condition is wider than the four predominants (object predominance).
- The nine powers have no condition of their own; their members act through others, such as faculty and path.

The requisites of enlightenment

The 37 requisites are 14 states: energy 9 times, mindfulness 8, wisdom 5, concentration 4, faith 2, and nine states once each (desire, consciousness, zest, tranquillity, equanimity, applied thought, the three abstinences).

The table is on the Level VI models page D6.

IV Relations Builds on 8 Leads to 10 · 13 · 14 3D view

citta feeling contact kamma roots

The wheel across three lives

The Abhidhamma reads the twelve links of dependent origination across three lives and hangs a whole vocabulary on them: three periods, twelve factors, twenty modes, three connections, four groups, three rounds and two roots. The wheel shows all seven at once.



round of defilements round of kamma round of results root: ignorance, craving connection

Past causes
1. ignorance
2. formations
3. craving
4. clinging
5. becoming (kamma)

Present effects
1. consciousness
2. mind and matter
3. six sense bases
4. contact
5. feeling

Present causes
1. craving
2. clinging
3. becoming (kamma)
4. ignorance
5. formations

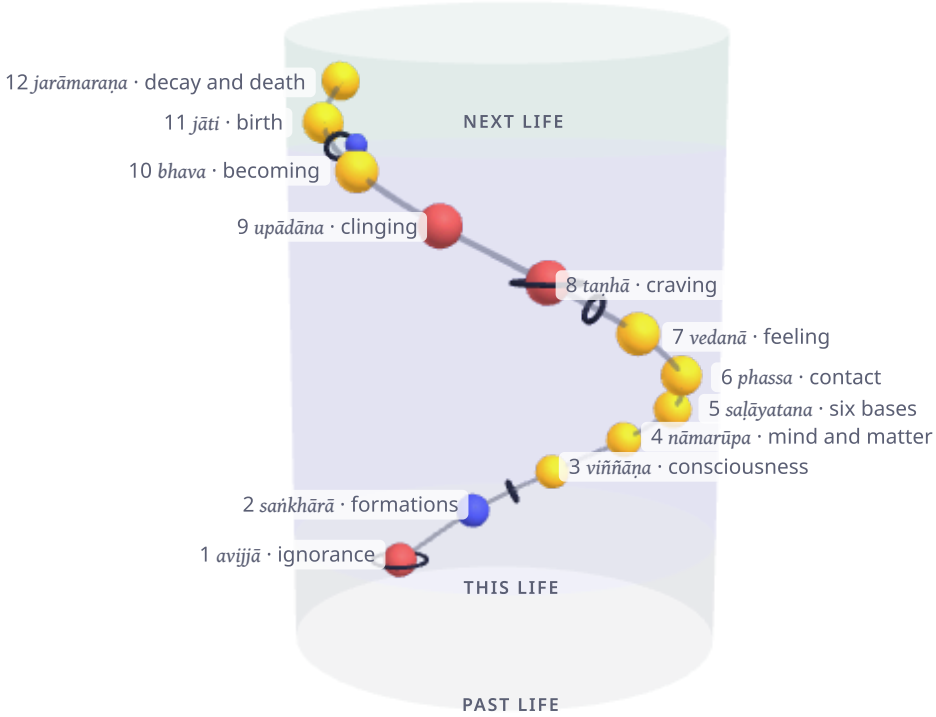
Future effects
1. consciousness
2. mind and matter
3. six sense bases
4. contact
5. feeling

Links 8–10, craving, clinging and becoming, arise in the javanas of Plate 7 → 7. Links 3–7 are the results that Plate 10 follows across the hinge between lives → 10.

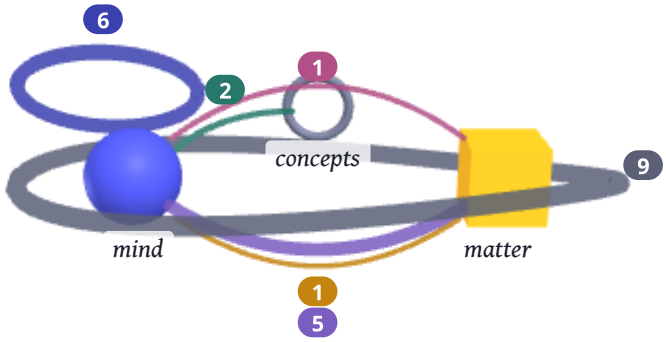
IV Relations Models for plates 8–9

Relations in 3D

The wheel of Plate 9 opened into a helix that climbs through three lives, and the 24 conditions of Plate 8 drawn as arcs between mind, matter and concepts.



Red links are defilements, indigo kamma, turmeric results; becoming (10) is both kamma and result. The three rings are the connections between the four groups, and the halos mark the two roots, ignorance and craving. At rebirth, the Visuddhimagga says, mentality supports the mind base, the sixth of the six bases, in at least seven ways: conascence, mutuality, support, association, result, presence and non-disappearance. It supports the five physical bases in fewer ways, since association holds only between mental states.



Six families, 24 conditions

Arcs between mind (sphere), matter (cube) and concepts (ring); an arc's thickness shows how many conditions its family holds.

Mind → mind · 6 *proximity, contiguity, absence, disappearance, repetition, association.*

Mind → mind and matter · 5 *root, jhāna, path, kamma, result.*

Mind → matter · 1 *postnascence.*

Matter → mind · 1 *prenascence.*

Concepts, mind, matter → mind · 2 *object, decisive support.*

Mind and matter → both · 9 *predominance, conascence, mutuality, support, nutriment, faculty, dissociation, presence, non-disappearance.*

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* VIII; Visuddhimagga XVII

IV Relations Retells and reads plates 8–9 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Relations in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE MN 36; Ud 1.1–1.3

The night of awakening

Under the Bodhi tree, in the first watch of the night he recalled his past lives; in the second he saw beings pass away and reappear according to their kamma; in the third he realised the destruction of the taints. In the days that followed he reviewed dependent origination forward and in reverse.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The three watches map onto the atlas: past lives and the planes (Plates 10–11), kamma and its fruit (Plate 10), and the wheel with its ending (Plates 9 and 13). → 9 → 10 → 13

REFLECT *Why must dependent origination be seen in reverse as well as forward?*

DISCIPLES Vinaya, Mahāvagga I.23

Assaji's four lines

The wanderer Upatissa saw the monk Assaji on alms round and asked for his teacher's doctrine. Assaji gave it in one verse: "Of things that arise from a cause, the Tathāgata has told the cause, and also their cessation." Upatissa, later Sāriputta, gained the eye of Dhamma on hearing it.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The shortest summary of Plates 8 and 9: whatever is conditioned has conditions, and they can cease. Sāriputta went on to become the Abhidhamma's first teacher (Plate 1). → 8 → 9 → 1

REFLECT *Why might a statement about conditions be enough to open the eye of Dhamma?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE DN 15

"Do not say so, Ānanda"

Ānanda remarked that dependent origination, though called deep, seemed clear to him. The Buddha replied: "Do not say so, Ānanda. This dependent origination is deep and appears deep. Through not understanding it, this generation has become like a tangled skein."

READ WITH THE ATLAS Plates 8 and 9 make the structure visible, but reading a diagram is learning (suta). Seeing a link happen is development (bhāvanā). → 9

REFLECT *What would it take to move from knowing the twelve links to seeing one of them happen?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE Atthasālinī, introduction

Rays from the Jewel House

In the fourth week after the awakening, the commentary says, the Buddha sat in a jewelled chamber and contemplated the Abhidhamma. Through the first six books no rays appeared; when he reached the Paṭṭhāna, rays of six colours streamed from his body.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The tradition marks the Paṭṭhāna, the book behind Plate 8, as the vastest of all. Its colours inspired the modern Buddhist flag. → 8 → 1

REFLECT *Why might the relations between things be harder to see than the things themselves?*

LEVEL V OF VII · PLATES 10–11

V Lives and worlds

What carries on from one life to the next, and where?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | III · Process | IV · Relations | **V · Lives and worlds** | VI · Practice | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Level III: javana and the life-continuum. Level IV: dependent origination.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

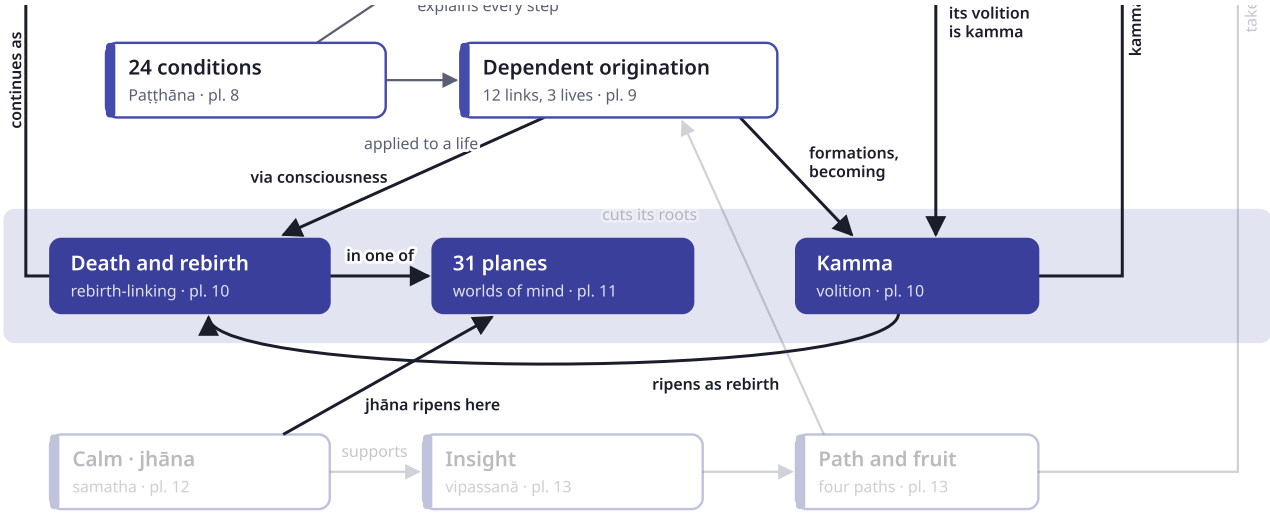
- Sort kamma by function, order, time and place.
- Describe the last process of a life and how rebirth-linking takes its object.
- Match each jhāna to its planes and read their lifespans.

10 Kamma, death and rebirth
Four ways to sort kamma, and the hinge between two lives.

11 Thirty-one planes
The worlds of each level of mind, on a scale of deep time.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. What three kinds of object can appear at death?
2. Which plane holds beings with matter but no mind?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. Rebirth-linking takes the same object as the last javanas. How does that tie Plate 10 back to Plate 7?
2. Why might habitual kamma matter more, in practice, than any single act?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Notice which thoughts return most often as you fall asleep. They are the raw material of habitual kamma.

Common confusions

≠ Kamma is the volition, not its result. Results are vipāka.

≠ Nothing transmigrates. Rebirth-linking is conditioned by the past life, but nothing passes across.

≠ The planes are not only places. Each corresponds to a kind of mind: jhāna kamma ripens in the Brahmā worlds.

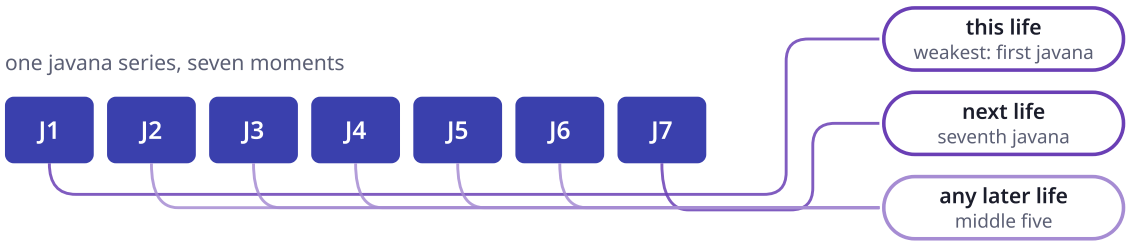
V Lives and worlds Builds on 7 · 9 Leads to 11 3D view kamma bhavaṅga jhāna time

Kamma, death and rebirth

Kamma is volition (*cetanā*). The Saṅgaha sorts it four ways, each answering a different question. Then it follows the last moments of a life into the first moment of the next.

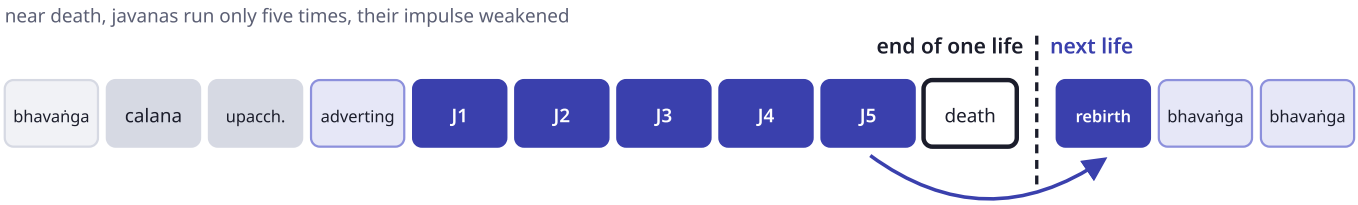
BY FUNCTION: WHAT DOES IT DO?	*janaka* productive: produces rebirth and results during life	*upatthambhaka* supportive: strengthens another kamma's results	*upapīḷaka* obstructive: weakens or delays them	*upaghātaka* destructive: cuts another kamma off and takes its place
BY ORDER: WHICH RIPENS FIRST AT DEATH?	*garuka* weighty: jhāna, a heinous crime or fixed wrong view; nothing overrides it	*āsanna* death-proximate: done or recalled just before death	*āciṇṇa* habitual: what one does again and again	*kaṭattā* reserve: anything done once, if nothing else is there
BY TIME: WHEN DOES IT RIPEN?	*diṭṭhadhammavedanīya* in this very life	*upapajjavedanīya* in the next life	*aparāpariyavedanīya* in any later life	*ahosi* defunct: its chance passed
BY PLACE: WHERE DOES IT RIPEN?	*akusala* unwholesome kamma	*kāmāvacara kusala* sense-sphere wholesome	*rūpāvacara kusala* fine-material wholesome: jhāna	*arūpāvacara kusala* immaterial wholesome

WHEN A JAVANA'S KAMMA CAN RIPEN



If the right conditions never come in time, the kamma becomes defunct (*ahosi*). These are the seven javanas of Plate 7 → 7.

THE HINGE BETWEEN TWO LIVES



rebirth-linking takes the same object as the last javanas: a kamma, a kamma sign or a destiny sign

Three signs at death

The last process takes one of three objects: a **kamma** remembered, a **kamma sign** (a sight or sound linked with it, such as flowers offered at a shrine), or a **destiny sign** (an image of the coming birth).

Four causes of death

End of the lifespan, end of the productive kamma, both together, or a destructive kamma cutting in. A lamp goes out the same four ways: the wick is used up, the oil is used up, both run out, or a gust of wind blows it out.

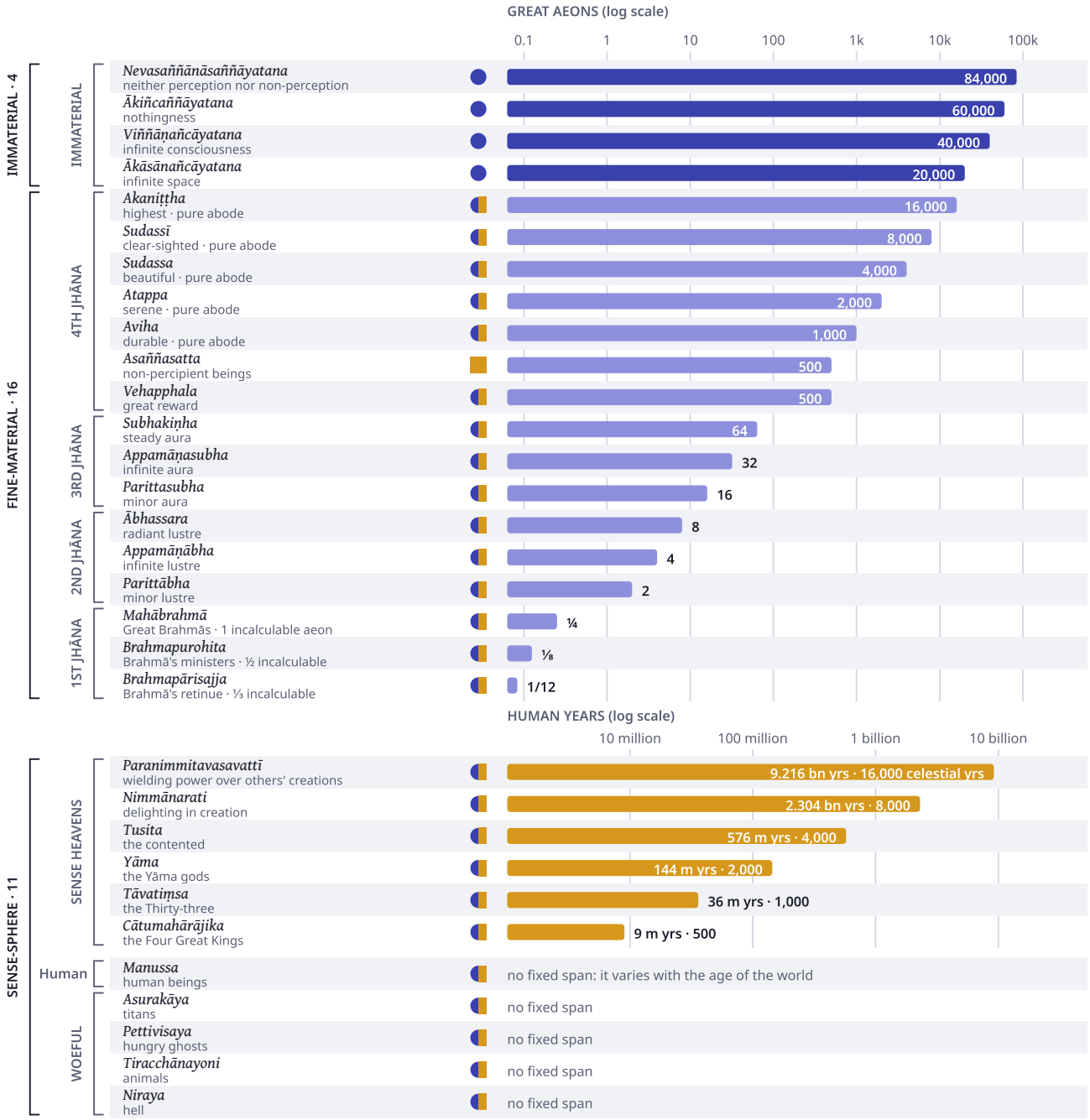
Nothing travels across

Rebirth-linking is conditioned by the past life, but nothing passes over. The Visuddhimagga's images: an echo, the light of a lamp, the impression of a seal, a reflection in a mirror.

V Lives and worlds Builds on 3 · 10 Leads to 12 3D view citta matter jhāna time

Thirty-one planes, on a scale of deep time

The planes match the levels of mind: each jhāna has its own heavens. Plotted on a logarithmic scale, most of the lifespans rise in doublings. The chart also shows which planes hold mind only or matter only.



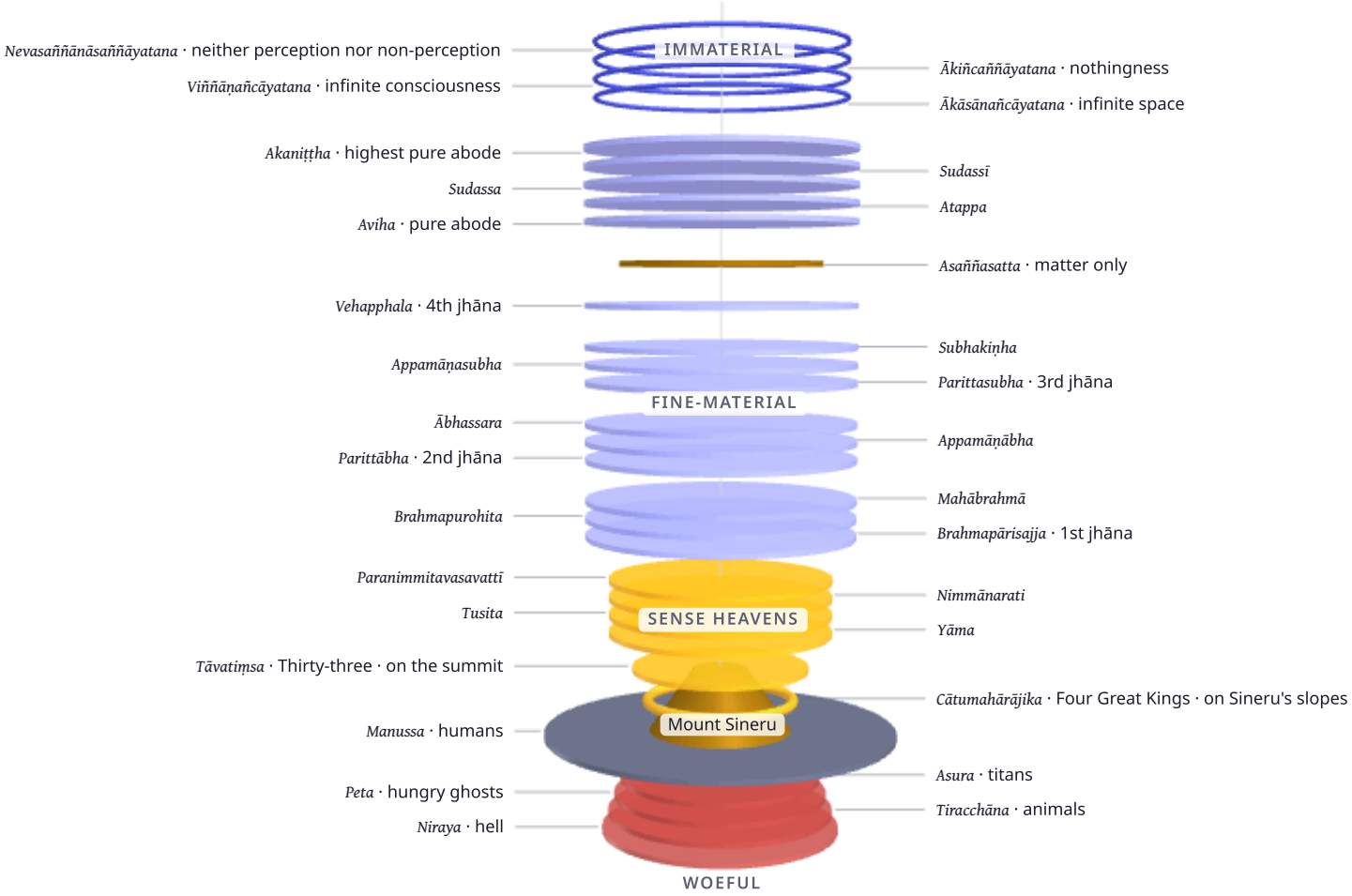
mind only (immaterial planes) matter only (non-percipient beings) mind and matter

Brahmā lifespans are in great aeons (*mahākappa*). The first three are given in the texts as fractions of an incalculable aeon, a quarter of a great aeon, and are converted here. Deva lifespans are in human years: 50 human years make one day of the Four Great Kings, and each higher heaven doubles both the day and the lifespan. Jhāna kamma ripens in the Brahmā planes → 12.

V Lives and worlds Models for plates 10–11

Thirty-one planes as a world-mountain

The traditional cosmos, stacked. The woeful states lie below the human world. Mount Sineru rises from it: the Four Great Kings dwell on its slopes and the Thirty-three on its summit. The higher heavens and the Brahmā worlds rest above it in space, and the four immaterial planes, drawn as empty rings, have no matter at all.



Floors of mind

Each floor of the Brahmā worlds corresponds to a jhāna; beings are reborn there by the kamma of that jhāna. The higher the floor, the longer the life and the subtler the mind.

Mind without matter

In the four immaterial planes there is no body and no base: cittas arise with no physical support. Among the non-percipient beings, the reverse: a body with no mind at all.

Ring widths

Disc widths are schematic, not measured. For the actual lifespans, from nine million human years to 84,000 aeons, see Plate 11.

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* V; commentaries on Sineru

V Lives and worlds Retells and reads plates 10–11 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Lives and worlds in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, v. 2

Maṭṭhakuṇḍalī's last thought

A miserly brahmin's son lay dying, left on the veranda so visitors would not see inside the house. The Buddha passed and let himself be seen. The boy's mind filled with faith, he died with that thought, and he was reborn in the Tāvatiṃsa heaven.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Death-proximate kamma on Plate 10: the last javanas were full of faith, and the rebirth-linking that followed took up their object. → 10 → 11

REFLECT *If one last thought can decide a rebirth, why do teachers stress habitual kamma?*

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, v. 151

Queen Mallikā's seven days

Queen Mallikā was generous and devout, but as she died her mind went to one wrong deed she had hidden from the king. She was reborn in a woeful state for seven days, and then in the Tusita heaven.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The other face of death-proximate kamma: one unwholesome last thought outweighed a good life, but only for a while. Her stored good kamma then took its turn (Plate 10). → 10 → 11

REFLECT *Which shapes rebirth more: a whole life, or its last moments?*

DISCIPLES MN 86

Aṅgulimāla and the stones

The bandit Aṅgulimāla had killed many. Meeting the Buddha, he went forth and became an arahant. On alms round people threw stones and sticks at him. The Buddha said: "Bear it, brahmin. You are experiencing here and now the result of deeds for which you might have suffered in hell for many years."

READ WITH THE ATLAS Kamma by time (Plate 10): what could ripen in this life did. With arahantship there is no next life, so kamma waiting for later lives could never ripen. → 10

REFLECT *What does Aṅgulimāla's story say about whether kamma is fate?*

DISCIPLES Vinaya, Cūḷavagga VII; Dhammapada commentary, v. 17

Devadatta's weighty kamma

The Buddha's cousin Devadatta drew the Buddha's blood with a rock hurled from Vulture Peak, and split the Saṅgha. The commentary says that as he came at last to ask forgiveness, the earth swallowed him and he was reborn in the Avīci hell.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Wounding a Buddha and splitting the Saṅgha are two of the five heinous deeds: weighty kamma, which ripens before any other kind (Plate 10). → 10 → 11

REFLECT *Why should weighty kamma override even death-proximate kamma?*

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, vv. 137–140

Why Moggallāna was beaten

Late in life the great disciple Mahā Moggallāna was beaten to death by hired bandits. The commentary traces this to a deed many lives before, when he turned on his own blind parents; versions differ on whether he went through with it.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Kamma that can ripen "in any later life" (Plate 10) waits for its chance, even for an arahant. What arahantship ends is new kamma and any further rebirth. → 10

REFLECT *If even an arahant meets old kamma, what exactly does arahantship end?*

JĀTAKA Ja 541

King Nimi's chariot

Sakka sent his charioteer Mātali to bring the righteous King Nimi to the Tāvatiṃsa heaven. On the way Mātali showed him the hells, naming the deeds that led there, and then the heavenly mansions, naming the deeds that earned them.

READ WITH THE ATLAS A guided tour of Plate 11. Each world is paired with a kind of deed, the same pairing as kamma "by place" on Plate 10. → 11 → 10

REFLECT *Why does the story always show the deed alongside the world?*

VI

LEVEL VI OF VII · PLATES 12–13

Practice

What do I do with all this?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | III · Process | IV · Relations | V · Lives and worlds | **VI · Practice** | VII · Synthesis

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Levels II to IV. Insight takes the elements, the process and the conditions as its objects.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

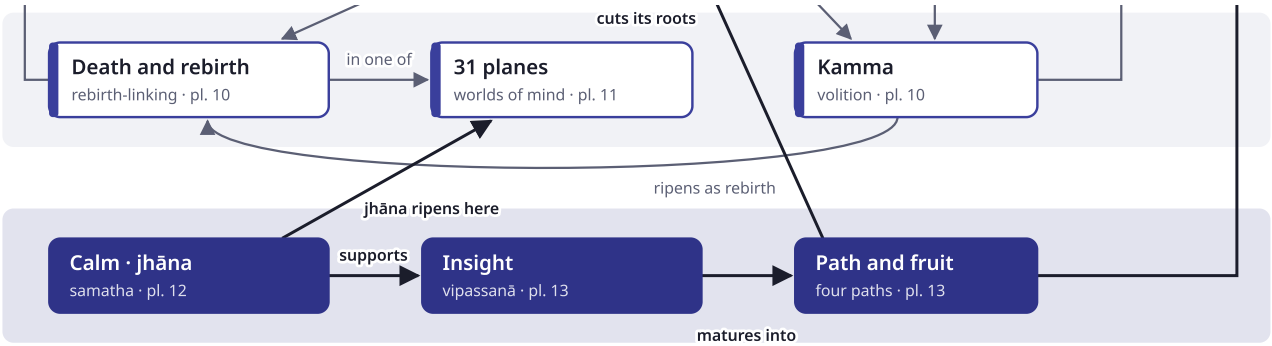
- Choose a meditation subject for a temperament and say how deep it can go.
- Name the three signs and three stages of concentration.
- Order the seven purifications and the ten insight knowledges, and say which fetters each path ends.

12 Forty meditation subjects
Subjects matched to temperaments, and how deep each can go.

13 The tree of purification
The path of insight as soil, roots, trunk and crown.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.



The concept map around this level. Filled: this level. Outlined: earlier levels. Faded: what comes later. Bold arrows touch this level; the whole map is on page 5.

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. Which subjects can reach all five jhānas?
2. Which three fetters end at stream-entry?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. Purifications 3 and 4 are "defining mind and matter" and "discerning their conditions". Which levels of this atlas do they match?
2. Why does the tree put virtue and concentration at the roots rather than in the trunk?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Choose one subject suited to your temperament and practise it daily for a week. Note which sign, if any, appears.

Common confusions

≠ Calm and insight are not rivals. The tree puts concentration at the roots of insight.

≠ The insight knowledges are not ideas about impermanence. They are stages of directly seeing mind and matter arise and pass.

VI Practice Builds on 3 · 11 Leads to 13 3D view feeling jhāna

Forty meditation subjects

Each subject is fitted to a temperament and reaches a known depth. The colour bar on each card shows the temperament it suits. The five boxes show how many jhānas it can reach.

lustful · 11 hateful · 8 deluded · 1 speculative · 1 faithful · 6 intelligent · 4 all temperaments · 10
jhāna reached, 1st to 5th

Kasiṇas 10
- earth ■■■■■
- water ■■■■■
- fire ■■■■■
- air ■■■■■
- blue ■■■■■
- yellow ■■■■■
- red ■■■■■
- white ■■■■■
- light ■■■■■
- limited space ■■■■■

Foulness 10 corpses
- bloated ■□□□□
- livid ■□□□□
- festering ■□□□□
- cut up ■□□□□
- gnawed ■□□□□
- scattered ■□□□□
- hacked and scattered ■□□□□
- bleeding ■□□□□
- worm-infested ■□□□□
- skeleton ■□□□□

Recollections 10
- the Buddha ACCESS
- the Dhamma ACCESS
- the Saṅgha ACCESS
- virtue ACCESS
- generosity ACCESS
- deities ACCESS
- peace ACCESS
- death ACCESS
- the body ■□□□□
- breathing ■■■■■

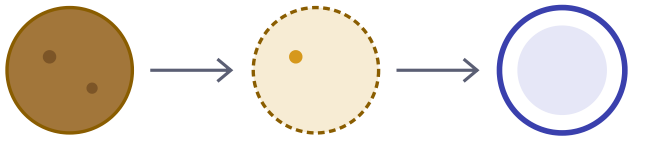
Illimitables 4
- loving-kindness ■■■■□
- compassion ■■■■□
- appreciative joy ■■■■□
- equanimity □□□□■

Perception 1
- repulsiveness of food ACCESS

Analysis 1
- the four elements ACCESS

Immaterial 4
- infinite space IMMATERIAL
- infinite consciousness IMMATERIAL
- nothingness IMMATERIAL
- neither perception nor non-perception IMMATERIAL

THREE SIGNS, THREE STAGES (EARTH KASIṆA)



preliminary sign *parikamma-nimitta* → learning sign *uggaha-nimitta* → counterpart sign *paṭibhāga-nimitta*

preliminary development → access, when the counterpart sign appears → absorption (jhāna), when the factors grow strong.

Reading the depths

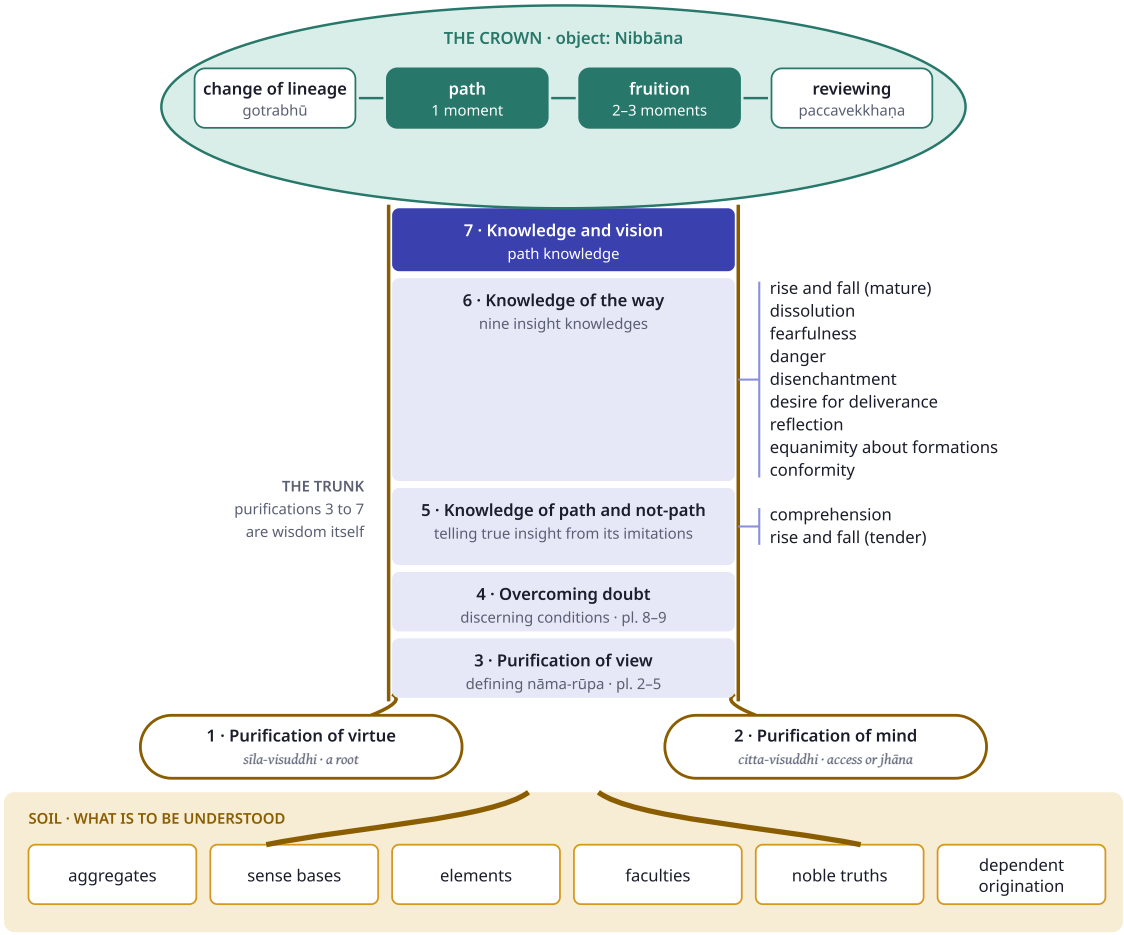
- **Access only** (10 subjects): the object is too varied or too deep in thought to settle into absorption.
- **First jhāna only** (11): foulness and the parts of the body need applied thought to hold the object.
- **Four jhānas** (3): loving-kindness, compassion and appreciative joy come with pleasant feeling, so they stop before the fifth.
- **Fifth only** (1): equanimity as a divine abiding needs neutral feeling.
- **All five** (11): the kasiṇas and the breath. The immaterial four build on the fifth. → 11

VI Practice Builds on 9 · 12 Leads to 14 3D view

roots jhāna Nibbāna wisdom

The tree of purification

The Visuddhimagga pictures the path of insight as a tree. The things to be understood are the soil. Virtue and a concentrated mind are the roots. The five purifications of wisdom are the trunk, and the insight knowledges grow up it.



TEN FETTERS AND THE FOUR PATHS

Fetter	Stream-entry	Once-return	Non-return	Arahantship
personality view	■			
doubt	■			
clinging to rites and rules	■			
sensual desire		▮	■	
ill will		▮	■	
lust for fine-material being				■
lust for immaterial being				■
conceit				■
restlessness				■
ignorance				■

■ abandoned ▮ weakened

Three doors to liberation

Insight that ends in path enters by one of three doors, set by the characteristic it dwelt on most.

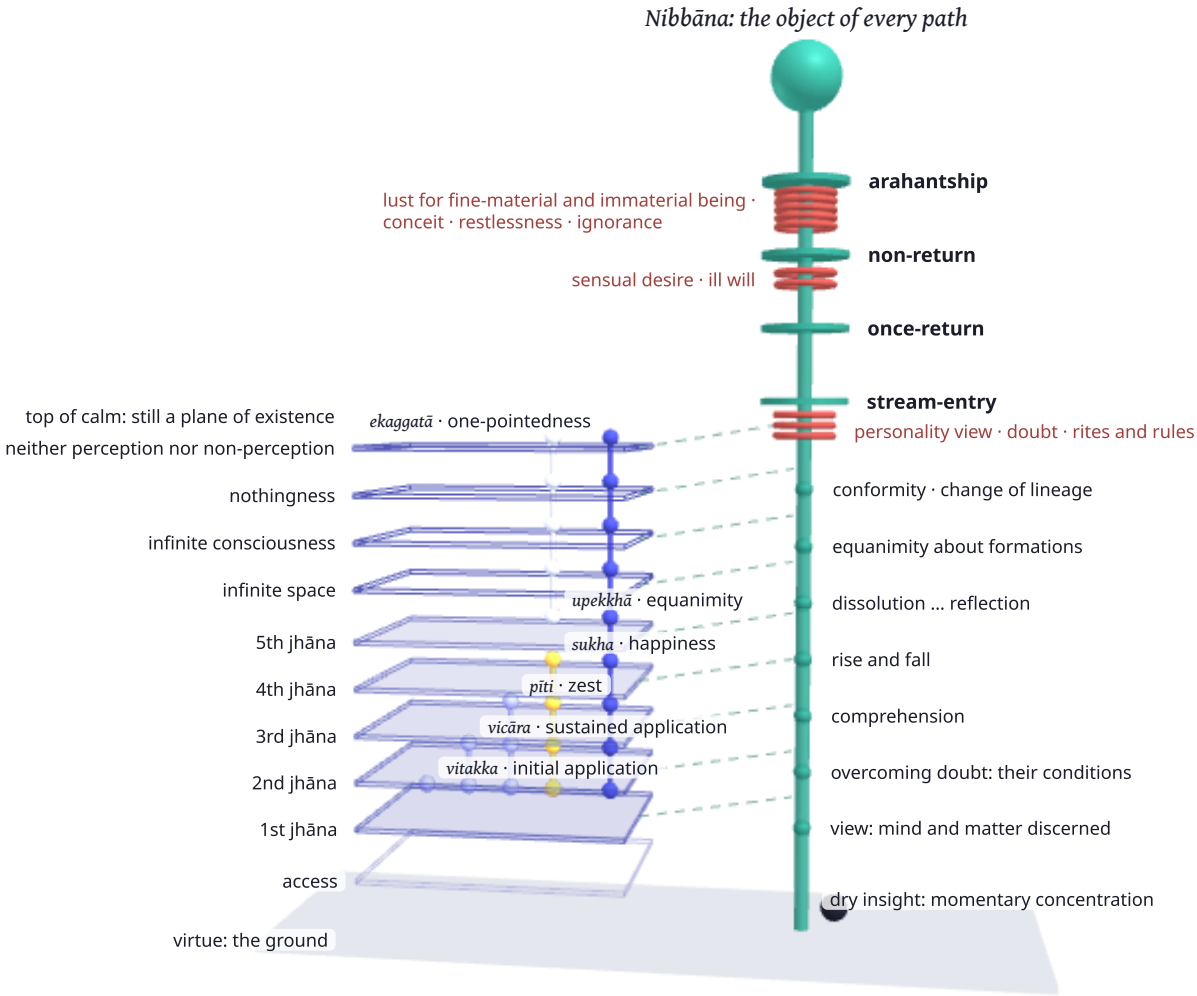
- Impermanence → the **signless** (*animitta*)
- Suffering → the **desireless** (*appaṇihita*)
- Non-self → the **void** (*suññata*)

At the crown, a single moment of path knowledge is followed by two or three moments of fruition, both taking Nibbāna as their object.

VI Practice Models for plates 12–13

Practice as a climb

Calm rises through stacked floors of absorption, the first five each with fewer factors than the one below; the immaterial floors keep the fifth jhāna's two. Insight rises beside them: it can start from any floor, or from none, and only insight passes the top of calm into the supramundane, where four paths, each taking Nibbāna as object, cut the ten fetters.



Ordinary person. All ten fetters bind. The red rings sit just under the path that will cut them.

THE 37 REQUISITES ARE 14 STATES

	Found. 4	Efforts 4	Bases 4	Facult. 5	Powers 5	Enlight. 7	Path 8	×
viriya energy		4	●	●	●	●	●	9
sati mindfulness	4			●	●	●	●	8
paññā wisdom			●	●	●	●	●	5
samādhi concentration				●	●	●	●	4
saddhā faith				●	●			2
chanda desire to act			●					1
citta consciousness			●					1
pīti zest						●		1
passaddhi tranquillity						●		1
upekkhā equanimity						●		1
vitakka right intention							●	1
sammā-vācā right speech							●	1
sammā-kammanta right action							●	1
sammā-ājīva right livelihood							●	1

Reading the climb

A factor's post ends on the last floor that has it: initial and sustained application go first, then zest, then happiness, which gives way to equanimity; one-pointedness runs to the top. The immaterial floors keep the fifth jhāna's two factors and change only the object; drawn as empty frames, they are still planes of existence (D5). Dashed links: insight may start from any floor; dry insight starts from the ground with momentary concentration.

The table: each dot is one place a state appears among the 37; energy appears nine times, mindfulness eight, wisdom five, concentration four, faith twice, the other nine once. Thirteen are mental factors; one, as a base of success, is citta itself.

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* I (jhāna factors), VII (requisites), IX (calm, insight, paths); Nārada, *Manual* VII

VI Practice Retells and reads plates 12–13 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Practice in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE MN 36

The rose-apple tree

As a boy, the Bodhisatta sat in the shade of a rose-apple tree while his father worked at a ploughing ceremony, and entered the first jhāna. Years later, worn out by austerities, he remembered it and asked: "Could that be the path to awakening?"

READ WITH THE ATLAS On Plate 13's tree, concentration is a root. The commentaries say his subject was the breath, one of the eleven that can reach all five jhānas on Plate 12. → 12 → 13

REFLECT *Why was a pleasant, blameless state the clue, after years of pain?*

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, v. 25

Cūḷapanthaka's white cloth

Cūḷapanthaka could not learn a single verse in four months, and his brother told him to leave. The Buddha gave him a clean white cloth to rub while repeating "removing dirt". As the cloth grew soiled he saw impermanence, and he became an arahant.

READ WITH THE ATLAS A subject fitted to the person (Plate 12): a simple object you can see and touch, which ripened into insight (Plate 13). → 12 → 13

REFLECT *Why might a slow learner of words be a quick learner of seeing?*

DISCIPLES Dhammapada commentary, v. 285; Ja 25

The goldsmith and the lotus

A young monk, a goldsmith for five hundred lives, made no progress with meditation on the foulness of the body. The Buddha gave him a lotus instead. Its beauty steadied his mind; then the flower withered, and he saw impermanence.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Plate 12's temperaments in action: the usual remedy for lust did not fit this mind, and a beautiful object did. → 12

REFLECT *Which of Plate 12's six temperaments sounds most like your own?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE MN 26

Āḷāra and Uddaka

Before his awakening, the Bodhisatta reached the base of nothingness under Āḷāra Kālāma, and neither perception nor non-perception under Uddaka Rāmaputta. He left both, seeing they did not lead to Nibbāna. After awakening he thought first of teaching them, but both had died.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The highest calm leads to the highest immaterial planes of Plate 11, with lifespans of 60,000 and 84,000 aeons, but not out of the round. That is why Plate 13's tree needs a trunk of insight. → 11 → 12 → 13

REFLECT *What does insight supply that even the highest jhāna lacks?*

DISCIPLES Therīgāthā 112–116

Paṭācārā and the water

Having lost her whole family, Paṭācārā became a nun. Washing her feet, she watched the water trickle down, some a little way, some further, like the stages of a life. That night, as she drew down the wick of her lamp, her mind was freed.

READ WITH THE ATLAS The knowledge of rise and fall on Plate 13, seen first in water and then in her own mind. The lamp going out echoes Plate 10's image of death. → 13 → 10

REFLECT *Why is the going-out of a flame so often the image of Nibbāna?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE SN 56.11

Koṇḍañña's eye of Dhamma

At the first sermon in the Deer Park, as the Buddha finished, Koṇḍañña understood: "Whatever is subject to arising is all subject to cessation." The Buddha exclaimed, "Koṇḍañña has understood!"

READ WITH THE ATLAS Stream-entry (Plate 13): just after change-of-lineage first turns to Nibbāna, path knowledge takes Nibbāna as its object and the first three fetters fall away. → 13

REFLECT *Why is the insight put as a general rule rather than a particular experience?*

VII

LEVEL VII OF VII · PLATES 14–15

Synthesis

How does it all fit together, and how do others see it?

I · Foundations | II · Elements | III · Process | IV · Relations | V · Lives and worlds | VI · Practice | **VII · Synthesis**

YOU ARRIVE WITH

Everything before. This level is for review and perspective.

YOU LEAVE ABLE TO

- Describe one moment of experience through every lens in the atlas.
- Compare the Theravāda list with the Sarvāstivāda and Yogācāra lists.
- Follow any key idea through every plate where it appears.

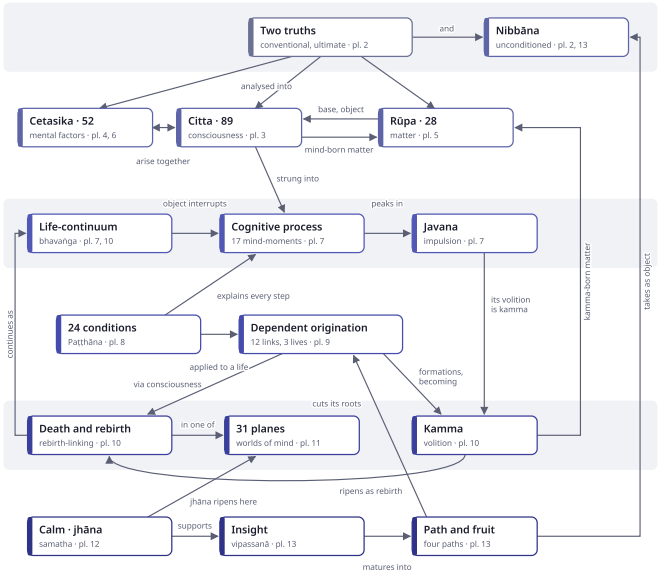
14 One moment, every lens
One moment of seeing and wanting, read through ten frameworks.

15 Other maps of the same ground
How two other schools counted the elements.

In 3D
Models of this level's diagrams to turn and explore.

In the stories
Episodes from the Buddha's life, the Jātakas and the disciples, read with these plates.

Threads and glossary
Every key idea traced across the plates, what to read in the Manual, and 150 terms.



Synthesis uses the whole map (page 5).

CHECK YOURSELF AT THREE DEPTHS

Learn *suta*

recall the lists and terms

1. How many elements does each of the three schools count?
2. Which thread runs through the most plates?

Reflect *cintā*

connect and explain

1. If the past and future were as real as the present, which plates would have to change?
2. The Paṭṭhāna already relates everything to everything. What does a concept map add, and what does it leave out?

Observe *bhāvanā*

find it in experience

1. Fill in the worksheet on Plate 14 for one moment of your own day.

Common confusions

≠ Different counts do not always mean different claims. Much of the difference lies in how things are grouped.

≠ Synthesis is not a new doctrine. These pages only make visible the links the texts already draw.

VII Synthesis Builds on 2–13 Leads to 15 3D view

citta feeling contact kamma matter bhavaṅga roots wisdom

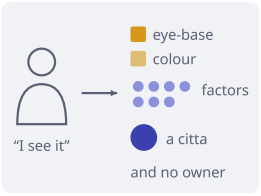
One moment, every lens

Every plate so far describes the same experience from a different angle. Here one ordinary moment, seeing a ripe mango and wanting it, is read through ten of them at once. Each lens points back to the plate that teaches it.

Seeing a ripe mango and wanting it

one ordinary moment, ten lenses · each card shows its plate's drawing with this moment marked

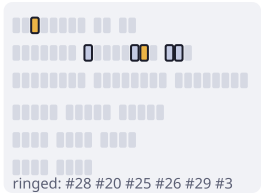




Two truths

2

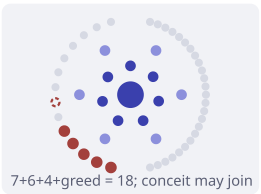
Conventionally: "I see a mango and want it." Ultimately: cittas, mental factors, an eye-base and a visible form, with no owner behind them.



Citta

3

Six kinds of citta in one process: adverting #28, seeing #20, receiving #25, investigating #26, determining #29, then javanas of #3, greed with joy, without wrong view, unprompted.



Cetasika

4

Seeing carries only the 7 universals. Each javana carries 18: the 7, the 6 occasionals, the 4 unwholesome universals and greed. Conceit may join as a 19th.



Rūpa

5

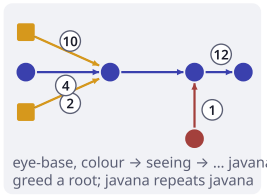
Eye-sensitivity is kamma-born; the mango's colour is temperature-born. The javanas make mind-born matter: perhaps a smile, or a hand reaching out.



Process

7

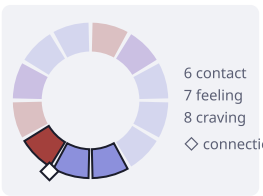
A very great object: seeing at moment 5, the wanting in javanas 9–15, registration at 16–17, then back to the life-continuum.



Conditions

8

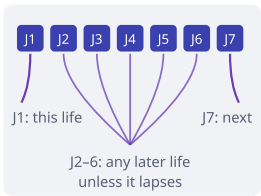
Eye-base: prenascence and support. Colour: object. Adverting: proximity. Greed: root. Each javana: repetition. Volition: kamma.



Dependent origination

9

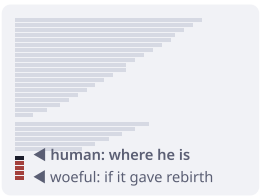
Contact → feeling → craving. This is the second connection, where present results turn into present causes.



Kamma

10

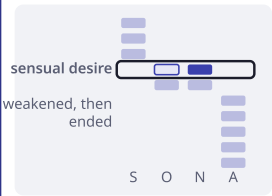
Unwholesome kamma. By time: J1 may ripen in this life, J7 in the next, J2–6 in any later life. Repeated often, it becomes habitual kamma.



Planes

11

If kamma like this produces rebirth, it leads to a woeful plane; within a human life it ripens as unwelcome sights and sounds.



Practice

12 13

Mindfulness notes "wanting". Insight sees it arise and pass. Sensual desire is weakened at once-return and ended at non-return.

Your turn

Pick one moment from today, such as hearing your name or tasting something sweet, and answer each lens in a line.

Two truths · In everyday words, and in dhammas?

Citta · Which kind, and with what feeling?

Cetasika · Which factor led: greed, aversion, mindfulness?

Rūpa · Which base, and which object?

Process · Which door, and how strong an object?

Conditions · What was the object, the root, the strong support?

Dependent origination · Did feeling turn into craving?

Kamma · What was the volition? Is it a habit?

Planes · What kind of world does this mind belong to?

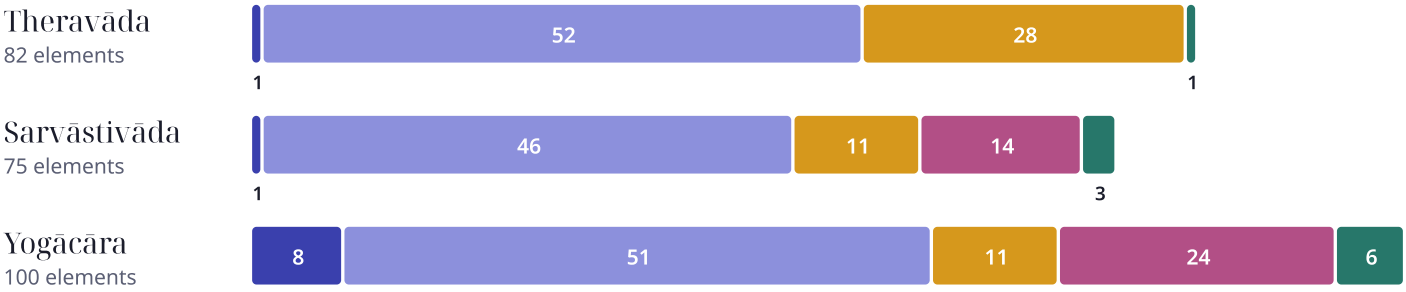
Practice · What would mindfulness have noticed?

VII Synthesis Builds on 14 Threads and glossary 3D view

citta matter bhavaṅga Nibbāna time

Other maps of the same ground

Three Buddhist schools analysed experience into ultimate elements and reached different lists. Comparing them shows which choices were open. Counted the same way, with citta as one element, the Theravāda list has 82 items.



citta · consciousness cetasika · mental factors rūpa · matter formations dissociated from mind unconditioned

Time

The Sarvāstivāda held that dhammas exist in the past, present and future; hence its name, “the doctrine that all exists”. The Theravāda Kathāvatthu argues against this. For the Theravāda only the present moment is real.

A fifth category

Northern lists add “formations dissociated from mind”: possession, life force, the arising and decay of things, words. The Theravāda has no such category. It treats most of these as concepts, or as aspects of matter and mind.

The base of mind

Yogācāra counts eight consciousnesses, including a storehouse consciousness (*ālaya-vijñāna*) that carries seeds of past action. The Theravāda's life-continuum (*bhavaṅga*) is often compared with it, though it is momentary and stores nothing.

Research notes

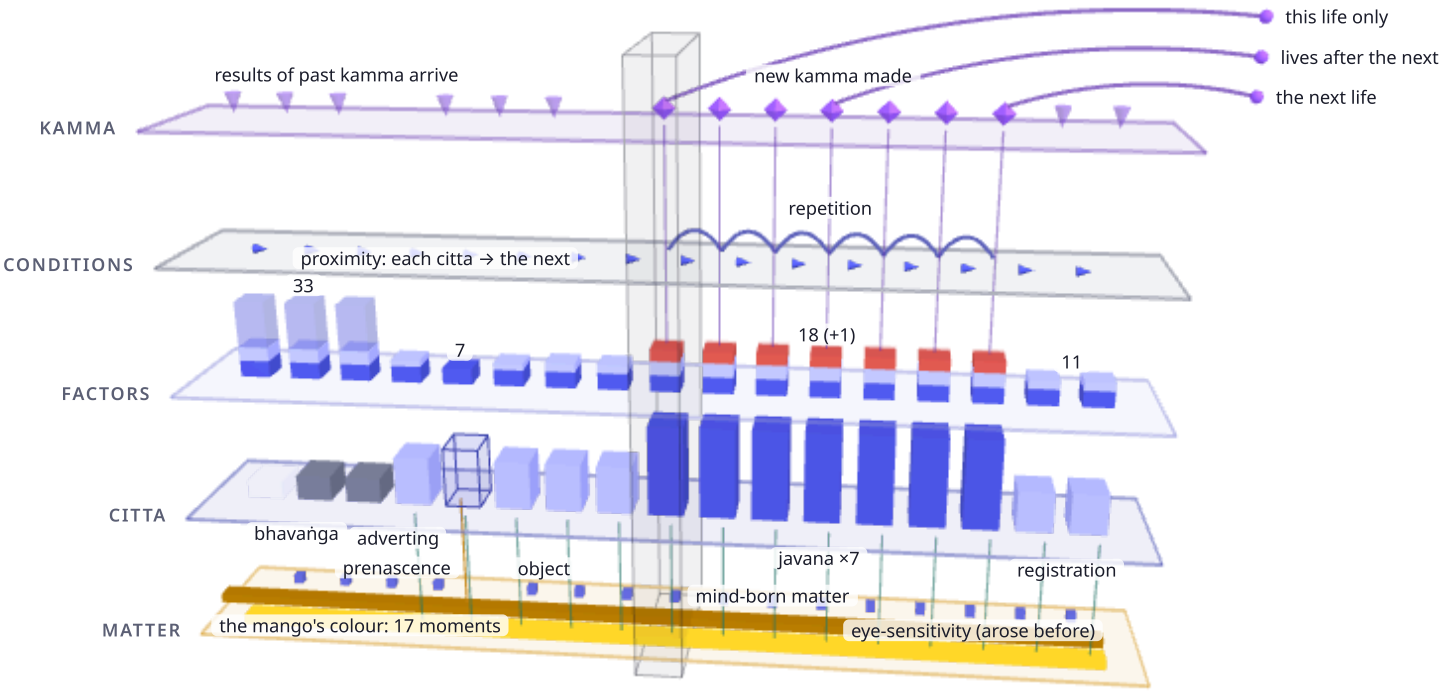
This atlas was built from two rounds of research. The first surveyed the canonical books, the commentaries and manuals, and modern studies, looking for how each explains the material. The second checked the specific claims used here: the groupings of the 24 conditions, the plane lifespans, the wording and source of each simile, and the counts of the northern schools. Where the texts give a range, or where a figure was confirmed only by secondary sources, the plate says so.

Principal sources: Bhikkhu Bodhi (ed.), *A Comprehensive Manual of Abhidhamma* (BPS, 1993); Nārada, *A Manual of Abhidhamma*; Bhikkhu Ñāṇamoli (tr.), *The Path of Purification*; *The Expositor* (Atthasālinī), tr. Pe Maung Tin; *Milindapañha*; Nyanaponika, *Abhidhamma Studies*; Y. Karunadasa, *The Theravāda Abhidhamma*; L. S. Cousins (1992) on vitakka and vicāra; M. Heim on nāmarūpa in Buddhaghosa; Agganyani's Paṭṭhāna overview; Encyclopedia of Buddhism entries on the 75 and 100 dharmas.

VII Synthesis Models for plates 14–15 and the threads

One moment, every lens

The mango moment of Plate 14 (seeing a ripe mango and wanting it) as five transparent layers on one time axis of seventeen mind-moments: matter, citta, its factors, the conditions that link them, and kamma. Everything the atlas teaches happens at once; the layers show it lined up. Choose a moment to cut through all five.



universal factors · occasional · beautiful · unwholesome · object condition · prenascence · proximity, repetition · kamma

The cut at javana 1. Citta: The first javana: greed-rooted, joyful, without wrong view (citta 3): wanting what is seen. “A mango” is known in the mind-door processes that follow. **Factors:** 18, or 19 if conceit joins: 13 ethically variable, then delusion, shamelessness, fearlessness of wrong, restlessness and greed (red). **Matter:** Colour in its 9th moment; the javana makes mind-born matter. **Conditions:** Proximity from determining; repetition to the next javana. **Kamma:** Its volition is kamma, and the first javana's can ripen only in this life.

What lines up

Red appears in the factors only at the javanas, and the same seven moments are the only ones that send kamma forward; every other moment of the process is a result arriving or a functional step. The object's matter lasts exactly as long as the process, seventeen moments, and every citta but seeing adds mind-born matter.

How to use it

Cut at each moment and say all five lenses aloud before reading the caption. The threads page follows eleven ideas across all the plates; this model takes the opposite cut: one moment, every idea at once.

Sources: Bodhi, *CMA* II (factors), III–IV (process), V (kamma), VI (matter), VIII (conditions)

VII Synthesis Retells and reads plates 14–15 ● the Buddha's life ● Jātaka ● disciples

Synthesis in the stories

The tradition has always taught through lives. Each story is retold briefly from its source. The second part reads it with the plates of this level; those readings are study aids, not claims made by the texts themselves.

JĀTAKA Buddhavaṃsa II; Jātaka introduction

Sumedha's vow

Ages ago, the ascetic Sumedha lay down in the mud so that the Buddha Dīpaṅkara could walk across him, and resolved to become a Buddha himself. Dīpaṅkara foretold it. Four incalculable aeons and a hundred thousand aeons of perfections followed.

READ WITH THE ATLAS One volition (Plate 4), renewed and fulfilled across lives (Plate 10), in worlds measured in aeons (Plate 11): the whole atlas in a single vow. → 4 → 10 → 11

REFLECT *In Abhidhamma terms, what continues from Sumedha to Siddhattha?*

JĀTAKA Ja 547

Vessantara's gifts

In the last human life before the final one, the Bodhisatta as Prince Vessantara gave away the kingdom's white elephant, his wealth, and in the end his children and his wife. After that life he was reborn in the Tusita heaven.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Sense-sphere wholesome kamma at its fullest (Plate 10). The tradition counts it as the completion of the perfection of giving. → 10 → 11

REFLECT *Can giving be wholesome kamma and also a step toward ending kamma?*

DISCIPLES DN 2

Ajātasattu's lost chance

King Ajātasattu, who had killed his father to take the throne, heard the Buddha's discourse on the fruits of the recluse's life and went for refuge. When he had left, the Buddha said that had he not killed his father, the eye of Dhamma would have arisen in him then and there.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Weighty kamma (Plate 10) can bar the path (Plate 13). A heinous deed closes the door to path attainment in that life. → 10 → 13

REFLECT *Why can one past act close a door that a good present act cannot open?*

THE BUDDHA'S LIFE DN 16

The last night at Kusinārā

The Buddha's last words were: “All conditioned things are subject to decay. Strive on with diligence.” He then rose through the jhānas to the cessation of perception and feeling, came back down to the first jhāna, rose again to the fourth, and on emerging from it attained final Nibbāna.

READ WITH THE ATLAS Every level at once: the jhānas of Plates 3 and 12, the planes he would not return to (11), and a death followed by no rebirth-linking (10). → 3 → 10 → 12 → 13

REFLECT *In terms of Plate 10, how does an arahant's death differ from anyone else's?*

Threads: following one idea through the atlas

Eleven key ideas run through many plates. Each coloured line is one idea; each stop is a plate where it appears. Plate 14 is the interchange where most of them meet. To review, pick a line and read its plates in order. The same colours mark the threads in the strip at the top of every plate.



READING ALONGSIDE THE MANUAL · BODHI'S *COMPREHENSIVE MANUAL*, CHAPTER AND SECTION FOR EACH PLATE

1 **The library**
Introduction (the Abhidhamma Piṭaka, commentaries, the Saṅgaha and its commentaries); I §1 (opening verse)

2 **From a person to dhammas**
I §2 (the four ultimate realities); VII §§34–40 (compendium of the whole: aggregates, bases, elements, truths); Introduction on the two truths

3 **A map of the 89**
I §§3–32 (all 89/121 cittas); III §§2–4 (compendium of feeling)

3b **What each citta does**
III §§5–7 (roots), §§8–11 (functions), §§12–15 (doors), §§16–19 (objects), §§20–22 (bases)

4 **The 52 factors**
II §§1–9 (the 52 in four groups), with the guide's definitions

5 **How matter is made**
VI §§2–5 (enumeration), §§6–8 (classification), §§9–15 (origination), §§16–22 (kalāpas), §§23–29 (occurrence)

6 **The commentators' picture-book**
II guide (each factor's characteristic, function, manifestation, proximate cause); Vism XIV; Atthasālinī

7 **The mango and the moment**
IV §§1–11 (six kinds of process, the five-door process and intensity of objects); IV guide on the mango simile

8 **The web of 24 conditions**
VIII §§11–28 (the Paṭṭhāna method; the six kinds of relation; synthesis: all conditions fold into four)

9 **The wheel across three lives**
VIII §§2–10 (dependent origination: formula, periods, factors, modes, connections, groups, rounds, roots)

10 **Kamma, death and rebirth**
V §§18–33 (kamma: four ways, unwholesome and wholesome kamma, results), §§34–41 (death and rebirth); IV §21 (death-proximate javana)

11 **Thirty-one planes**
V §§2–8 (the four planes), §§9–17 (four kinds of rebirth-linking, lifespans)

12 **Forty meditation subjects**
IX §§2–21 (calm: subjects, temperaments, stages of development, signs, jhānas, direct knowledges)

13 **The tree of purification**
IX §§22–44 (insight: purifications, knowledges, emancipations, individuals, attainments)

14 **One moment, every lens**
Review: I, II, III §§8–22, IV §6, VI §§9–22, VIII; with the mango.json map

15 **Other maps of the same ground**
Introduction (other schools); not covered by the CMA: Abhidharmakośa, Vasubandhu's Hundred Dharmas

Section ranges are approximate where the chapter is certain but the paragraph numbers were not checked against the printed book.

Glossary

One hundred and fifty terms, each with the plate where it is taught. Terms with several senses are listed once for each sense. On screen, a Pāli word with a dotted underline shows its definition when you point at it.

abhidhamma the "higher teaching": experience analysed into ultimate realities, dhammas 1

Abhidhammattha Saṅgaha Anuruddha's manual of the whole Abhidhamma in nine chapters; Bodhi's CMA translates it 1

dhamma an ultimate reality, bearing its own nature; not a mere name or concept 2

paramattha ultimate what remains after analysis: citta, cetasika, matter and Nibbāna 2

sammuti convention conventional truth: speech about persons and things; true, but not ultimate 2

paññatti concept a concept: a name, or what a name refers to, such as "chariot" 2

khandha aggregate one of the five heaps into which the suttas sort all experience 2

rūpa matter matter: the third reality, 28 kinds; as an aggregate it is called form 2

rūpa visible form visible form: colour, the object of seeing; one of the 28 kinds of matter 5

vedanā feeling feeling: the pleasant, painful or neutral tone of a moment; not emotion 2

saññā perception perception: marks an object's features so it can be recognised again 2

saṅkhāra formations (aggregate) formations, the fourth aggregate: the fifty factors besides feeling and perception 2

saṅkhāra formations (link 2) kamma-formations, link 2: wholesome and unwholesome volition in the past life 9

saṅkhāra all conditioned things widest sense: everything conditioned, as in "all formations are impermanent" 13

viññāṇa consciousness (aggregate) consciousness, the fifth aggregate: all 89 cittas, the same reality as citta 2

viññāṇa consciousness (link 3) consciousness, link 3: the 32 mundane resultant cittas, from rebirth-linking on 9

citta consciousness one moment of knowing an object; 89 kinds, or 121 counted in detail 2, 3

cetasika mental factor a mental factor: arises and ceases with a citta, sharing its object and base 2, 4

nāma mind mind: citta with its factors, which "bend" toward objects; the word also means "name" 2

nibbāna the unconditioned: the ending of craving; object of path and fruition 2, 13

lakkhaṇa characteristic a dhamma's own nature: the first part of its identity card 2

rasa function (of a dhamma) what a dhamma does: the second part of its identity card 2

āyatana base (the twelve) one of twelve bases: six internal (five sense organs and the mind base) and their six objects D1

dhātu element (the eighteen) one of eighteen elements: the twelve bases, with the mind base split into seven D1

mano mind (base and door) as a base, all 89 cittas; as the mind door, the life-continuum D1, 3b

sacca noble truth suffering, its origin, its cessation, the path: the four noble truths D1

lokiya mundane within the round of rebirth: all cittas but the eight supramundane, and all matter D1, 3

kāmāvacara sense-sphere the 54 cittas, and 11 planes, where sense desire holds sway 3

rūpāvacara fine-material sphere the 15 cittas of form-jhāna and the 16 planes they lead to 3, 11

arūpāvacara immaterial sphere the 12 cittas of formless jhāna and the 4 formless planes 3, 11

lokuttara supramundane beyond the world: the four paths, four fruits and Nibbāna 3, 13

kusala wholesome healthy, blameless, bringing pleasant results; rooted in non-greed and non-hatred 3

akusala unwholesome unhealthy, blameworthy, bringing painful results; rooted in greed, hatred or delusion 3

vipāka resultant a citta that is the ripening of past kamma; it makes no new kamma 3, 10

kiriya functional a citta that neither makes kamma nor results from it, such as adverting 3

ahetuka rootless a citta with none of the six roots; there are 18 3

sobhana beautiful the 59 cittas other than unwholesome and rootless ones, and their 25 factors 3, 4

hetu root one of six factors that steady a citta: greed, hatred, delusion, or their opposites 3, 4

asaṅkhārika unprompted arising spontaneously, without urging by oneself or another 3

sasaṅkhārika prompted arising after urging or persuasion, by oneself or by another 3

ñāṇasampayutta with knowledge accompanied by wisdom that understands the object as it is 3

somanassa joy pleasant mental feeling; it accompanies 62 of the 121 cittas 3

domanassa displeasure painful mental feeling; only in the two hate-rooted cittas 3

upekkhā equanimity (feeling) neutral feeling, neither pleasant nor painful; in 55 of the 121 cittas 3

hasituppāda smile-producing an arahant's rootless functional citta that causes smiling at sense-sphere things 3

121 the cittas counted in detail the 89, with each path and fruit counted at five jhāna levels 3

magga path (citta) a supramundane citta that arises once, cutting defilements, with Nibbāna as object 3, 13

phala fruition the supramundane resultant citta that follows its path, also taking Nibbāna as object 3, 13

jhāna absorption deep concentration fixed on one object: five fine-material levels, then four immaterial 12

kicca function (of a citta) one of fourteen jobs a citta can do, such as seeing or javana 3b

paṭisandhi rebirth-linking the first citta of a life: a resultant that links it to the last 3b, 10

bhavaṅga life-continuum the resultant citta, of the same kind as rebirth-linking, that runs between processes 3b, 7

cuti death consciousness the last citta of a life, of the same kind as its life-continuum 3b, 10

pañcadvārāvajjana five-door adverting citta 28: turns toward an object arriving at one of the five sense doors 3b, 7

manodvārāvajjana mind-door adverting citta 29: opens mind-door processes, and does determining in five-door ones 3b, 7b

sampaṭicchana receiving the citta that takes up the object just after sense consciousness 3b, 7

santīraṇa investigating the rootless resultant citta that examines the object just received 3b, 7

voṭṭhapana determining the moment that defines the object; done by mind-door adverting, citta 29 3b, 7

javana impulsion the active phase of a process, usually seven alike cittas; here kamma is made 3b, 7

tadārammaṇa registration resultant cittas that hold the javanas' object after a strong object 3b, 7

dvāra door the channel by which a process meets its object: five senses and mind 3b

vatthu physical base the matter a citta arises from: a sense organ or the heart-base 3b

hadaya-vatthu heart-base in beings with bodies, the matter supporting every citta except sense consciousness 3b

ārammaṇa object whatever a citta knows: a sight, a sound, a thought, a concept, Nibbāna 3b, 8

sabbacittasādhāraṇa universals the seven factors present in every citta, from contact to attention 4

pakiṇṇaka occasionals six ethically variable factors that join some cittas but not all 4

phassa contact the meeting of object, base and consciousness; the first universal factor 2, 4

cetanā volition the willing that organises the other factors; as kamma, it bears results 4, 10

jīvitindriya life faculty (mental) sustains the mental factors it arises with, for as long as they last 4

manasikāra attention turns the citta and its factors toward the object; present in every citta 4

vitakka applied thought lays the mind onto its object; a factor of the first jhāna only 4, 6

vicāra sustained thought keeps the mind moving over its object; a factor of the first two jhānas 4, 6

pīti zest delight in the object; a jhāna factor up to the third jhāna 4

lobha greed grasping at an object; roots eight cittas; as craving, a root of the wheel 4

dosa hatred aversion, from irritation to rage; root of two cittas, always with displeasure 4

moha delusion mental blindness to an object's true nature; present in every unwholesome citta 4

sati mindfulness not floating away from the object; a beautiful universal factor 2, 4

appamaññā illimitables (factors) compassion and appreciative joy as mental factors, taking suffering or happy beings as object 4

mahābhūta great elements earth, water, fire and air: the primary matter all other matter depends on 5

kalāpa the smallest group of matter: eight or more kinds arising and ceasing together 5

jīvita life faculty (material) sustains kamma-born matter in its kalāpa while it lasts 5

visayappavatti presentation of objects very great, great, slight or very slight: decides how far a process runs 7

upacāra access concentration just short of jhāna; also a javana in the run-up to absorption 7b, 12

paccaya condition a dhamma that helps another to arise or persist, in a specific way 8

nissaya support (condition 8) a foundation, as the earth is for trees; arising together or before 8

āhāra nutriment (four) edible food, contact, volition and consciousness, each sustaining its results 8

saṃyojana fetter one of ten defilements that bind to rebirth; the four paths cut them 8b, 13

bodhipakkhiyā dhammā 37 requisites the suttas' 37 aids to awakening, which reduce to 14 states 8

taṇhā craving greed as thirst: for sense objects, for existence or for non-existence; a root 9

bhava rebirth-becoming link 10, passive side: the new life's resultant mind and kamma-born matter 9

saṅkhepa group one of four sets of five: past causes, present effects, present causes, future effects 9

garuka weighty kamma jhāna kept to death, a heinous deed or fixed wrong view; ripens first 10

kamma-nimitta kamma sign at death, an object linked with a past deed, such as offered flowers 10

bhūmi plane one of 31 planes of existence, each matched to a kind of mind 11

Brahmā a being of the fine-material planes, reborn there through jhāna 11

asaṅkheyya incalculable (the Bodhisatta's career) in the Bodhisatta's story, a countless number of great aeons life

nimitta meditation sign the preliminary, learning or counterpart image of the meditation object 12

tilakkhaṇa the three marks impermanence, suffering and non-self: the marks that insight sees 13

vipassanā-ñāṇa insight knowledge one of ten stages of direct insight, from comprehension to conformity 13

arahant one who has cut all ten fetters; makes no new kamma and ends rebirth 13

diṭṭhi wrong view a mistaken belief, such as a lasting self; joins four greed-rooted cittas 3, 4

kāya body (two senses) the physical body; or, in factor names like kāya-passaddhi, the mental factors 4

paññā wisdom understanding things as they are; also called non-delusion and the faculty of wisdom 4, 6

pasāda sensitivity the matter of eye, ear, nose, tongue or body that receives sense impacts 5

viññatti intimation bodily or vocal expression of intention: mind-born matter that communicates 5

cittakkhaṇa mind-moment the life of one citta, in three sub-moments: arising, presence, dissolution 5, 7

manodvāra-vīthi mind-door process a process at the mind door alone: adverting, javanas, perhaps registration 7

gotrabhū change of lineage the javana that leaves the sense-sphere lineage for jhāna, or turns to Nibbāna 7b, 13

sahajāta conascence support between things arising at the same moment, like a lamp and its light 8

nissaya word-by-word text a study text giving each Pāli phrase, then its meaning; a Burmese teaching form study

upādāna clinging intense grasping: at sense pleasures, views, rites, a self; link 9 of the wheel 8b, 9

jhānaṅga jhāna factors applied and sustained thought, zest, one-pointedness and feeling: seven in CMA VII, five distinct states 8b, 12

paṭicca-samuppāda dependent origination the twelve links by which suffering arises, and by whose ending it ceases 9

nāmarūpa mentality-materiality (link 4) link 4: the resultant mental factors and kamma-born matter of a new life 9

ākāra mode one of twenty factors in the three-life reading: five for each group 9

vaṭṭa round one of three cycles turning in the wheel: defilements, kamma, results 9

āsanna death-proximate kamma done or recalled just before death; it ripens next if no weighty kamma does 10

gati-nimitta destiny sign at death, an image of the coming birth 10

apāya woeful planes hell, animals, ghosts and titans: the four unhappy destinations 11

mahākappa great aeon one cycle of a world's arising and passing; four incalculable aeons 11

samatha calm meditation that develops concentration, up to the jhānas 12

appamaññā illimitables (meditation) loving-kindness, compassion, appreciative joy and equanimity, toward all beings: the divine abidings 12

dukkha suffering the unsatisfactoriness of all that is conditioned; first noble truth and second mark D1, 13

sotāpanna stream-enterer one who has cut the first three fetters; at most seven more lives 13

puthujjana worldling an ordinary person who has reached no path 13

alobha adosa non-greed, non-hatred, non-delusion: the three wholesome roots; non-delusion is wisdom 4

tatramajjhattatā equanimity (factor) neutrality of mind, balancing its fellows; not a feeling; the divine abiding of equanimity 4, 12

saṅgaha combination reading down: which factors each citta contains (also, elsewhere, "compendium") 4

avinibbhoga inseparables the eight kinds in every kalāpa: four elements, colour, smell, taste, nutritive essence 5

ojā nutritive essence the essence in food, and in every kalāpa, that sustains matter 5

vīthi cognitive process a fixed series of cittas taking one object at one door 7

yoniso manasikāra wise attention attending in a way that leads to wholesome javanas; unwise attention leads to unwholesome 7

appanā absorption the jhāna or path javana itself, after access; the third stage of concentration 7b, 12

upanissaya decisive support a strong earlier cause, such as a habit, a teacher or a climate 8

indriya faculty a dhamma that governs its own domain; 22 faculties, and condition 16 8, 8b

anusaya latent tendencies seven defilements lying dormant, ready to arise when conditions meet 8

maggaṅga path factors twelve: eight right factors and four wrong ones; the eight right ones in path consciousness are the truth of the path 8

avijjā ignorance not knowing the four noble truths; delusion as a root of the wheel 9, 13

bhava kamma-becoming link 10, active side: volition and the deeds that lead to rebirth 9

sandhi connection one of three joints between the groups of causes and effects 9

kamma wholesome or unwholesome volition, which later ripens as results 10

āciṇṇa habitual kamma what one does again and again; next in line after death-proximate kamma 10

ānantariya heinous deeds killing mother, father or an arahant, wounding a Buddha, splitting the Saṅgha 10

deva a being of the six sense-sphere heavens, above the human world 11

asaṅkheyya-kappa incalculable aeon (Plate 11) a quarter of a great aeon, one phase of a world-cycle 11

kasiṇa a device for concentration, such as a disc of earth or a colour 12

vipassanā insight seeing mind and matter as impermanent, suffering and non-self 13

visuddhi purification one of seven stages of the path, from virtue to knowledge and vision 13

anāgāmī non-returner has cut sensual desire and ill will; reborn only in higher planes 13

ariya noble one anyone who has reached a path or fruit, from stream-entry up 13

One dhamma, many lenses

The Abhidhamma's own way of knowing a thing is to pass it through every list: is it mind or matter, which aggregate, which base, which element, which truth, wholesome or not, a result or a cause, a root or not. The Dhammasaṅgaṇī opens with exactly such lists, its matrix (*mātikā*) of triads and dyads. Read a row across to know one dhamma from every side; read a column down to see how one list sorts them all.

Dhamma	Reality *paramattha*	Aggregate *khandha*	Base *āyatana*	Element *dhātu*	Noble truth *sacca*	Quality *kusala triad*	Result *vipāka triad*	Root *hetu*	Takes an object *ārammaṇa*	Plates
cakkhuviññāṇa eye-consciousness	citta	consciousness	mind	eye-consciousness	suffering	indeterminate	result	–	●	3 7
mahākusala citta great wholesome citta	citta	consciousness	mind	mind-consciousness	suffering	wholesome	productive	–	●	3
phassa contact	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	varies	varies	–	●	2 4
vedanā feeling	cetasika	feeling	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	varies	varies	–	●	3 4
saññā perception	cetasika	perception	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	varies	varies	–	●	4 6
cetanā volition	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	varies	varies	–	●	4 10
manasikāra attention	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	varies	varies	–	●	4 7
lobha greed	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	origin	unwholesome	productive	●	●	4 9
dosa hatred	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering	unwholesome	productive	●	●	4
moha delusion	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering	unwholesome	productive	●	●	4 9
saddhā faith	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1]	wholesome[2]	varies	–	●	4
sati mindfulness	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1] · path	wholesome[2]	varies	–	●	2 4 13
paññā wisdom	cetasika	formations	mental object	mental object	suffering[1] · path	wholesome[2]	varies	●	●	4 6 13
pathavī-dhātu earth element	rūpa	form	tangible	tangible	suffering	indeterminate	neither	–	–	5
cakkhu-pasāda eye-sensitivity	rūpa	form	eye	eye	suffering	indeterminate	neither	–	–	5
rūpārammaṇa visible form	rūpa	form	visible form	visible form	suffering	indeterminate	neither	–	–	5 7
nibbāna Nibbāna	Nibbāna	none	mental object	mental object	cessation	indeterminate	neither	–	–	2 13

[1] When it occurs in a mundane citta. In path consciousness the path factors (eight, or seven in the higher-jhāna paths; among them wisdom and mindfulness) are the truth of the path; other factors in supramundane cittas stand outside the four truths.

[2] Wholesome in wholesome cittas; indeterminate in resultant and functional ones. "Varies": the factor takes the quality of the citta it arises in.

Patterns to look for

- Every mundane dhamma, even a wholesome citta, belongs to the truth of suffering: it is conditioned and it passes.
- Only greed is the truth of origin, as craving; only Nibbāna is cessation.
- Matter and Nibbāna take no object; every citta and factor does.
- Feeling and perception have aggregates of their own; every other factor is a formation.

Use it slowly

Take one row a day. Say it aloud as a sentence, find the dhamma's identity card, and carry its Notice prompt through the day. In seventeen days you will have met every reality the atlas teaches, from every side.

Sources: Dhammasaṅgaṇī mātikā; Vibhaṅga; Bodhi, *CMA* I, II, VI, VII

Sixteen identity cards

Four marks for each dhamma, as the commentaries give them (Plate 2 → 2). Learn one card a day. Then, when that dhamma is present, try to recognise it by its characteristic rather than by its name.

cakkhuviññāṇa

eye-consciousness · citta

CHARACTERISTIC
being aware of a visible object, with the eye as its base
FUNCTION
having only a visible object as its object
MANIFESTATION
being occupied with a visible object
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the five-door adverting citta's passing away

phassa

contact · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
touching the object
FUNCTION
impingement
MANIFESTATION
the coming together of base, object and consciousness
PROXIMATE CAUSE
an object that has come into focus

vedanā

feeling · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
being felt
FUNCTION
experiencing the taste of the object
MANIFESTATION
relishing by the factors that arise with it
PROXIMATE CAUSE
for joy, tranquillity; in the suttas, feeling arises with contact as its condition

saññā

perception · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
perceiving the qualities of the object
FUNCTION
making a sign for perceiving again "this is the same", as a carpenter marks timber
MANIFESTATION
interpreting by the features it has picked up
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the object as it appears

cetanā

volition · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
the state of willing
FUNCTION
accumulating kamma
MANIFESTATION
coordinating, like a head carpenter who does his own work and keeps others at theirs
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the factors that arise with it

manasikāra

attention · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
conducting the factors that arise with it toward the object
FUNCTION
yoking them to the object
MANIFESTATION
confronting an object
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the object

lobha

greed · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
grasping an object
FUNCTION
sticking, as meat sticks to a hot pan
MANIFESTATION
not letting go
PROXIMATE CAUSE
seeing enjoyment in things that lead to bondage

dosa

hatred · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
ferocity
FUNCTION
spreading, or burning up its own support
MANIFESTATION
persecuting
PROXIMATE CAUSE
grounds for annoyance

moha

delusion · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
mental blindness, or unknowing
FUNCTION
not penetrating, or concealing the object's true nature
MANIFESTATION
absence of right understanding, or mental darkness
PROXIMATE CAUSE
unwise attention

saddhā

faith · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
placing faith, trusting
FUNCTION
clarifying, like a gem that clears muddy water; or setting out, like crossing a flood
MANIFESTATION
non-fogginess, or resolution
PROXIMATE CAUSE
something worthy of faith, or hearing the good Dhamma

sati

mindfulness · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
not wobbling, not floating away from the object
FUNCTION
absence of confusion, non-forgetfulness
MANIFESTATION
guarding, or facing the object
PROXIMATE CAUSE
strong perception, or the four foundations of mindfulness

paññā

wisdom · cetasika

CHARACTERISTIC
penetrating things as they really are
FUNCTION
lighting up the object, like a lamp
MANIFESTATION
non-bewilderment
PROXIMATE CAUSE
wise attention (Visuddhimagga XIV gives concentration)

pathavī-dhātu

earth element · rūpa

CHARACTERISTIC
hardness
FUNCTION
acting as a foundation
MANIFESTATION
receiving
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the other three great elements

cakkhu-pasāda

eye-sensitivity · rūpa

CHARACTERISTIC
the sensitivity of the great elements, ready for the impact of visible objects
FUNCTION
picking up visible objects
MANIFESTATION
being the base of eye-consciousness
PROXIMATE CAUSE
great elements born of kamma, from a desire to see

rūpārammaṇa

visible form · rūpa

CHARACTERISTIC
striking the eye
FUNCTION
being the object of eye-consciousness
MANIFESTATION
being what eye-consciousness rests on
PROXIMATE CAUSE
the four great elements

nibbāna

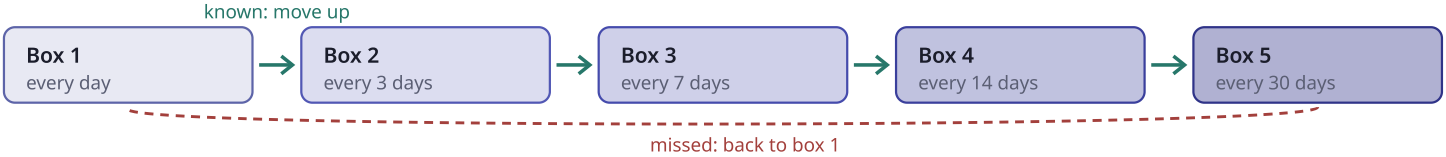
the unconditioned

CHARACTERISTIC
peace
FUNCTION
not dying, or comforting
MANIFESTATION
the signless, or freedom from proliferation
PROXIMATE CAUSE
none: it is unconditioned

Wording condensed from Bodhi's *Comprehensive Manual* (chapters II and VI), which follows the Atthasālinī and the Visuddhimagga (XIV, XVI); Nibbāna has no proximate cause because nothing conditions it. Translations differ; check a term against the source you study from.

A review deck in five boxes

Seventy-seven questions. Six recall cards for each level are printed below; on screen, 35 more ask why, classify and relate. Answer before you look: the effort of recalling is what fixes the answer. A card you know moves up a box and comes back later; a card you miss goes back to box 1 and comes back tomorrow. Add a level's cards only when you reach it.



I · FOUNDATIONS

1. **Name the four ultimate realities.**
   Citta (consciousness), cetasika (mental factors), rūpa (matter) and Nibbāna.
2. **How many kinds of each reality are there?**
   89 cittas (121 in detail), 52 cetasikas, 28 kinds of matter, and one Nibbāna.
3. **Which book of the Abhidhamma analyses, and which relates everything by conditions?**
   The Dhammasaṅgaṇī analyses; the Paṭṭhāna relates.
4. **What are conventional and ultimate truth called in Pāli?**
   Sammuti-sacca and paramattha-sacca.
5. **Name the four parts of a commentarial definition.**
   Characteristic, function, manifestation and proximate cause.
6. **In SN 22.95, what are the five aggregates compared to?**
   Form to a lump of foam, feeling to a bubble, perception to a mirage, formations to a plantain trunk, consciousness to a magic show.

II · ELEMENTS

1. **Name the seven universal mental factors.**
   Contact, feeling, perception, volition, one-pointedness, life faculty and attention.
2. **How many cittas are unwholesome, and by which roots?**
   Twelve: eight rooted in greed, two in hatred, two in delusion.
3. **In which cittas does mental displeasure (domanassa) occur?**
   Only in the two hate-rooted cittas.
4. **What are the four origins of matter?**
   Kamma, citta, temperature and nutriment.
5. **Name the eight inseparable kinds of matter.**
   Earth, water, fire and air; colour, smell, taste and nutritive essence.
6. **How are the 89 cittas divided by plane?**
   54 sense-sphere, 15 fine-material, 12 immaterial and 8 supramundane.

III · PROCESS

1. **How many mind-moments make a complete five-door process?**
   Seventeen, counting the past life-continuum moment.
2. **At which moment of a five-door process does seeing occur?**
   The fifth: after past life-continuum, vibration, arrest and five-door adverting.
3. **In which moments is new kamma made?**
   In the javanas, usually seven of them.
4. **What happens when the object is only slight?**
   The process stops at determining; no javanas run.
5. **Which citta fills the gaps between processes?**
   The life-continuum (bhavaṅga), the same resultant citta as rebirth-linking.
6. **What decides whether the javanas are wholesome or unwholesome?**
   Wise or unwise attention, at the turning point of determining.

IV · RELATIONS

1. **What are the two roots of the wheel of dependent origination?**
   Ignorance and craving.
2. **Name the twelve links in order.**
   Ignorance, formations, consciousness, mind-and-matter, six bases, contact, feeling, craving, clinging, becoming, birth, ageing-and-death.
3. **Which links belong to the past life in the three-life reading?**
   Ignorance and formations.
4. **Which four conditions, the Saṅgaha says, include all 24?**
   Object, decisive support, kamma and presence.
5. **Name a condition that holds between things arising at the same time.**
   Conascence (sahajāta); also mutuality, support, association and presence.
6. **Where does the wheel turn from present results to present causes?**
   Between feeling and craving: the second of its three connections.

V · LIVES AND WORLDS

1. **What is kamma, strictly speaking?**
   Volition (cetanā).
2. **Name the four kinds of kamma by function.**
   Productive, supportive, obstructive and destructive.
3. **Name the four kinds of kamma by order of ripening.**
   Weighty, death-proximate, habitual and reserve.
4. **What three kinds of object can appear at the time of death?**
   Kamma, a sign of kamma, or a sign of destiny.
5. **How are the 31 planes divided?**
   11 sense-sphere, 16 fine-material and 4 immaterial planes.
6. **Which plane has matter but no mind?**
   The plane of non-percipient beings.

VI · PRACTICE

1. **How many meditation subjects does the Visuddhimagga list?**
   Forty.
2. **Name the three signs (nimitta) of concentration.**
   The preliminary, learning and counterpart signs.
3. **Name the three stages of concentration.**
   Preliminary, access and absorption.
4. **Which subjects can lead to all five jhānas?**
   The ten kasiṇas and mindfulness of breathing.
5. **Which three fetters are abandoned at stream-entry?**
   Identity view, doubt, and clinging to rites and rituals.
6. **What is the first purification, and the last?**
   Purification of virtue; purification by knowledge and vision.

VII · SYNTHESIS

1. **How many elements do the Theravāda, Sarvāstivāda and Yogācāra count?**
   82, 75 and 100.
2. **Which thread runs through the most plates?**
   Citta, through ten of the fifteen.
3. **Trace the loop of a life on the concept map.**
   Kamma → rebirth → life-continuum → process → javana → kamma.
4. **Which idea takes part in the most links on the concept map?**
   Citta.
5. **In the moment of seeing a mango and wanting it, which factor leads the javanas?**
   Greed (lobha).
6. **Which of the 17 moments is the mango simile's "eating"?**
   The javanas.